

RECORD OF THE REGULAR MEETING OF THE BROOKLINE SCHOOL COMMITTEE HELD ON **THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 28, 2019** AT 6:00 PM IN THE WALSH SCHOOL COMMITTEE ROOM, 5TH FLOOR, TOWN HALL. STATUTORY NOTICE OF THIS MEETING WAS FILED WITH THE TOWN CLERK.

School Committee Members Present: Mr. Pollak (Chairman), Ms. Schreiner-Oldham (Vice Chairman), Ms. Ditzkoff, Ms. Federspiel, Mr. Glover, Ms. Monopoli, Mr. Pearlman, and Ms. Scotto. School Committee Members Absent: Ms. Charlupski. Also present: Mr. Bott, Ms. Dunn, Dr. Gittens, Ms. Ngo-Miller, Mr. Lummis, Mr. Simon, and Ms. Coyne.

Others Present: Jennifer Buller, Lesley Ryan Miller, Dr. Kalise Wornum, and Jonathan Levi, Principal, JLA Architects.

1. ADMINISTRATIVE BUSINESS

a. Calendar

Mr. Pollak called the meeting to order at 6:00 PM. He noted upcoming events on the calendar.

b. Consent Agenda

ACTION 19-20

On a motion of Ms. Schreiner-Oldham and seconded by Mr. Pearlman, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY to approve the item included in the Consent Agenda.

- i. Past Record: February 14, 2019 School Committee Meeting

2. PUBLIC COMMENT

The following people spoke in support of open negotiations between the School Committee and the Brookline Educators Union (BEU) and allowing the BEU to expand its negotiating team to include silent observers: Jesse Kirdahy, Driscoll Educator; Ann Collins, Brookline High School Teacher; Jeremy Bloch, Coolidge Corner School Teacher and Brookline resident; Kathy Hitchcock, Brookline High School Teacher and parent; and Liz Lamson, Heath Teacher. Their comments included the following: School Committee's unwillingness to negotiate with silent observers present is frustrating; open negotiations would be a sign of respect; allowing silent BEU representatives helps avoid misunderstandings and has positive benefits for both sides; open bargaining is becoming more common and has been supported by both unions and management in other districts; the process is not meant to intimidate; the members would conduct themselves in a responsible and respectful manner; encourage School Committee to be open to learning more about open negotiations; the process was used successfully in Concord, Massachusetts; and open bargaining provides clarity in the process.

John Schachter, Driscoll parent, advocated for requiring sustainability measures in the new contract for Food Services management, including composting, more plant-based offerings, and donation of untouched food. He spoke in support of pilot programs at the schools.

The following people spoke in support of the Alternative Choices in Education (ACE) Program: Martha Bebinger, Brookline High School parent; Rebecca Sneider, Runkle Guidance Counselor and Brookline High School parent; and Susan Gordon, Brookline High School parent. Their comments included the following: should maintain the full-time counseling position; the program works well and should be expanded, not reduced; are seeing more students with vulnerabilities at younger ages; consider expanding the program to middle school grades; the number of administrators at the high school has increased, but the number of guidance counselors has not increased; should not reduce guidance services for the most vulnerable students; the ACE guidance position is different from other guidance positions; reducing the counselor position will negatively impact the students who are already at risk; students very much support maintaining a full-time guidance counselor.

3. PRESENTATIONS AND DISCUSSIONS OF CURRENT ISSUES

a. FY 2020 Budget Update

Ms. Dunn provided an update on the FY 2020 Budget (Attachment A). She referred to her February 22, 2019 memo regarding the FY 2020 Budget Request for the 2019 Annual Town Meeting (Attachment B). The School budget currently shows a revenue deficit of \$383,000. The administration is cautiously optimistic that the deficit will be eliminated as we receive additional information. For example, the Group Insurance Commission (GIC) increase may be less than the initial projection. The budget presented to Town Meeting will be balanced hopefully without the need for further operating budget reductions. School Committee members suggested that communications on the budget note that we started with a projected deficit of almost \$2 million, explain how we were able to close most of that gap, and clarify the plan to address any remaining shortfall. School Committee members requested that consideration be given to composting in the schools. It was noted that the Ms. Charlupski has reached out to Commissioner of Public Works. The School Committee discussed the need for school building leaders to have some budget autonomy to enable them to address specific needs in their schools.

i. Possible Votes on FY 2020 Budget

ACTION 19-21

On a motion of Ms. Ditkoff and seconded by Ms. Schreiner-Oldham, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY to approve the budget of \$120,109,718 for FY 2020.

Ms. Dunn stated that the next proposed vote is being requested to provide the Superintendent and the district with improved management oversight and reporting of our financial information. All public school districts in the Commonwealth must report to the Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education (DESE) under this structure. The reporting structure should support the recruitment and retention of principals as instructional leaders.

ACTION 19-22

On a motion of Ms. Ditzkoff and seconded by Ms. Monopoli, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY to require all expenditures comply with Education Reform Act of 1993, the Uniform Massachusetts Accounting System (UMAS), the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education (DESE) Chart of Accounts reporting structure for the End of Year Report. The expenditure accounts are to be structured in the following manner:

- a. **Location:** Building/School Locations (e.g., District, Beep – Beacon, Baker, Lawrence, Brookline High School)
- b. **Program:** Regular Day, Special Education, Early Childhood, Ch 74 Vocational/Technical, English Language Education, Other Programs, Undistributed
- c. **DESE Function Codes[1]:** 1000 – 9000
- d. **UMAS[2]:** Object Codes that complement/support the DESE Object Codes
- e. **Subject:** e.g., Math, Science, English Language Arts, etc. (Brookline has partially implemented; Education Reform requirement yet to be implemented by DESE for End of Year)
- f. **Grade:** (Education Reform requirement yet to be implemented by DESE for End of Year)

Ms. Dunn summarized next steps, including collaboration with the Comptroller's Office on the account structure. This will be a multi-year process. The Advisory Committee's Administration and Finance Subcommittee is interested in this issue. School Committee members recommended that this be rolled out in a thoughtful manner that does not lead to unnecessary angst.

Ms. Dunn presented the proposed vote on Revenue Sources. The proposed vote assumes the deficit will be the responsibility of the School Committee to adjust, based on the recommendation of the Superintendent, the category of expenditures (Personnel, Services, Supplies, Other, Capital) prior to June 30, 2020 and close the fiscal year in balance. The Finance Subcommittee will be having further discussions on grants and revolving funds. The Advisory Committee has expressed interest in having the Schools review fees under their control for possible increase.

ACTION 19-23

On a motion of Ms. Ditzkoff and seconded by Ms. Scotto, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY to approve the budget revenue of \$119,724,028 for FY 2020, with the understanding that the School Committee will vote a balanced budget no later than April 23, 2019.

Ms. Dunn presented a proposed 2019 Annual Town Meeting Warrant Article: School Bus Transportation Revolving Fund {Chapter 44: Section 53 ½}. The \$150,000 figure is significantly higher than the anticipated amount.

ACTION 19-24

On a motion of Ms. Ditkoff and seconded by Mr. Pearlman, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY to see if the Town will authorize the following revolving fund limit for certain Town departments pursuant to the provisions of M.G.L. Chapter 44, Section 53E ½ for Fiscal Year 2019 beginning July 1, 2019. Annual expenditures from the fund shall not exceed \$150,000

Program or Purpose for Revolving Funds	FY2020 Authorization
School Bus Transportation	\$150,000

The School Committee will be asked to consider approving non-aligned pay rates on March 14, 2019. The Finance Subcommittee will be asked to review and report back on the following items: a proposed FY 2020 transfer to the Department of Public Health for the Youth Services Substance Abuse Counselor; FY 2020 Grant applications and anticipated awards; FY 2020 Revolving Fund program budgets (preferably by the end of March); FY 2020 Student Fees, Fines, and Charges (preferably by April 1); and a proposed Special Education Stabilization Fund.

b. Overview of Student Achievement Measures, Progress, and Interventions

Mr. Bott stated that this year's presentation (Attachment C) will focus on district-wide assessments and development of a culture of using data to inform decision making and support students. He provided an overview of district-wide assessments in the Public Schools of Brookline (PSB) and peer districts (Newton, Cambridge, Wellesley, and Lexington). The PSB collects the following student achievement data across all schools: K-5 - Benchmark Assessment System (BAS) for English Language Arts (ELA) and the Kindergarten Literacy Assessment (ELA); Middle School - BAS (ELA)-only done with a subset of students.

Mr. Bott provided an overview of results of the faculty survey on use of BAS (Attachment D). Overwhelmingly, educators indicated that BAS data helps to support placement of students in reading peer groups and helps identify how they should focus reading instruction with students. For specified populations, educators also use BAS data to learn whether or not students are regressing and need to be referred to support opportunities and whether or not students who are fluent in reading actually comprehend what they are reading. BAS also helps teachers to differentiate different types of reading comprehension. Mr. Bott referred to specific comments submitted as part of the survey (Attachment E).

Data when used appropriately is an important and valuable resource. At later meetings Special Education and Brookline High School administrators will be reporting to the Curriculum Subcommittee and full School Committee on the development of an early warning system (uses information such as attendance, course grades and survey

data on connection to an adult and peers at the school; does not use standardized test scores) to help identify students at risk of not graduating.

Dr. Wornum, Senior Director of Educational Equity, discussed the district's efforts to be more systematic about how we use data to inform our practice and make decisions about learning, programs, practices, and budget. In order to become a more equitable system, we need to train ourselves to always ask key questions (e.g., Where do students have the greatest sense of belonging?) and then to use the information to impact professional development and practice.

Mr. Bott discussed the following: plan going forwarding for testing students at "pause and consider," consideration of how to reduce achievement gaps and best provide interventions/support to students who are struggling (Mr. Bott will provide information on student achievement gaps by grade); potential benefit of increased communication with parents/guardians regarding BAS results (School Committee members noted the importance of doing this well; suggested communicating ranges rather than more specific targets; avoid actions that will lead to labeling; and note that BAS looks at the continuum).

Coolidge Corner School Co-Interim Principal Jennifer Buller discussed how the School used BAS during the 2017-2018 School Year. Grade level teams drilled into Mid-Year BAS results to see exactly where students were struggling. Interventions for students were discussed and selected based on the BAS outcomes. Teachers worked with Literacy Coaches if they needed support on how to provide specific in-class interventions. Teachers decided to complete another round of BAS to determine if the selected intervention was having a positive impact. Ms. Buller summarized Grade 1 results. Of the 11 students who scored "Does Not Meet" in the Mid-Year, five of them moved to "Exceeds" and two moved to "Meet" performance levels by the End-of-Year. Of the five students who scored "Approaches" in the Mid-Year, four moved to "Exceeds" and one moved to "Meet" performance levels by the End-of-Year.

Pierce School Principal Lesley Ryan Miller discussed how the School has been developing a culture of data-based decision making. Pierce introduced the Data Wise process, starting with data that teachers were interested in exploring (enrollment data). The School used the Data Wise process with the entire faculty to develop the 2018-2019 School Improvement Plan and identified literacy as the school-wide focus. Grade level teams identified specific literacy challenges their students faced and are now looking at behavior and student conduct data to identify patterns and learn where students need support. Ms. Ryan Miller provided examples of how using data to make decisions is making Pierce's culture more collaborative (data helps staff work together to decide the priorities; teachers are more involved in decision making and leadership; gives teachers one voice and a greater sense of ownership; grade level teams worked together to identify their student needs instead of having someone else tell them; all educators involved in school improvement planning; teachers are asking for more data so they can have a better sense of what is happening for individual students and groups of students, and to help

them improve their practice). Ms. Ryan Miller discussed the teachers' role in the process, including the determination of which data to collect and how data is collected.

Mr. Bott summarized the ways in which an ongoing practice of using data systematically will help the district (understand why we have inequitable student outcomes and identify and implement effective responses; make thoughtful decisions on what we should start, continue, or stop doing; understand if we are allocating resources in ways that best impact student learning; determine if our programs and interventions are helping students reach the program's intended outcomes; understand persistent challenges and learn how to address them; monitor implementation and adjust and improve as necessary; and understand student needs before summative assessments so teachers can provide support earlier).

School Committee members requested further discussion of what success will look like; how the type of measures and data used varies depending on the questions we are trying to answer; and use of assessments to support individual students and as a tool to answer larger district-wide questions.

**c. Progress Report and Discussion of 2018-2019 District/
Superintendent Goals**

Mr. Bott introduced the Progress Report on District/Superintendent 2018-2019 Goals (Attachment F). Ms. Ngo-Miller discussed the development of the new Code of Conduct, which will become effective July 1, 2019. The administration has met with all principals and Brookline High School (BHS) deans for first stage of implementation planning. The department is currently working on the following: 1) an implementation guide with a communication and training plan and 2) thoughtful planning with school leaders and senior staff to ensure alignment with restorative practice work and Social and Emotional Learning curricula selection/determination process.

Ms. Ngo-Miller discussed the three-year process to bring Restorative Justice practices to all schools, PreK-12. She described what has already been done: 1) regular coaching and support session from the Center for Restorative Justice (CRJ) for project leadership, Dr. Maria Letasz, and Gabe McCormick; 2) CRJ Circle Training for Principals, Central Office staff, and High School Deans; 3) training completed for BHS staff, elementary Vice Principals, Lincoln School staff, guidance, and social workers; 4) twelve community meetings between October 24 and February 6: one at each elementary school, BHS, Brookline Early Education Program (BEEP), and two at community locations. Information gathered from these community meeting is being reviewed to help inform additional communication/education opportunities; and 5) presentation of Restorative Practices at each Superintendent Forum. Current work includes: 1) coordinating dates for additional trainings this spring in anticipation of having five more Tier I trainings scheduled between March and June, as well as one additional Tier II training scheduled in June and 2) revising the three-year plan in consultation with Suffolk University CRJ and district leadership.

School Committee members asked about supports in place to help school leaders and teachers implement the new Code of Conduct. Members requested additional information on the Runkle School “demerit” system and whether it aligns with the new Code of Conduct and focus on Restorative Justice. Staff responded that the system, developed by a team of deeply committed educators to address some issues at the school, does align with the new Code of Conduct. No one is tied to the word “demerit,” which some members suggested might have an unintended negative connotation.

Due to the lateness of the hour, the School Committee decided to continue the presentation and discussion of 2018-2019 District/Superintendent Goals at the March 19, 2019 School Committee Workshop.

d. Presentation - Schematic Design Driscoll School

Mr. Bott and Jonathan Levi, Principal, JLA Architects, presented the Driscoll School Schematic Design (Attachment G). They presented design updates (site plan, open space metrics, anatomy of a classroom, floor plans, elevations, and the street massing diagram). Mr. Bott and Mr. Levi then discussed budget (construction cost drivers, which includes the Boston Metro Area cost index, structured parking, fossil fuel free systems, and the Brookline K-8 standard multipurpose room; construction costs; total project costs; and projected total costs, \$87.3 million construction and \$108.8 million total project; cost comparison to the Feasibility Study; escalation in recent Massachusetts School Building Authority projects; and recent middle school project costs, adjusted for escalation).

School Committee members asked for clarification on several items: cafeteria noise level and traffic flow/congestion as people enter the building (plan is still under development; will be acoustic absorption and thoughtful placement of furniture, which will be movable; has become common practice to put cafeteria in the middle of a school); placement of maker space near the pre-kindergarten classrooms (want maker space to be near the learning commons; perhaps include a partition; want to keep grade levels together, but not isolate); consider an outdoor garden space on the terrace; access terrace without going through maker space (tried to avoid long corridors; look at options for performance space (will bring in a theatre consultant); make sure small gym ceiling is high enough; and the smaller spaces in the basement (still working on this; ask Coolidge Corner staff about the use of lockers).

e. Presentation - Schematic Design Baldwin School

Mr. Bott and Jonathan Levi, Principal, JLA Architects, presented the Baldwin School Schematic Design (Attachment H). They presented design updates (site plan, anatomy of a classroom, floor plans, and the street massing diagram). Mr. Bott and Mr. Levi then discussed budget (construction cost drivers, which include the Boston Metro Area cost index, the Reaching Independence through Structured Education - RISE - Program, structured parking, and fossil fuel free systems); construction costs; total project costs; projected total costs, \$66.9 million construction and \$82.9 million total project; cost comparison to the Feasibility Study; escalation in recent Massachusetts

School Building Authority projects; recent middle school project costs, adjusted for escalation; and Brookline Schools additional seat options comparisons).

f. Presentation/Discussion/Possible Vote on Proposed Request for Proposals (RFP) for Food Service Management Company

Ms. Dunn presented the proposed RFP for Management of the School Food Service Program. She explained the proposed RFP schedule (Attachment I). The district will also post the position of Food Service Director.

ACTION 19-25

On a motion of Ms. Schreiner-Oldham and seconded by Ms. Scotto, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY to authorize the issuance of a formal RFP for contracting a Food Service Management Company to perform the duties and responsibilities of the Food Service Director and to operate and manage the Public Schools of Brookline Food Service Program from July 1, 2019 through June 30, 2022.

4. SCHOOL COMMITTEE ACTION

**a. Possible Vote to Approve Superintendent's Contract
(July 1, 2019-June 30, 2024)**

ACTION 19-26

On a motion of Mr. Pollak and seconded by Ms. Schreiner-Oldham, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY to approve the Superintendent's Contract for the period July 1, 2019-June 30, 2024 (Attachment J).

5. NEW BUSINESS

There was no new business to discuss.

6. ADJOURNMENT

Mr. Pollak adjourned the meeting at 10:30 PM.

Respectfully Submitted,

Robin E. Coyne, Executive Assistant
Brookline School Committee

Fiscal Year
2020 Budget
Request
for the 2019
Annual Town
Meeting

The memorandum contains the following actions.

- 1) Approve Fiscal Year 2020 Budget Request for the 2019 Annual Town Meeting**
- 2) Establish School Committee Expenditure Reporting Requirement**
- 3)** Approve Non-Aligned Pay Rates
- 4) School Committee votes and authorizes Fiscal Year 2020 Revenue Sources**
- 5)** Approve/Authorize FY20 transfer to Public Health for Youth Services Substance Abuse Counselor
- 6)** Authorize Grant Applications and Anticipated Awards
- 7)** Approve Revolving Fund Program Budgets
- 8)** Approve FY 20 Student Fees, Fines, and Charges
- 9) Submit 2019 Annual Town Meeting Warrant Articles**
 - a) Transportation Revolving Funds {Chapter 44 Section 53 ½}**
 - b)** Special Education Stabilization Fund {Section 24 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016}

1. Approve Fiscal Year 2020 Budget Request for the 2019 Annual Town meeting

Motion: The School Committee votes the following budget of \$120,109,718 for Fiscal Year 2020.

Program	Exp.	FY18 ACTUAL		FY19 Budget STM		FY20 BUDGET PRELIMINARY		FY20 PRELIM Bud - FY19 Bud Variance	
		FTE	EXP.	FTE	EXP.	FTE	EXP.	FTE	EXP.
<u>Gross School Dept. Budget</u>	Personnel	1,240.49	\$94,622,356	1,276.72	\$ 98,478,447	1,313.60	\$ 104,282,459	36.88	\$ 5,804,011
<u>Expenditures</u>	Services		\$9,741,002		\$ 10,542,721		\$ 11,699,864		\$ 1,157,142
	Supplies		\$1,922,502		\$ 2,051,297		\$ 1,833,497		\$ (217,800)
	Other		\$,593,018		\$ 1,288,570		\$ 1,102,213		\$ (186,357)
	Capital		\$1,140,010		\$ 1,364,723		\$ 1,191,685		\$ (173,038)
	Total		\$ 108,018,889		\$ 113,725,760		\$120,109,718	5.61%	\$ 6,383,958

2. Establish School Committee Expenditure Reporting Requirement

- a. **Location:** Building/School Locations (e.g., District, Beep – Beacon, Baker, Lawrence, BHS)
- b. **Program:** Regular Day, Special Education, Early Childhood, Ch 74 Vocational/Technical, English Language Education, Other Programs, Undistributed
- c. **Deese Function Codes[1]:** 1000 – 9000
- d. **UMAS[2]:** Object Codes that compliment/support the DESE Object Codes
- e. **Subject:** e.g., Math, Science, ELA, Etc. (Brookline has partially Implemented. Education reform requirement yet to be implemented by DESE for EOYR)
- f. **Grade:** (Education reform requirement yet to be implemented by DESE for EOYR)

2. **Establish School Committee Expenditure Reporting Requirement**

Motion: The School Committee requires all expenditures comply with Education Reform Act of 1993, The Uniform Massachusetts Accounting System (UMAS), The Department of Elementary and Secondary Education (DESE) Chart of Accounts reporting structure for the End of Year Report. The expenditure accounts are to be structured in the following manner:

3. Approve FY 20 – FY23 Non-Aligned Pay Rates

The School Committee Negotiations Sub Committee will be reporting out on this item after consideration and review by March 7.

School Committee will receive for review and action on March 14.

4.

School Committee votes and authorizes Fiscal Year 2020 Revenue Sources

Program	Exp.	FY18 ACTUAL FTE EXP.	FY19 Budget STM FTE EXP.	FY20 BUDGET PRELIMINARY FTE EXP.	FY20 PRELIM Bud - FY19 Bud Variance FTE EXP.
<u>School Dept. Revenues</u>					
General Fund Appropriation		\$ 104,758,343	\$ 110,583,255	\$ 117,235,691	6.02% \$ 6,652,436
EHS Fee Based Busing			\$ 75,000		-100.00% \$ (75,000)
Total Town/School Partnership Revenue			\$ 110,658,255	\$ 117,235,691	5.95% \$ 6,577,436
Tuition and Fees		\$ 696,016	\$ 696,016	\$ 717,523	28.68% \$ 21,507
Facility Rental		\$ 225,000	\$ -	\$ -	* \$ -
Circuit Breaker Funding		\$ 1,873,044	\$ 1,688,705	\$ 1,769,814	4.80% \$ 81,109
Revolving Fund Reimbursement		\$ 50,680	\$ 150,680	\$ -	-100.00% \$ (150,680)
Other Revenue		\$ -	\$ 358,680	\$ -	-100.00% \$ (358,680)
Total Revenue:		\$ 107,603,083	\$ 113,582,336	\$ 119,723,028	5.43% \$ 6,170,692
Surplus/Deficit:		\$ (415,806)	\$ (173,424)	\$ (386,690)	
			*STM Budget Reduction to fund FY18 deficit		

4.

School Committee votes and authorizes Fiscal Year 2020 Revenue Sources

*The deficit will be the responsibility of the School Committee to adjust, based on the recommendation of the Superintendent, the category of expenditures (Personnel, Services, Supplies, Other, Capital) prior to **June 30, 2020** and close the fiscal year in balance.*

The Superintendent will not assume any ongoing or future subsidy for Athletics, Food Service, or any Federal, State, or Local Grant. Revolving Funds and Grants will have to reduce expenditures and not assume the operating budget will have funding available to cover the over expenditure due to reductions in grant awards or revenue collection.

4.

School Committee votes and authorizes Fiscal Year 2020 Revenue Sources

Motion: The School Committee votes the following budget revenue of \$119,724,028 for Fiscal Year 2020.

Town Meeting	Levy/Town Financial Plan	Town/School Partnership	\$117,235,691
BHS Fee Based Busing	Levy/Town Financial Plan	Warrant Article for Revolving Fund	
School Department	Tuition and Fees	Materials Fee/International	\$717,523
	Facility Rental	FY 19 moved to Revolving Fund	
	Circuit Breaker	Circuit Breaker Reimbursement	\$1,769,814
	Revolving Fund Reimbursement	Eliminated FY 20	
	Other Revenue	Eliminated FY 20	

5. Approve and Authorize FY 20 transfer to Public Health for Youth Services Substance Abuse Counselor

Refer to School Committee Finance Sub Committee for presentation from

Dr. Swannie Jett, Director of Public Health

Anthony Meyer, BHS Headmaster

Casey Ngo- Miller, Interim Deputy Superintendent for Student Services

Partnership history, service and support provided, reason for transfer.

6.

FY 20 Grant Applications and Anticipated Awards

Annually the School Department submits grant applications for both entitlement and competitive grants. Federal and state grants, gifts, and donations to the School Committee shall be processed as specified by statute and donor requirements. These Special Revenue Funds are reported in the Grant Section of the School Committee Budget Book.

The School Committee Finance Sub Committee will be reporting out on this item after consideration and review

6.

FY 20 Grant Applications and Anticipated Awards

1. Grant applications known to be needed in future budget years will have a projected fiscal year budget showing projected personnel and expense related costs and anticipated revenue.
2. If the anticipated revenue does not meet the projected costs, the grant application will have to reduce expenditures and not assume the operating budget will have funding available to cover the over expenditure due to reductions in grant awards or revenue collection. Any reduction in expenditure should be submitted for consideration during the Operating Budget development cycle.
3. The Superintendent is responsible under his authority to maintain a balanced grant and operating budget.
4. Acceptance of the Grant will take place upon award and without additional presentation if no additional operating budget funds are needed to support the mission of the grant.

7.

FY20 Revolving Fund Program Budgets

A revolving fund receives its income from selling goods and services to users or participants in a program and expends funds to cover the costs of such goods or the expenses of providing the particular program or service. The intent is for such activities to break even financially, and the revolving fund is a mechanism that allows for fluctuations in levels of activity.

7.

FY20 Revolving Fund Program Budgets

Revolving funds exist under specific statutory authority and operate without approval or appropriation by town meeting. State law [G.L. c. 44, §53E1/2] allows a wide variety of revolving funds. Revolving funds are commonly used for park and recreation programs, school athletic programs, community adult education and continuing education programs, and school lunch programs. Most revolving funds must be authorized annually by town meeting. School Committee has authority under Chapter 71 for certain revolving funds.

7.

FY20 Revolving Fund Program Budgets

Revolving Fund accounts shall be under the direct control of the School Committee, which delegates the power to the Superintendent and/or School Business Administrator to authorize expenditures from them without further appropriation by the Town. All monies collected by the schools from fees, fines, admissions, and other non-tax sources shall be submitted to the Business Office, deposited with the Treasurer of the Town, and credited to the appropriate and authorized fund for expenditure.

The School Committee Finance Sub Committee will be reporting out on this item after consideration and review.

LEGAL REF.: M.G.L, Ch. 40 §3; Ch. 44, § 53, 53A, 53E 1/2.; Ch. 71, §17A, 26C, 37A, 47, 71, 71E, 71F; Ch. 548 of the Acts of 1948.

8.

FY20 Student Fees, Fines, and Charges

Next steps

By April 1 SC vote fees, fines, and charges in accordance to the fee table provided in the memorandum and as adjusted after budget review.

FY 20 Warrant Article Proposals: School Bus

9. Transportation Revolving Funds {Chapter 44: Section 53 1/2}

Description: South Brookline School Bus Transportation for Brookline High Schools Students

Requirement:

A revolving fund established under the provision of Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 44, Section 53E1/2 must be approved annually by vote of the Town Meeting. The Funds are credited with the receipts received in connection with the programs supported by such funds, and expenditures may be made from the revolving fund without further appropriation.

9. FY 20 Warrant Article Proposals: School Bus Transportation Revolving Funds {Chapter 44: Section 53 ½}

Motion:

To see if the Town will authorize the following revolving fund limit for certain Town departments pursuant to the provisions of M.G.L. Chapter 44, Section 53E ½ for Fiscal Year 2019 beginning July 1, 2019. Annual expenditures from the fund shall not exceed \$150,000

Program or Purpose for Revolving Funds	FY2020 Authorization
School Bus Transportation	\$150,000

9.

FY 20 Warrant Article Proposals: Special Education Stabilization Fund {Section 24 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016}

The Special Education Stabilization Fund is being established to provide for extraordinary need in special education tuition and transportation expenses. The fund is restricted to special education, out of district tuition, and specialized transportation expenditures that exceed the district's operating budget and require regular education programs to be severely impacted by the budget deficit. The fund will begin with \$_____ transfer from the FY_____ School Department operating budget voted at the {Date} School Committee Meeting. Section 24 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016 provides for the establishment of a Special Education Stabilization fund. The law enables municipal and regional districts to establish a reserve fund that can be used in future years for unanticipated or unbudgeted costs of special education, out of district tuition or transportation.



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ANDREW J. BOTT
SUPERINTENDENT

MARY ELLEN N. DUNN
DEPUTY SUPERINTENDENT OF SCHOOLS
FOR ADMINISTRATION & FINANCE

To: Andrew Bott, Superintendent
From: Mary Ellen N. Dunn, Deputy Supt for Administration and Finance
Date: February 22, 2019
RE: Fiscal Year 2020 Budget Request for the 2019 Annual Town Meeting (ATM)

The School Committee is required to provide a budget request to the Town Financial Plan in preparation for the Annual Town Meeting. Below are a series of votes that are required to complete the School Committee's budget request for the Town's Financial Plan document, submission to the Town Meeting Warrant, and request additional revenue to fund the FY 2020 Budget request of the Superintendent.

The memorandum contains the following actions to be taken prior to March 7, 2019.

- 1) Approve Fiscal Year 2020 Budget Request for the 2019 Annual Town Meeting
- 2) Establish School Committee Expenditure Reporting Requirement
- 3) Approve Non-Aligned Pay Rates
- 4) School Committee votes and authorizes Fiscal Year 2020 Revenue Sources
- 5) Approve and Authorize FY 20 transfer to Public Health for Youth Services Substance Abuse Counselor
- 6) Authorize Grant Applications and Anticipated Awards
- 7) Approve Revolving Fund Program Budgets
- 8) Approve FY 20 Student Fees, Fines, and Charges
- 9) Submit 2019 Annual Town Meeting Warrant Articles
 - a) Transportation Revolving Funds {Chapter 44 Section 53 ½}
 - b) Special Education Stabilization Fund {Section 24 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016}

1. Approve Fiscal Year 2020 Budget Request for the 2019 Annual Town Meeting

Program	Exp.	FY18 ACTUAL		FY19 Budget STM		FY20 BUDGET PRELIMINARY		FY20 PRELIM Bud - FY19 Bud Variance	
		FTE	EXP.	FTE	EXP.	FTE	EXP.	FTE	EXP.
Gross School Dept. Budget	Personnel	1,240.49	\$94,622,356	1,276.72	\$ 98,478,447	1,313.60	\$ 104,282,459	36.88	\$ 5,804,011
Expenditures	Services		\$9,741,002		\$ 10,542,721		\$ 11,699,864		\$ 1,157,142
	Supplies		\$1,922,502		\$ 2,051,297		\$ 1,833,497		\$ (217,800)
	Other		\$593,018		\$ 1,288,570		\$ 1,102,213		\$ (186,357)
	Capital		\$1,140,010		\$ 1,364,723		\$ 1,191,685		\$ (173,038)
	Total		\$ 108,018,889		\$ 113,725,760		\$ 120,109,718	5.61%	\$ 6,383,958

Motion: The School Committee votes the following budget of \$120,109,718 for Fiscal Year 2020.

2. Establish School Committee Expenditure Reporting Requirement

Motion: The School Committee requires all expenditures comply with Education Reform Act of 1993, The Uniform Massachusetts Accounting System (UMAS), The Department of Elementary

Fiscal Year 2020 Budget Request for the 2019 Annual Town Meeting (ATM)

and Secondary Education (DESE) Chart of Accounts reporting structure for the End of Year Report.¹ The expenditure accounts are to be structured in the following manner:

- Location:** Building/School Locations (e.g., District, Beep – Beacon, Baker, Lawrence, BHS)
- Program:** Regular Day, Special Education, Early Childhood, Ch 74 Vocational/Technical, English Language Education, Other Programs, Undistributed
- Deese Function Codes²:** 1000 – 9000
- UMAS³:** Object Codes that compliment/support the DESE Object Codes
- Subject:** e.g., Math, Science, ELA, Etc. (Brookline has partially implemented. Education reform requirement yet to be implemented by DESE for EOYR)
- Grade:** (Education reform requirement yet to be implemented by DESE for EOYR)

3. Approve FY 20 – FY23 Non-Aligned Pay Rates

The School Committee Negotiations Sub Committee will be reporting out on this item after consideration and review by March 7.

4. School Committee votes and authorizes Fiscal Year 2020 Revenue Sources

Program	Exp.	FY18 ACTUAL FTE EXP.	FY19 Budget STM FTE EXP.	FY20 BUDGET PRELIMINARY FTE EXP.	FY20 PRELIM Bud - FY19 Bud Variance FTE EXP.
School Dept. Revenues					
General Fund Appropriation		\$ 104,758,343	\$ 110,583,255	\$ 117,235,691	6.02% \$ 6,652,436
BHS Fee Based Busing			\$ 75,000		-100.00% \$ (75,000)
Total Town/School Partnership Revenue			\$ 110,658,255	\$ 117,235,691	5.95% \$ 6,577,436
Tuition and Fees		\$ 696,016	\$ 696,016	\$ 717,523	28.68% \$ 21,507
Facility Rental		\$ 225,000	\$ -	\$ -	* \$ -
Circuit Breaker Funding		\$ 1,873,044	\$ 1,688,705	\$ 1,769,814	4.80% \$ 81,109
Revolving Fund Reimbursement		\$ 50,680	\$ 150,680	\$ -	-100.00% \$ (150,680)
Other Revenue		\$ -	\$ 358,680	\$ -	-100.00% \$ (358,680)
Total Revenue:		\$ 107,603,083	\$ 113,552,336	\$ 119,723,028	5.43% \$ 6,170,692
Surplus/Deficit:		\$ (415,806)	\$ (173,424)	\$ (386,690)	
			*STM Budget Reduction to fund FY18 deficit		

Town Meeting Appropriation
BHS Fee Based Busing
School Department Revenue

Levy/Town Financial Plan
Levy/Town Financial Plan
Tuition and Fees
Facility Rental
Circuit Breaker
Revolving Fund Reimbursement
Other Revenue

Town/School Partnership
Warrant Article for Revolving Fund
Materials Fee/International Students
FY 19 moved to Revolving Fund
Circuit Breaker Reimbursement (state)
Eliminated FY 20
Eliminated FY 20

The deficit will be the responsibility of the School Committee to adjust the category of expenditures (Personnel, Services, Supplies, Other, Capital) prior to June 30, 2020 and close the fiscal year in balance. The deficit does not assume any ongoing or future subsidy for Athletics, Food Service, or any Federal, State, or Local Grant. Revolving Funds and Grants will have to reduce expenditures and not assume the operating budget will have funding available to cover the over expenditure due to reductions in grant awards or revenue collection.

¹ <http://www.doe.mass.edu/finance/accounting/compliance-supp.html>

² <http://www.doe.mass.edu/finance/accounting/eoy/chartofaccounts.docx>

³ <https://www.mass.gov/service-details/accounting-guidance-oversight-and-financial-management-publications>

5. Approve and Authorize FY 20 transfer to Public Health for Youth Services Substance Abuse Counselor

a. Option 1:

Motion: School Committee authorizes effective July 1 the transfer of \$61,048 for the purposes of funding a Substance Abuse Counselor in the FY 20 Public Health Budget.

b. Option 2

Motion: School Committee requests to revise the Town/School Partnership allocation to the Public Health Department from its original vote by reducing the School Department allocation by \$61,048 and permanently making available to Town Meeting to appropriate to the Public Health Department for the purposes of a Youth Services Substance Abuse Counselor position that has been a long standing transfer between the School Department and Public Health departments.

Background as printed in Town Financial Plan: "The Substance Abuse and Violence Prevention and Services for Youth Sub-program is designed to reduce substance abuse and violence among Brookline youth. The division provides counseling to Brookline youth with substance abuse problems and their families; prevention education; peer leadership training for the high school and elementary schools; consultation, trainings, and presentations to community members and service providers; and updated materials, information, and resources. Staffing for the Brookline Coalition Against Substance Abuse (B-CASA) and Brookline Parent Education Network (B-PEN) are provided through this division for related programs.

Substance Abuse

SUB-PROGRAM COSTS					
CLASS OF EXPENDITURES	ACTUAL FY2018	BUDGET FY2019	REQUEST FY2020	FY20 vs. FY19	
				\$ CHANGE	% CHANGE
Personnel	78,274	82,526	82,526	0	0.0%
Services	0	0	0	0	0.0%
Supplies	100	0	0	0	0.0%
Other	0	50	50	0	0.0%
Capital	0	0	0	0	0.0%
TOTAL	78,374	82,576	82,576	0	0.0%

FY 20 Objectives:

Substance Abuse and Violence Prevention for Youth

60. To promote the health and wellbeing of Brookline youth and provide alcohol, nicotine, marijuana and other drug prevention and intervention services to Brookline teens and their families.
61. To conduct an annual needs assessment, including the bi-annual student health survey and Community Wellness Summit, and track a set of measurable performance-based objectives.
62. To implement research based health promotion strategies to reduce the incidence of underage alcohol, marijuana and other drug use through the Brookline High School Peer Leaders and the Brookline Parent Education Network (B-PEN).
63. To provide confidential intervention services including consultation, counseling, referrals and the Youth Diversion Program for alcohol and other drug related problems, accessible to all Brookline youth and their families.
64. To maintain and enhance collaboration with the Public Schools of Brookline (PSB) and Police, to address youth substance abuse and violence prevention issues; serve on the BHS

Deans' Teams, the BHS Clinical Services Team, the Wellness Committee and the monthly Juvenile Roundtable.

65. To lead the Brookline High School Peer Leadership Program, recruiting 45 Peer Leaders to serve as positive role models in the community actively promoting healthy behaviors through presentations to 8th and 9th grade health classes, parent and community groups, and public health campaigns.

FY 19 Accomplishments:

Substance Abuse and Violence Prevention for Youth

60. Trained 45 peer leaders who implemented prevention strategies to address vaping and marijuana use, teen dating violence, mental health issues, and bullying/cyber bullying. Peer Leaders conducted over 56 health classes to PSB students in grades 8– 9, and 14 presentations to parent and community groups.
61. Applied for and was awarded a Brookline Community Fund \$25,000 grant for the Brookline Parent Education (B-PEN) Program to develop the division's capacity to reach a larger audience of youth and families with research based prevention programming targeting the problem of marijuana and other drug use and associated risk behaviors.
62. Implemented B-PEN (Brookline Parent Education Network), including the weekly B-PEN News Blasts, presentations at PTO meetings, community forums, parent discussion groups, and the B-PEN.org parent education website and Facebook page.
63. Program social workers with expertise in adolescent development provided 2280 hours of service to 264 youth substance abuse, including assessments, and individual, group, and family counseling through the BSAPP program. Serviced 71 youth in the Youth Diversion Program referred by with the Brookline schools and Police. Coordinated referral process for teens in need of treatment.
64. In collaboration with Watertown, Waltham and Belmont, applied for and was awarded alcohol prevention grant through the Massachusetts Department of Public Health, Bureau of Substance Abuse Prevention.
65. Conducted local needs assessment and created the annual action plan including analysis of the student health survey in collaboration with the PSB Information Services. Held the annual Wellness Summit bringing together 90 key community stakeholders to identify prevention strategies addressing identified student health issues."

6. FY 20 Grant Applications and Anticipated Awards

Annually the School Department submits grant applications for both entitlement and competitive grants. Federal and state grants, gifts, and donations to the School Committee shall be processed as specified by statute and donor requirements. These Special Revenue Funds are reported in the Grant Section of the School Committee Budget Book.

The School Committee Finance Sub Committee will be reporting out on this item after consideration and review by March 7.

7. FY 20 Revolving Fund Program Budgets

Revolving Fund accounts shall be under the direct control of the School Committee, which delegates the power to the Superintendent and/or School Business Administrator to authorize expenditures from them without further appropriation by the Town. All monies collected by the schools from fees, fines, admissions, and other non-tax sources shall be submitted to the Business Office, deposited with the Treasurer of the Town, and credited to the appropriate and authorized fund for expenditure.

The School Committee Finance Sub Committee will be reporting out on this item after consideration and review by March 7.

LEGAL REF.: M.G.L, Ch. 40 §3; Ch. 44, § 53, 53A, 53E 1/2.; Ch. 71, §17A, 26C, 37A, 47, 71, 71E, 71F; Ch. 548 of the Acts of 1948.

8. FY 20 Student Fees, Fines, and Charges

Educational Equity is a core value of the PSB:

The Public Schools of Brookline are committed to identifying and eliminating barriers to educational achievement in our schools. To this end, we create policies and practices that are fair and just and provide educational opportunities to ensure that every student, regardless of race, color, religion, gender, sexual orientation, marital status, age, national origin, disability, or economic status, meets our standards for achievement, participation, and growth.

In fulfillment of this value, this policy on student fees, fines, and charges commits the PSB to the following:

- Regardless of financial means, all PSB students shall have access to all educational books, materials, and other education-related opportunities;
- The PSB will engage in responsible financial management and practices to ensure the above can be made possible; and
- The financial operations of the district will be transparent in order to ensure accountability to these commitments.
- All students and families are treated with dignity in all discussion or disclosure of confidential information.

I. Establishing Fees

The School Committee reserves the right to establish fees for participation in certain activities and programs. Examples include, but are not limited to, field trips and community education, Brookline Early Education Program (BEEP), Summer School, student parking, and athletics.

Unless otherwise specified through School Committee action, each fee shall be established on a yearly basis for the next school year and communicated in a timely manner to students, parents, and/or guardians. Due dates and payment schedules for all fees will be established by the relevant program.

II. Collection of Fees, Fines, and Charges

A. Central Collection

This policy authorizes a centralized revenue collection and recording system for administration (charging and collecting) of Fees, Fines, and Charges. Such a system should provide efficiencies and transparency for parents and the community. Faculty and staff (e.g. departments, clubs, student organizations, etc.) shall use this system for administration of all fees, fines, and charges.

B. Non-Payment

Fiscal Year 2020 Budget Request for the 2019 Annual Town Meeting (ATM)

For fee-based activities, the School Committee expects that all fees will be paid in advance of participation unless the payor has been qualified for financial assistance by the Office of Administration and Finance pursuant to the policy on financial assistance.

If payment of any fee, fine, or charge is not received and the payor has been noticed in writing of the amount(s) due, the Superintendent or his/her designee may take one or more of the following actions, unless or until prohibited by state law or regulation:

1. Prohibit participation of the student in the relevant program.
2. Prohibit participation of the student or other students in the student's household from participating in any future fee-based program until or unless outstanding balances are resolved.
3. Prohibit student participation in senior activities or graduation exercises.
4. Referral to small claims court.

Legal Reference:

M.G.L. Chapter 71: Section 47. Athletic programs; school organizations; student activity accounts

M.G.L. Chapter 44: Section 69. Municipal or district services, fees or charges; insufficient funds checks; penalty

M.G.L. Chapter 60: Section 57A. Payment by check not duly paid; penalty

M.G.L. Chapter 93: Section 40A. Dishonored checks; demand for payment

M.G.L. Chapter 71, Section 49 Purchase of textbooks by pupils

Financial reporting for all fees occur in three areas, General Fund, Special Revenue Funds (known as Revolving Funds), and Agency Funds (commonly referred to as Student Activities).

General Fund Fees

Program	FY19 Fee	FY20 Fee	Reason for Change	Estimated Revenue
Transcripts				

Special Revenue Funds: Revolving Funds

The School Department receives fees and donations for various programs. A complete description of each revolving funds and a five year financial summary is available in the Revolving Funds section of the budget book. Below is a highlight of specific revolving funds that impact the calculation of the operating budget.

Revolving Fund Fee Summaries

Program	FY19 Fee	FY20 Fee	Reason for Change	Estimated Revenue
Athletics	- High School Sport: \$300 7/8 Grade Basketball: \$100 7/8 Grade Volleyball: \$85 7/8 Grade Indoor Soccer: \$85	- High School Sport: \$300 7/8 Grade Basketball: \$100 7/8 Grade Volleyball: \$85 7/8 Grade Indoor Soccer: \$85	No Change	
Materials fee Need to verify numbers	Materials Fee: \$2,888 Discount Per Add. Child: \$288.80	Materials Fee: \$2,974.64 Discount Per Add. Child: \$297.46	Expected 3% increase	\$750,000

Fiscal Year 2020 Budget Request for the 2019 Annual Town Meeting (ATM)

International Tuition (SEVIS) 1 year Exchange	\$20,632 per student plus Lunch, Breakfast, other student fees, fines, and charges.	\$21,230 per student plus Lunch, Breakfast, other student fees, fines, and charges.	\$598	Unknown Number of students for FY 20.
S. Brookline Bus Transportation	User Fee ▪ Cost per Day/Fee: \$400 ▪ Days/payers: 120	User Fee ▪ Cost per Day/Fee: \$400 ▪ Days/payers: 120		\$60,000
Beep Tuition	Preschool \$10,488 Pre-K \$10,488 Pre-K Extended Days 2 Days Until 3:00PM \$2,667 Until 5:45PM \$4,461 3 Days Until 3:00PM \$4,001 Until 5:45PM \$6,691 5 Days Until 3:00PM \$6,669 Until 5:45PM \$11,153	Preschool \$10,488 Pre-K \$10,488 Pre-K Extended Days 2 Days Until 3:00PM \$2,667 Until 5:45PM \$4,461 3 Days Until 3:00PM \$4,001 Until 5:45PM \$6,691 5 Days Until 3:00PM \$6,669 Until 5:45PM \$11,153	No Change	\$XXX
School Lunch	K-8 Breakfast \$1.75 Lunch \$3.25 High School Breakfast \$1.75 Lunch \$3.50 Premium Lunch \$4.25 Dairy/Lactaid Milk \$0.75 Soy Milk \$1.50 100% Juice \$0.50 Reduced Price Breakfast \$0.30 Lunch \$0.40	K-8 Breakfast \$2.00 Lunch \$3.05 High School Breakfast \$2.00 Lunch \$3.75 Premium Lunch \$4.50-\$8.00 Dairy/Lactaid Milk \$0.75 Soy Milk \$1.50 100% Juice \$0.50 Reduced Price Breakfast \$0.30 Lunch \$0.40	Increased by \$0.25	
Summer school Programs (BHS)	2 Hour Class: Brookline Resident \$310 Non-resident \$350 Financial Aid \$60 4 Hour Class: Brookline Resident \$575 Non-resident \$625 Financial Aid \$120	2 Hour Class: Brookline Resident \$310 Non-resident \$350 Financial Aid \$60 4 Hour Class: Brookline Resident \$575 Non-resident \$625 Financial Aid \$120	No Change	
Summer school Programs (elementary) Project Achieve Discovery and Explore	▪ Project Achieve \$400 ▪ Project Discovery \$400 ▪ Project Explore \$400	▪ Project Achieve \$400 ▪ Project Discovery \$400 ▪ Project Explore \$400	Proposal to Eliminate Fee and charge to operating budget	\$0
BACE	Adult Programs \$6-\$324 Children's Programs \$50-\$350 Music Lessons \$459-\$718	Adult Programs \$6-\$324 Children's Programs \$50-\$350 Music Lessons \$459-\$718		

Agency Funds: Student Activities

Student Activities Fund Summaries: In 1996, due to the enactment of a state law on student activity accounts as codified in Section 47 of Chapter 71 of the General Laws of Massachusetts (MGL), the Public Schools of Brookline (PSB) prepared guidelines to assist Principals in properly safeguarding student funds. These guidelines and procedures which are currently undergoing extensive review and updates are necessary to achieve good accounting practices, and comply with the law.

The financial monitoring of these funds is undergoing a full overhaul and audit to comply with the latest regulations. New policies and procedures are being finalized during school year 2019-2020 to ensure compliance and improve reporting, reconciliations, and routine audits of these accounts. These funds are student funds and are restricted to the following formula:

$$\text{Formula for determining costs: } \frac{\text{Total costs of all expenses (tickets, transportation, meals, etc)}}{\text{\# of Students Attending}}$$

The Number of Student attending is not reduced by any financial assistance students. These students are funded from other sources determined by the Principal. Additional funding has been added to elementary school principal budgets for the purpose of funding financial assistance eligible students. Funds can only be used to directly benefit students. Use of funds for curriculum supplies, materials, or personnel are prohibited by statute.

Program	FY18 Fee	FY19 Fee	Reason for Change	Estimated Revenue
Field Trips and Extracurricular Activities	Student Activities: Costs are calculated for total cost of providing experience divided by the number of students attending.	Student Activities: Costs are calculated for total cost of providing experience divided by the number of students attending.	No Change	At Cost

9. FY 20 Warrant Article Proposals:

School Bus Transportation Revolving Funds {Chapter 44: Section 53 ½ }⁴

Submitted by: School Committee

MOTION:

Option 1: To see if the Town will authorize the following revolving fund limit for certain Town departments pursuant to the provisions of M.G.L. Chapter 44, Section 53E ½ for Fiscal Year 2019 beginning July 1, 2019. Annual expenditures from the fund shall not exceed \$150,000

Program or Purpose for Revolving Funds	FY2019 Authorization
School Bus Transportation	\$150,000

Option 2: To see if the Town will vote, pursuant to Chapter 44, Section 53E1/2 and of the Massachusetts General Laws and Chapter____ of the Code of the Town of Brookline, to continue existing revolving funds; to establish new revolving funds; to determine whether the maximum amounts that may be expended from such new and existing revolving fund accounts in FY2019 shall be the following amounts or any other amounts; or act in any other manner in relation thereto.

⁴ <https://malegislature.gov/Laws/GeneralLaws/PartI/TitleVII/Chapter44/Section53E1~2>

Program or Purpose for Revolving Funds	FY2019 Authorization
School Bus Transportation	\$150,000

DESCRIPTION: A revolving fund established under the provision of Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 44, Section 53E1/2 must be approved annually by vote of the Town Meeting. The Funds are credited with the receipts received in connection with the programs supported by such funds, and expenditures may be made from the revolving fund without further appropriation.

Special Education Stabilization Fund {Section 24 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016}⁵

Submitted by: School Committee

The Special Education Stabilization Fund is being established to provide for extraordinary need in special education tuition and transportation expenses. The fund is restricted to special education, out of district tuition, and specialized transportation expenditures that exceed the district's operating budget and require regular education programs to be severely impacted by the budget deficit. The fund will begin with \$_____ transfer from the FY_____ School Department operating budget voted at the {Date} School Committee Meeting. Section 24 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016 provides for the establishment of a Special Education Stabilization fund. The law enables municipal and regional districts to establish a reserve fund that can be used in future years for unanticipated or unbudgeted costs of special education, out of district tuition or transportation.

MOTION:

That the Town establish a Special Education Stabilization Fund as allowed under Section 24 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016 provides for the establishment of a Special Education Stabilization fund, for the purpose of funding extraordinary need in special education, out of district tuition, and specialized transportation expenses.

Appendix

Chapter 44: Section 53E 1/2. Revolving funds

[Text of section as amended by 2016, 218, Sec. 86 effective November 7, 2016.]

Section 53E 1/2. Notwithstanding section 53, a city or town may authorize by by-law or ordinance the use of 1 or more revolving funds by 1 or more municipal agencies, boards, departments or offices, which shall be accounted for separately from all other monies in the city or town and to which shall be credited any fees, charges or other receipts from the departmental programs or activities supported by the revolving fund. Expenditures may be made from such revolving fund without further appropriation, subject to the provisions of this section; provided, however, that expenditures shall not be made or liabilities incurred from any such revolving fund in excess of the balance of the fund or in excess of the total authorized expenditures from such fund, and no expenditures shall be made unless approved in accordance with sections 41, 42, 52 and 56 of chapter 41.

Interest earned on any revolving fund balance shall be treated as general fund revenue of the city or town. No revolving fund may be established under this section for receipts of a municipal water or sewer department, a municipal hospital, a cable television access service or facility or for receipts reserved by law or as authorized by law for expenditure for a particular purpose.

⁵ <https://malegislature.gov/Laws/SessionLaws/Acts/2016/Chapter218>

Revolving fund expenditures shall not be made to pay wages or salaries for full-time employees unless the revolving fund is also charged for the costs of fringe benefits associated with the wages or salaries so paid; provided, however, that such prohibition shall not apply to wages or salaries paid to full-time or part-time employees who are employed as drivers providing transportation for public school students; provided further, that only that portion of a revolving fund which is attributable to transportation fees may be used to pay the wages or salaries of those employees who are employed as drivers providing transportation for public school students; and provided further, that any such wages or salaries so paid shall be reported in the budget submitted for the next fiscal year.

A revolving fund shall be established pursuant to this section by by-law or ordinance. The by-law or ordinance shall specify for each fund: (1) the programs or activities for which the revolving fund may be expended; (2) the departmental receipts in connection with those programs or activities that shall be credited to the revolving fund; (3) the board, department or officer authorized to expend from such fund; and (4) any reporting or other requirements the city or town may impose. The establishment of any fund shall be made not later than the beginning of the fiscal year in which the fund shall begin. Notwithstanding this section, whenever, during the course of any fiscal year, any new revenue source becomes available for the establishment of a revolving fund under this section, such a fund may be established in accordance with this section upon certification by the city auditor, town accountant, or other officer having similar duties that the revenue source was not used in computing the most recent tax levy.

The city or town shall, on or before July 1 of each year, vote on the limit on the total amount that may be expended from each revolving fund established under this section. In any fiscal year, the limit on the amount that may be spent from a revolving fund may be increased with the approval of the city council and mayor in a city or with the approval of the board of selectmen and finance committee in a town.

Upon termination of a revolving fund, the balance in the fund at the end of that fiscal year shall revert to surplus revenue at the close of the fiscal year.

The director of accounts may issue guidelines further regulating revolving funds established pursuant to this section.

Section 24 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016

SECTION 24. Said chapter 40 is hereby further amended by inserting after section 13D the following section:-

Section 13E. Any school district which accepts this section, by a majority vote of the school committee and a majority vote of the legislative body or, in the case of a regional school district by a majority vote of the legislative bodies in a majority of the member communities of the district, may establish and appropriate or transfer money to a reserve fund to be utilized in the upcoming fiscal years, to pay, without further appropriation, for unanticipated or unbudgeted costs of special education, out-of-district tuition or transportation. The balance in such reserve fund shall not exceed 2 per cent of the annual net school spending of the school district.

Funds shall only be distributed from the reserve funds after a majority vote of the school committee and a majority vote of the board of selectman or city council, or, in the case of a regional school district by a majority vote of the board of selectmen or city council in a majority of the member communities of the district.

The district treasurer may invest the monies in the manner authorized in section 54 of chapter 44 and any interest earned thereon shall be credited to and become part of the fund.

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

School Committee Presentation
February 28, 2019

1

We need to be more systematic about how we use data to inform our practice and make decisions about learning, programs, practices, and budget.

Tonight's Presentation

1. **District-wide Assessments** - What Brookline and Peer Districts Do
2. **Benchmark Assessment System** - PSB's only multigrade district-wide assessment
 - What is it
 - Recent results reinforce the district's persistent pattern
 - Teacher input on BAS - How they use it, how they find it valuable
3. **Developing a Culture of Using Data to Inform Decision Making and Support Students** - Examples from Coolidge Corner and Pierce
4. **Informing our Practice and Decision Making** - How a culture of using data systematically helps

3

District-wide Assessments *Brookline and Peer Districts*

4

What Student Achievement Data does PSB Collect Across All Schools?

- **K-5**
 - BAS (ELA)
 - Kindergarten Literacy Assessment (ELA)
- **Middle School**
 - BAS (ELA) - Only done with a subset of students.

*The number of times these assessments are given vary by grade level

5

Newton

- **K-5**
 - BAS (ELA)
 - Gates-MacGinitie Reading Test (ELA)
 - District-wide Common Math assessments from AMC curriculum.
- **Middle School**
 - Gates-MacGinitie Reading Test (ELA)
 - Districtwide Common Writing Assessment

*The number of times these assessments are given vary by grade level

6

Cambridge

Full K-8 District-wide Assessment Calendar that Includes:

- FAST Screeners (ELA and Math)
- Writing Assessments or Literary Essay (ELA)
- Reading Benchmark Assessments (ELA)
- Kathy Richardson's Kindergarten Assessment (Math)
- Project-Based Question Essay (History/Social Studies)
- Project-Based Assessment (History/Social Studies)
- Pre and Post Assessment (History/Social Studies)
- District-wide Common Unit assessments in accordance with curriculum map and pacing guides (ELA, Math, Science)
- District-wide Common Interim assessments (ELA and Math)

*The number of times these assessments are given vary by grade level

**Some assessments are optional

7

Wellesley

K-5

- BAS (ELA)
- Dibels (ELA)
- District developed Math benchmark system (Math)

All Grade Levels

- District-wide common assessments at all grade levels in Multiple Content Areas

Use Data Wise approach system-wide for analysis, intervention, and reassessment

*The number of times these assessments are given vary by grade level

8

Lexington

K-5

- BAS (ELA)
- Aimsweb (ELA)
- Common Writing Prompts (ELA)
- Assessment Math Concepts [AMC] (Math)
- Local common assessment (Math)

Middle School

- Common unit assessments across all courses (Math)

*The number of times these assessments are given vary by grade level

Benchmark Assessment System (BAS)

- Looking More closely at our one assessment that is used across multiple grades
- Recent Results: Persistent Gaps
- Teachers Perceptions of the BAS

Benchmark Assessment System (BAS)

What is the BAS?

Teachers and specialists use precise tools and texts to observe and quantify specific reading behaviors. They interpret and use the data to plan meaningful instruction.

Process:

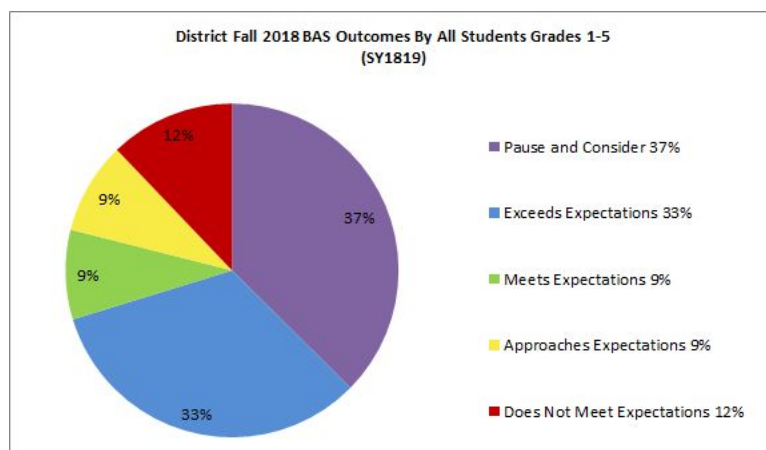
- Teachers meet individually with students to:
 - Observe student reading behaviors
 - Engage in comprehension conversations that go beyond retelling
- Teachers use information from the reading conversation to;
 - Determine instructional and independent reading levels
 - Make informed decisions to connect assessment to instruction

What's New?

- We are transitioning to the BAS-3rd Edition, which will allow for deeper understanding of student comprehension.
- Next school year we will begin to use the Benchmark levels introduced in 2012. (Brookline currently uses the lower expectations from the pre-2012 Benchmark levels.)

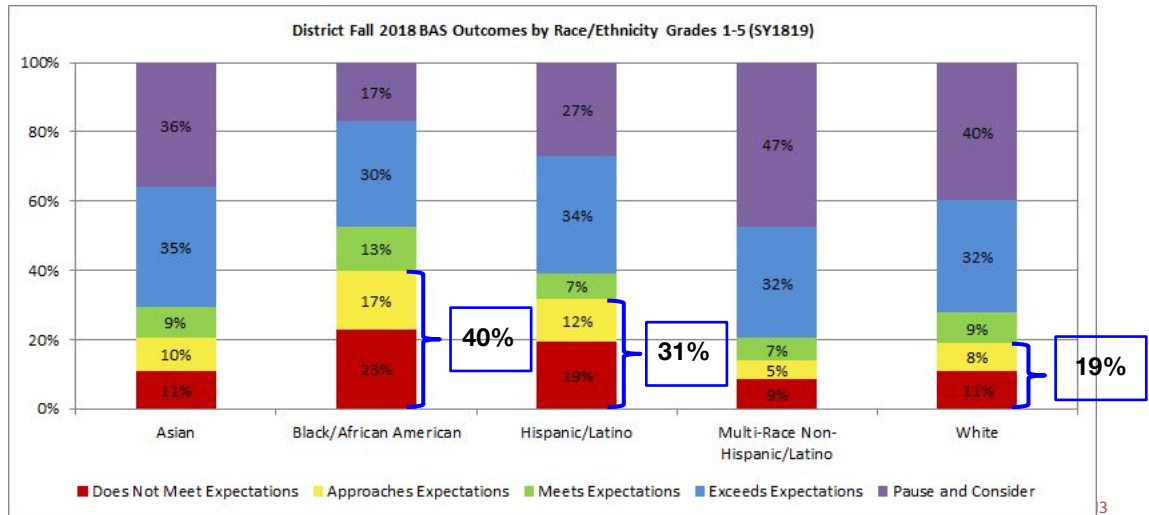
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BAS Assessment Results: Fall 2018

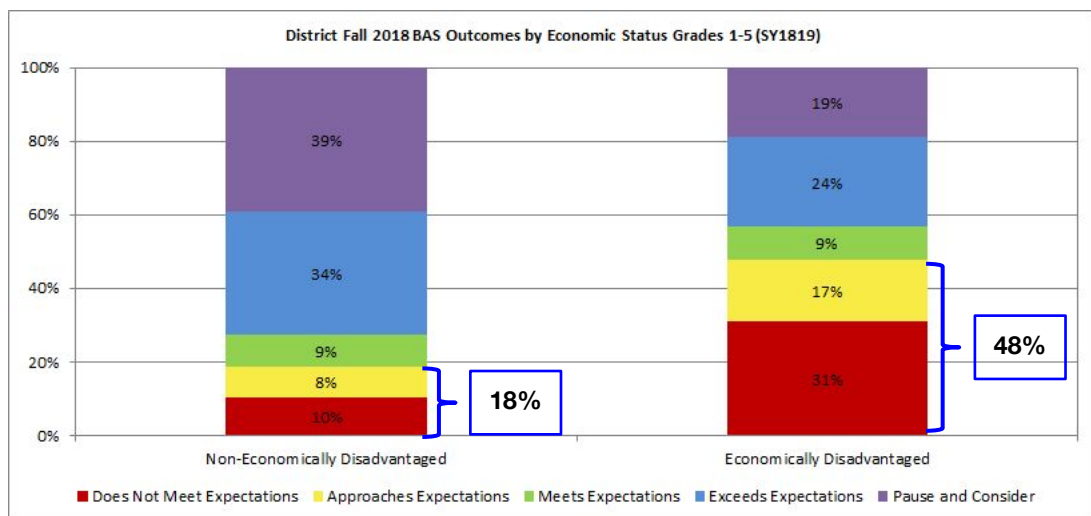


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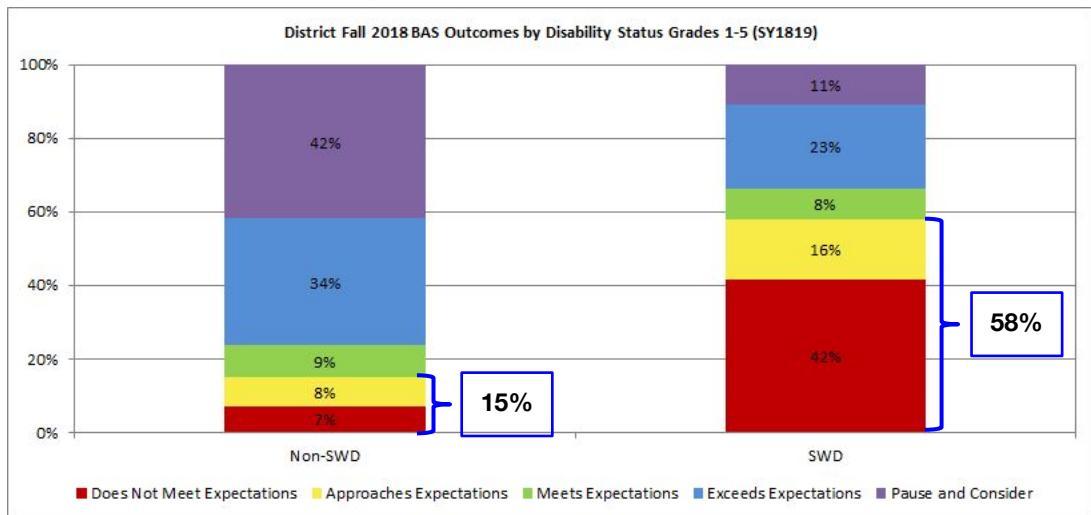
BAS Test Results by Race/Ethnicity: Fall 2018



BAS Assessment Results by Economic Status: Fall 2018



BAS Assessment Results by Special Education Status: Fall 2018



What are teachers saying about the BAS?

Results from BAS Teacher Survey: Fall 2018

How do you currently use the BAS? (214 educators responded out of ~275 who work with BAS)

- Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels (88.8%)
- Document student progress (84.1%)
- Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction (74.3%)
- Observe and quantify student reading behaviors (68.7%)
- Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals (61.7%)
- Confirm teacher professional judgment (46.7%)
- Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels (45.8%)
- BAS data are not helpful to my practice (4.2%)

What are teachers saying about the BAS?

Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors?

- Yes! Analyzing the BAS information gives me valuable information about how a reader is processing information within, beyond, and about the text, which leads to creating goals that will be carried out in guided reading groups. **Grade 3-5 Teacher**
- Yes. By analyzing students abilities to answer questions within the text, about the text and beyond the text, and by documenting their progress, I am able to create their attainable IEP goals and work on the benchmarks. - **Special Educator**
- Administering the BAS gives me a read on student confidence levels related to reading, as well as to sight word knowledge. - **Grade K-2 Teacher**
- The BAS gives me a snapshot of a student's reading behaviors (inferencing, using text evidence to support ideas, ability to give a sequential retelling, etc) at that time. The BAS helps me understand the reading profiles in my classroom, but I don't feel that it specifically informs instruction because we don't implement guided reading at the middle school level. - **Grade 6-8 ELA Teacher**
- I use it to monitor students' progress, particularly relative areas of strength and weakness, from year to year in order to inform ICAP and 504 plan development. - **Guidance Counselor**

What are teachers saying about the BAS?

Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?

- Is there a way to track student's reading mid-way through the year and then again at the end of the year rather than do another BAS in February? Can we use another measure instead of the BAS for a mid-way check? **Grade 3-5 Teacher**
- More of a range of assessments through general ed - some students just don't test well on the BAS so it doesn't show their true ability -- **Special Educator**
- I like giving the BAS myself as the classroom teacher. The biggest issue, though, is finding the time to administer the assessment. It is a lot of time away from teaching. Reading specialists could help cover for classroom teachers during the first few weeks of school so that the assessment can get done early AND time in the classroom is about learning something valuable instead of busy work with a sub? **Grade K-2 Teacher**
- For older students struggling with decoding, is there a district assessment for assessing those students? **Special Educator**
- District should upload our BAS data directly into the progress reports! - **Grade 3-5 Teacher**
- More information on how to use the BAS to inform practice - **Grade 3-5 Teacher**
- For older students who enter our system, is there a phonics assessment tool we could use to catch any important gaps, or to see where they are in general? - **EL Teacher**

How Two Schools are Using Data to Inform Decision Making and Support Students

- Co-Interim Principal Jennifer Buller: Coolidge Corner
- Principal Lesley Ryan Miller: Pierce

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How Coolidge Corner School Uses the BAS

School Year 2017-18 Grades 1-4

- Grade level teams drilled into Mid Year BAS results to see exactly where students were struggling
- Intervention for students were discussed and selected based on the BAS outcomes
- Teachers worked with Literacy Coaches if they needed support on how to provide specific in class interventions
- Teachers decided to complete another round of BAS to determine if the selected intervention was having a positive impact

Grade	Mid Year 2018 BAS_Category	EOY 2018 BAS_Category
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Does Not Meet Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Does Not Meet Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Meets Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Exceeds Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Exceeds Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Approaches Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Exceeds Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Meets Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Exceeds Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Exceeds Expectations
1	not assessed	Meets Expectations
1	not assessed	Does Not Meet Expectations
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Does Not Meet Expectations
1	Approaches Expectations	Exceeds Expectations
1	Approaches Expectations	Exceeds Expectations
1	Approaches Expectations	Exceeds Expectations
1	Approaches Expectations	Meets Expectations
1	Approaches Expectations	Exceeds Expectations

Grade 1 Results:

Of the 11 students who scored "Does Not Meet" in the Mid Year, 5 of them moved to "Exceeds", and 2 moved to "Meet" performance levels by the EOY.

Of the 5 students who scored "Approaches" in the Mid Year, 4 of them moved to "Exceeds", and 1 moved to "Meet" performance levels by the EOY.

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Pierce School - Developing a Culture of Data-Based Decision Making

How Pierce has used data to make decisions since 2017-18

- Introduced Data Wise process
- Started with data that teachers were interested in (enrollment data)
- Used Data Wise process with entire faculty to develop 2018-19 School Improvement Plan
- Identified literacy as our school-wide focus
- Grade level teams identified specific literacy challenges their students faced
- Now looking at behavior and student conduct data to identify patterns and learn where students need support

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Pierce School - Developing a Culture of Data-Based Decision Making

Using Data to Make Decisions is Making Pierce's Culture More Collaborative

- Using data helps us decide together what our priorities are
- Teachers are more involved in decision making and leadership
- Gives teachers more voice and a greater sense of ownership
- Grade level teams worked together to identify their student needs instead of having someone else tell them
- All educators involved in school improvement planning
- Teachers are asking for more data so they can have a better sense of what is happening for individual students and groups of students, and to help them improve their practice

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A culture of using data systematically can help
inform our practice and improve our decision
making

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An ongoing practice of using data systematically will help us:

- Understand why we have inequitable student outcomes and identify and implement effective responses
- Make thoughtful decisions on what we should start, continue, or stop doing
- Understand if we are allocating resources (money, people, and time) in ways that best impact student learning
- Determine if our programs and interventions are helping students reach the program's intended outcomes
- Understand persistent challenges and learn how to address them
- Monitor implementation and adjust and improve as necessary
- Understand student needs before summative assessments so teachers can provide support earlier

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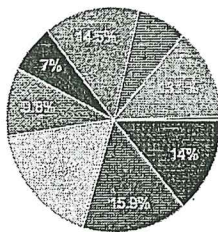
February 28, 2019

Executive Summary: Benchmark Assessment System (BAS) Survey

On October 23, 2018 during faculty meeting time, all schools administered the BAS Survey. There are fewer responses from Pierce and Lawrence because they ran out of time at the end of their faculty meetings.

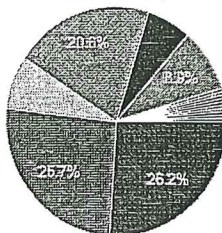
Principals asked that only educators who actually administer the BAS complete the survey so that the data collection included only educators who have first-hand knowledge and experience with the BAS. Across all eight K - 8 Schools, 214 educators responded.

My home school is:
214 responses



- Baker
- CCS
- Driscoll
- Heath
- Lawrence
- Lincoln
- Pierce
- Runkle
- TEST

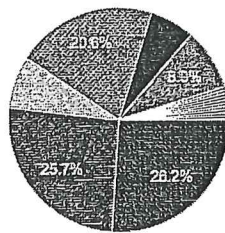
My current role is:
214 responses



- Grades K-2 Teacher
- Grades 3-5 Teacher
- Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher
- Special Educator
- Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teach...
- Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/...
- Prefer not to identify my role
- both 6-8 teacher and literacy coach

My current role is:

214 responses



- Grade 6-8 Social Studies
- 6-8 Social Studies Teacher
- Guidance Counselor
- teacher
- Science Teacher
- Vice Principal
- guidance
- Admin

▲ 2/2

The survey asked, and educators provided the following responses:

1. How do you currently use the BAS?
 - Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels (88.8%)
 - Observe and quantify student reading behaviors (68.7%)
 - Document student progress (84.1%)
 - Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction (74.3%)
 - Confirm teacher professional judgment (46.7%)
 - Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels (45.8%)
 - BAS data are not helpful to my practice (4.2%)
 - Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals (61.7%)
2. Does the BAS provide you additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? (214 responses)

Overwhelmingly educators indicate that BAS data helps to support with placing students in reading peer groups. Educators also indicate that BAS helps them to identify how they should focus their reading instruction with students. For specified populations, educators also use BAS data to learn whether or not students have or are regressing and may need to be referred for ESY or other support opportunities and whether or not students who are fluent in reading actually comprehend what they are reading--which some educators have found to be true of their EL students. Finally educators indicate that BAS helps teachers to differentiate different types of reading comprehension.

3. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district? (213 responses)

For the most part, educators did not have suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy. Those who had recommendations for improvement, believe that changing the assessment window, increasing the frequency of using BAS, having educators across content areas share in the responsibility for assessing student reading so that they have literacy information that is necessary for their instruction as well. Some teachers felt that BAS data should be uploaded directly into progress reports. There was a sentiment that educators need professional development to learn more ways to use BAS to inform

instruction. There was also an emerging theme that indicated that educators need/want more time to assess students and discuss results with colleagues. There were a few educators who want to consider another assessment that does not have subjective scoring; or another assessment that can be used for students who do not show their skills well on BAS.

Of all of the educator respondents, none indicated that they do not feel that it is important to assess students' literacy skills. Many indicated that they would like to have an opportunity to assess students more frequently in an effort to ensure that as student placement in reading groups is more fluid and responsive to their progress and ever changing literacy needs.

BAS Survey - October 2018

	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
1	Prefer not to identify my role	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	The is a test		
2	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	BAS gives me a general idea of what skills students may need to work on at their instructional levels. It helps me to group students for instruction and gives me some ideas of lessons that I definitely need to teach with specific skills to address.	Conduct beginning of year tests only with students who we are documented to possibly need support or are borderline, not with all students -- ie. not with those who are already at Pause and Consider since they are already great readers for our grade levels. These are time consuming tests that are hard to conduct at beginning of the year when establishing classroom culture, routines and procedures. Perhaps, there could be two testing windows? An early one for kids who will probably need LLI and other services and a later one -- closer to conferences, maybe -- for those whose reading we are not worried about.	
3	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	...	Often times the sub coverage availability isn't enough or conducive with a middle school schedule. I end up losing my prep times or it overlaps with consults or team meetings. To make up for this, I end up using other class times to complete the assessments. My other content area colleagues do not have to face this challenge. I also become the only stake holder in the assessments. I share the results, but I'm not sure how much that informs my colleagues' instruction. If perhaps they took on some of the reading assessments they may have an understanding of specific reading behaviors that students have, so ELA teachers aren't bearing the entire load.	
4	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	BAS allows me to compare and group students with similar needs into effective instruction that will my guided reading groups	For older students struggling with decoding, is there a district assessment for assessing those students?	
5	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It's good to have the opportunity to sit one-on-one with each student.	District should upload our BAS data directly into the progress reports!	
6	both 6-8 teacher and literacy coach	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes - fluency (repetitions, self-corrections, M-S-V) help me understand what readers might be working on	no	
7	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	No	NO	
8	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It also helps to plan for Guided Reading instruction.	Not at this moment.	
9	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps me see how the student reads and better teach them.	I find it to be very helpful the way that it is.	

BAS Survey - October 2018

	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
10	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Shows reading skills and habits	More information on how to use the BAS to inform practice	
11	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	As a special education teacher, it also helps to determine whether students have regressed (in regards to their reading levels) over the summer, which is helpful in determining eligibility for ESY.	No	
12	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, BAS data helps us create guided reading groups that are leveled, so we can work towards certain, targeted goals. Then, in a small group setting, we are able to observe our students reading behaviors.	The assessment process is long. I am not sure how to improve upon that piece of the process.	
13	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps me to give book suggestions and what skills to focus on in guided reading groups. I think BAS is a very useful snapshot.	I think it's going pretty well. A third half day to assess would be helpful or allowing us to assess. This would help us assess all our students because that one on one reading time is helpful and I wish I could assess all my students.	
14	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Helps identify reading goals	No	
15	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Differentiate student's strengths and weaknesses. Many EL students are good at decoding but lacking in comprehension.	I think current system works well.	
16	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	The BAS helps me determine if some targeted skills are being generalized by students.	No	
17	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It is helpful that the BAS breaks down the different kinds of comprehension	No	
18	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, the BAS is used to provide information about student independent reading levels and instructional needs. In IEP meetings and for IEP documents, the BAS is referred to indirectly (benchmark reading assessment) to gain information regarding the general education reading level. The BAS is also used to help group students in pull-out interventions (as well as push-in support within the classroom).	I think we need more frequent literacy assessments that measure students' progress (like Dibels) to measure students' reading of connected text across the year. We rarely have time to assess students (I use my lunch and prep) and infrequently have time to talk about BAS results.	
19	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress	Sometimes a need for additional vocabulary study	It's time consuming but I don't know how yo improve that.	
20	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	no	no	

BAS Survey - October 2018

	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
21	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It is useful to analyze student's mistakes so inform instruction. Are they using meaning, structure or visual information?	Teachers may need more time to administer assessments and plan from them once BAS 3 is adopted district wide.	
22	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	Yes. Decoding info, vocab gaps, student attention to context.	For older students who enter our system, is there a phonics assessment tool we could use to catch any important gaps, or to see where they are in general?	
23	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I am a Reading Recovery teacher so do not use BAS to assess my students but I do communicate with classroom teachers and those that administer BAS to ensure that it is consistent with my findings. It is helpful for classroom teachers to use in order to form groupings.	I believe that teachers need to understand that BAS is a small snapshot of the student. BAS can be very telling regarding reading strategies but students should not be stagnant and placed in a group without constant movement - groups should be flexible. I believe there is much more weight in running records and using this to frequently judge where students are reading. Cold reads are just as valuable to determine where a student is reading. We should have an idea of where students are and not be looking at a BAS score 6 weeks prior.	
24	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	I use the data to create flexible Guided Reading groups.	I believe that the BAS window needs to be changed. We should be assessing students closer to the end of the school year.	
25	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	It's helpful in September to make reading groups. I do not think it is helpful in the spring, as I have been working with my students for months and I know their levels. The data I get in September from the spring BAS window is not helpful as it is so outdated, I have to start fresh.	no	
26	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	no	Special educators are unable to access their students' data in any digital format. We do not have access to spreadsheets and must rely on tracking down folders from individual teachers, which makes it difficult to integrate BAS data meaningfully into our practice.	
27	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	No	Other assessments where the comprehension scores or not so subjective based on who scores it.	
28	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes. I am able to see student behaviors when it comes to reading; confidence, background knowledge, comfort.	Begin earlier in K?	
29	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, to look at trends across the school and cohorts	I'm not really sure what this question is asking...	It would be good to have a better understanding of the other assessments that are part of the BAS and how they can be used to understand a reader better and plan instruction. I also believe that we need an independent phonics screener for students in grades 2-8 to use on a case by case basis when we have students who present with difficulties in decoding and encoding.	
30	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	Helpful for creating leveled book groups	N/A	

BAS Survey - October 2018

	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
31	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps me to identify gaps and areas of confusion	Are there other progress monitoring tools and/or intervention resources other than LLI available in the district?	
32	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps me break down decoding, fluency and comprehension. I like the back and forth between fiction and nonfiction.	I like giving the BAS myself as the classroom teacher. The biggest issue, though, is finding the time to administer the assessment. It is a lot of time away from teaching. Why aren't the reading specialists asked and scheduled to cover for classroom teachers during the first few weeks of school so that the assessment can get done early AND time in the classroom is about learning something valuable instead of busy work with a sub? This year subs didn't even show up to cover all of the BAS half days. The two BAS half days are not enough time to do the assessments. Reading specialists appear to have more time than classroom teachers at the start of the year and this could be a good way of getting the assessments done in a timely manner. If you do this, please schedule it for us instead of making it something we need to request in a less structured way.	
33	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	It helps me to identify decoding challenges/ trouble spots.	If possible a larger window for BAS testing	
34	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	No	There needs to be a decoding assessment to separate that skill from comprehension.	
35	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, determine reading groups	Helps me see areas to target (fluency, comprehension, decoding, monitoring), lets me see how they read fiction vs non-fiction	Not logging data by hand and in a spread sheet, if I already write it on the spread sheet and it is shared with next year's teacher, I shouldn't need to handwrite it on the face sheet as well	
36	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	I consult with classroom teachers on reading levels	n/a	n/a	
37	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	Yes, what they are understanding when they are reading (ie: literal and inferential comprehension).	N/A	
38	Special Educator	Document student progress, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps me to identify what types of comprehension questions students have difficulty with (literal or inferential)	More of a range of assessments through general ed - some students just don't test well on the BAS so it doesn't show their true ability	
39	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, Used to compare students to national standards for the purpose of report cards, CST, IEPs, parent communication	Create small groups and reading goals (Can look at how students do on particular questions to inform the goals)	At Lincoln, I think we are in a good place on this. Everyone pitches in! Teachers use the data thoughtfully. I would encourage the district to think about training long term subs on the BAS as I think they would welcome the opportunity and it would take some of the pressure off other adults in the building.	
40	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors	The BAS helps me track words per minute and track student's fluency/rate. It also gives teachers time to listen 1:1 with students and track their reading behaviors.	Is there a way to track student's reading mid-way through the year and then again at the end of the year rather than do another BAS in February? Can we use another measure instead of the BAS for a mid-way check?	
41	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	I feel like I get a sense of skills that students need to work on when I meet with them during reading workshop. I can see if students are making progress, help them choose books.	I do not have any suggestions.	

BAS Survey - October 2018

	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
42	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Helpful to note on IEP to track progress	More reading aloud in class	
43	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I've modeled questions on assessments about whole-class text after the three levels of BAS questioning.	Fewer students to assess OR more trained staff to help with assessments (idea: paying retired teachers to assist) would improve the quality of each assessment and ensure all students listed would be assessed before the data is due. Middle school texts in the BAS kit can take about 20 minutes EACH after the reading and comprehension conversation, and most students read between 2-3 texts, which makes it nearly impossible (a.k.a. quite stressful) to assess all students on our lists in the time allotted for sub days (2 half days)	
44	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes! Analyzing the BAS information give me valuable information about how a reader is processing information within, beyond, and about the text, which leads to creating goals that will be carried out in guided reading groups.	Provide extra time for teachers to analyze BAS data to launch guided reading groups and make a plan for instruction. (Lincoln does this and it's great!)	
45	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	n/a	no	
46	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes- having a designated time to read one-on-one with students is invaluable. Important to hear their oral reading and thinking about reading.	give more time to administer... maybe literacy specialists teach our class when we assess	
47	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, Inform the creation of guided reading groups	Administering the BAS gives me a read on student confidence levels related to reading, as well as to sight word knowledge.	It would be helpful to have common texts and corresponding running records available to use for informal assessment.	
48	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress	As a special educator it does and it doesn't because I have formal reading assessments that dive deeper than the BAS	No	
49	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	it helps me to make effective reading groups with targeted goals.	Having more literacy specialists available to teach our classes while we administer the BAS would make it a smoother process.	
50	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, assist in creating small reading groups with kids who have similar skills	Assist in grouping students for small reading groups. Assist in identifying students to "keep on my radar" or students who would benefit from Tier 2 interventions.	Some Newton schools use a system where the literacy specialists within a school descend upon a classroom for 1 hour and attempt to complete as many (if not all of) the classroom's assessments 2x per year. The teachers sign up for one hour. Because students are assessed so early, reading groups and instruction can begin at a much earlier point in the school year.	
51	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels	I'm new to the BAS.	Not sure	
52	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, the BAS helps me to group students based on their reading behaviors/needs. BAS also helps me to see what level of books I should be sending my students to read to help them find just right books. In addition, it helps me to set independent reading goals with students.	I think we should have more time outside of the classroom to complete the BAS assessments. One day is too quick for 22+ students.	

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	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
53	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	Provides insight into students' thinking as they read, helps understand specific areas of need for instruction.	Have specialists assist in the process	
54	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	At the kindergarten level the most important information that we use BAS data is to observe and qualify students reading behaviors and to document progress especially as resend our students to first grade.	Even though it is time consuming to administer, I feel that this tool gives teachers significant information. I find it very helpful.	
55	Grades 3-5 Teacher	BAS data are not helpful to my practice, In case of 1/3 of class it is helpful for observing reading behaviors.	What helps the most is seeing when a child is skipping words, inserting words, misreading a word by substituting or dropping letters. This affects 1/4 of students. The other parts of assessment: the answers to questions is easy to see in the course of daily instruction, so is usually not informative.	BAS is helpful for 1/3 of class. Spending time on understanding MCAS data from year before helps. I know it has a bad reputation, but it really does tell you quite a bit.	
56	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	N/A	N/A - Yearly handouts and e-mail reminders (from literacy specialist and coach) about BAS and assessment expectations are very helpful and informative. BAS subs make it more manageable to assess students.	
57	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes	No	
58	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I use it to track reading trajectories over years and patterns of development for language group and starting level to determine typical pattern	I wouldn't do it so early in fall. Kids aren't as familiar with teachers and can be anxious. Perhaps only those who are 'cuspy' from previous year and new students. I think it's important to have data at least 3 times a year for at risk kids or in general- even if kids are not in LLI. Have seen kids start 2nd grade exceeding and end it at meets/approaching as they weren't assessed mid-year. While I respect the consistency of the BAS, I think other measures and systems should be considered when we look at reading of a child to better inform our instruction. If we are benchmarking them, let's have more materials to work exactly where they should be working. I think LLI books should be available/used more in classrooms for book groups allowing teachers to better control leveled targeted instruction. Middle school needs more LLI support in terms of reading specialists.	
59	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	The BAS gives me a snapshot of a student's reading behaviors (inferencing, using text evidence to support ideas, ability to give a sequential retelling, etc) at that time. The BAS helps me understand the reading profiles in my classroom, but I don't feel that it specifically informs instruction because we don't implement guided reading at the middle school level.	I think we should spend more time norming our scoring of the comprehension conversation in the BAS.	
60	Grade 6-8 Social Studies	Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	No because the data is hard to access, and therefore is often not a resource	no	
61	6-8 Social Studies Teacher	I don't use it because I don't have access to it.	N/A	Not necessarily because I am not familiar with the existing process.	
62	Guidance Counselor	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I use it to monitor students' progress, particularly relative areas of strength and weakness, from year to year in order to inform ICAP and 504 plan development.	Provide additional information on BAS reports regarding relative areas of strengths and weaknesses	

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	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
63	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, make guided reading groups focused on comp and others for fluency/accuracy	yes this is one of the main ways i do this at the beginning of the year	give us more time to assess them; i like doing the assessments myself; assessing students in the classroom with other students there is not reliable data; i only get through half my class with my full day sub for BAS testing	
64	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps us to see specific strengths and weaknesses within the umbrella of reading comprehension including ability to summarize, infer and discuss about the text.	I actually appreciate the BAS info. It is time consuming to sit with each student, but I do feel like it helps me know my readers.	
65	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes - this helps me flag certain students for additional services and help with reading in the classroom.	I think that the reading assessment times should be closer to the report card times. A January/February assessment is not helpful for a progress report that goes home in June, unless I am doing a third round of testing.	
66	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Common language within grade level teams, tracking student progress over time and across schools (I had two students move from another Brookline school this year) and it was very helpful to know exactly where to start. For students I have questions about, I'll do a quick BAS with students between cycles.	The two half day sub days are not nearly enough time to assess all students. I always take an "extra" when they are offered and I STILL don't finish. With older kids, this is can be managed as they build reading stamina. With that said, it takes away a lot of time from instruction in order to get them done.	
67	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress	-Data points for students progress within a year and from year to year	none	
68	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	The BAS gives me an opportunity to have one-on-one reading time with individual students. It helps me to differentiate the fluency of their oral reading from their ability to understand when reading in their head - the comprehension questions addressing information from the part of the book that the child read on their own sometimes points out relative strengths or weaknesses. As I've given the BAS over the course of many years, I'm able to compare students not only to other students in the current cohort but also to students I've had in the past. This means that my ability to determine students' reading levels quickly has improved over time.	I think the two biggest issues that could be improved are timing and time required. Giving the BAS at the beginning of the year is helpful in the sense that we get to know the students and can start guided reading after we assess them. However, doing our "spring" assessment in January means that it's hard to get a clear sense of how much progress kids have made. It also makes it difficult to say for sure whether students have reached end of the year benchmarks and to communicate that in end-of-the-year assessments. Administering the BAS also takes longer than the two half days that are provided. I can usually get through all the assessments with children during that time, but it is not enough time to fill out the enormous amounts of paperwork in multiple places. I wonder if literacy specialists could help to teach our classes lessons establishing some of those beginning of the year routines while classroom teachers had time to enter their data.	
69	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	NA	It would be great to have time to meet to learn more with the literacy specialists before we start BAS testing to learn about who should be on our radar.	
70	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	When I complete the BAS, I take detailed notes that give me information regarding the student's skills in all areas of reading.	I find that there is great variability amongst assessors of my students, and therefore I appreciate having the time to BAS all of my students myself as a classroom teacher. This helps me to gain a realistic picture of my students' skills and ensures that students are not marked at a level higher than they should be (thus giving false information to parents and possibly prohibiting students from receiving additional support).	
71	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes. It helps to determine regression over summer and identify specific areas where a student struggles.	Not really but I do think that it would be helpful for all teachers to take running records with some frequency.	

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72	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, it gives a sense of students' vocabulary knowledge and familiarity with nonfiction text features. It also reveals which students know how to give elaborated responses and which students require more prompting to guide their conversations around literature.	Not at this time	
73	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Yes. It allows me to sort students into guided reading groups and book clubs at the beginning of the year, when I do not know them as well as readers. It also allows me to assess progress throughout the year.	Nope!	
74	teacher	I am not aware of my students' BAS scores.	na	no	
75	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	No	No	
76	Science Teacher	Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Yes.	It would be helpful if the BAS "score" were in a language that made sense. Why can't grade level for 8th grade be called 8th grade reading level? Instead of a letter?	
77	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	The BAS helps to provide information on regression, which in turn helps support cases for ESY. It also gives recommendations on skills to work on based upon reading level.	Doing it three times throughout the school year (beginning, middle, end) and making it a whole day event. It would be a helpful motivation factor to offer enrichment rewards for students who make gains on their reading levels.	
78	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes. Helpful to see error patterns, tracking, and understanding of what they read (even if the comprehension questions provided are not always good)	Finding ways to provide shorter passages for those with stamina/attention issues, also as a measure of fluency	
79	Vice Principal	Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It is a great tool that helps teachers assess reading levels in order to develop intervention programs or leveled reading groups.	I don't have any other suggestions	
80	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It's so important to read with each kid. It helps provide information about the type of reader they are, and provides information about who needs phonics instruction or who needs comprehension instruction.	For some students it's helpful to have an independent/instructional level for non-fiction and an independent/instructional level for fiction texts.	
81	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress	Yes. I am able to sit 1:1 with a student and listen to them read, and then ask various questions. It helps me to attend to fluency, retelling, and such. I use this to then create guided reading groups.	More consistency in how we BAS a student - it's subjective to an extent. I would like additional ways to use the BAS data in my classroom.	
82	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I use this data to help sort students into book groups and to help find independent reading books	Provide teachers with more time/support for testing	
83	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment	It provides information that helps focus in on reading behaviors that need addressing for students below/on grade level.	Accept more open-ended answers for BAS responses. Focus on ability to discuss book more than their answer. (IE: This is a good title for this book? Acceptable answer is marked as yes. I'd like to be able to accept no if they can back their answer) Test at actual fall/spring times. Spring time is done in February- not in the spring.	
84	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	it allows me to group students	shared literacy and special ed conferences	
85	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Provide a common baseline to determine LLI groups across a grade level	Change the timeframe for administering BAS and possibly reduce the number of students who are assessed (possibly P&C level aren't assessed twice a year)	
86	guidance	Document student progress, CST	N/A	Something to help assess other lit skills and provide other types of tiered instruction	

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87	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes. I can observe several reading behaviors when I am assessing my students with the BAS including fluency, rate, level of anxiety and/or ease with testing and reading, etc.	I think if teachers didn't have to enter data in several different places, they would feel more positive and open minded about the BAS and how to use it in their practice. I also think we have to start thinking seriously about writing--the BAS does not assess writing, and it is a very important element of literacy that we are currently overlooking.	
88	Special Educator	Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress	no	BAS has helped identify students reading levels and track progress; however, often times whole class books are being used in English class and students are often placed in groups based on their interest level; not their BAS level.	
89	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Not really...	I strongly feel that we need an assessment to screen students for specific learning disabilities at the younger grade levels.	
90	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	Yes. By analyzing students abilities to answer questions about within the text, about the text and beyond the text, and by documenting their progress, I am able to create their attainable IEP goals and work on the benchmarks.	Provide us with more books for the same level so that the students have more variety of text and genres.	
91	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It is really helpful to sit in a quiet place and read with students individually to observe their reading strategies. I get to see students who might try to skip over or murmur words they do not know, students that leave off endings, students who paraphrase the text completely, etc. These are helpful points to note and share with families during fall conferences. I make note of these behaviors and address them directly and individually with students during reading groups.	The fall assessment is really helpful. I do not find the spring assessment to be as useful because I meet with my groups so frequently, I feel like I already know their reading level. Also since we do the assessment in February and March, the reading levels tend to change so drastically by the time we assess them again in the fall.	
92	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	-	-	
93	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	No, but it gives common language around skills and concrete info to discuss with parents at conference time	I really like BAS and find it an effective assessment tool!	
94	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes. BAS provides teachers the opportunity to communicate and share data about student reading levels. It is also helpful to have information about how students are comprehending the texts they are reading at their independent reading level.	I am a new teacher to the Brookline School District. I am going to be trained to administer the BAS and other teachers assessed the students in my class. I will have more information when I am able to BAS the students in my cohort.	
95	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes - it provides information about student growth and need	no	
96	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Yes - helps get information about fluency, word attack strategies, phonics, fluency, and comprehension (both inferential and explicit).	It would also be helpful to have a basic phonics assessment for classroom teachers for those students who aren't yet able to show their reading skills OR a spelling assessment. Its hard to find time to assess all the students in a classroom (given only one full day for a BAS sub). It ends up taking nearly 3-4 weeks of leaving the classroom to read with students in the hallway at multiple times during the week. It's hard to get into a groove in the school year being out of the classroom to assess students so much. It's helpful information and I like the assessments, but the time it takes to administer them and then score and record this information is really quite a lot.	
97	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels	no	none as of now	

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98	Special Educator	I haven't used this beautiful assessment tool as of yet.	I believe it will	Not at the moment	
99	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps me understand more of the strengths and roadblocks to their comprehension and decoding.	I would love to not have to deal with making sub plans for the time I am BASing students.	
100	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	No	I think it is important to continue to hold teachers accountable for reading with each student and keeping track of their progress in a way that can be shared as students move through the grades.	
101	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Somewhat. I find that our scoring of the responses is still not as normed as I would like. Maybe I score more conservatively than my colleagues, but I often find that my fall levels are lower than last year's spring levels...and I'm sure there's not that much regression. I'm also still struggling to pinpoint the specific behaviors to teach based on the questions we're asking and the books we're using. Sometimes a goal pops right out, but more often than not I'm left with somewhat vague feedback that doesn't give me a specific direction in which to go and isn't really helping me to set up guided reading groups. The new Guided Reading book is helpful because it shows new behaviors for my grade level, but even still there are way too many goals within each category (within/beyond/about) and I'm often left struggling to figure out what groups to form and what is most important to work on in the group.	One idea would be to use the prior grade's results to form groups and start instruction for the year. Then, as the year gets going I could assess more flexibly (it also feels very rushed during the testing cycle and I'm never quite sure if I'm getting the most authentic data). It would also be great to have more specific guidelines about goal areas in which we should focus for each grade level so that we can better group students for guided reading and so that I can narrow my focus a bit more during testing so that I find the best goals for my students. Hope this all makes sense. Thanks!	
102	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, as data/information for CST, SST and progress reports	Allows me to discuss personal reading habits with students at the start of the year (What do you like to read? When do you like to read?) Allows me to get to know students as readers better. Allows me to guide students to appropriate level text from classroom and school library for independent reading.	no, not at the moment	
103	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	In the middle elementary grades, it's helpful to have evidence of how students are responding to comprehension questions - this information guides my instruction.	Getting a spreadsheet with last year's data has been really helpful. In past years it's felt as though our data largely disappeared once submitted. Is it possible to share any common threads/trends across the grades at our school? Can the district share what it's learning from the data that is being collected?	
104	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, informing progress reports	It is important to read with each student and understand him/her as a reader.	The start of the year is stressful and we are just getting to know our kids. If we could have an additional 1/2 day (already have 2 half days), it would be helpful. Especially for those of us that do not have a second adult in the room.	
105	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes it helps me to level books depending on the reading we are doing whether short stories, genre study work, etc. It informs what I need to focus on, especially with struggling readers (within, about, beyond). Using this information along with Lucy Calkins reading progressions and Lucy Calkins 6-8 units of reading I believe will allow me to move the students up towards grade level reading.	More available people to test especially in grads 6-8. Can teachers other than ELA teachers BAS students if they are trained (Science, Math...)	
106	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Since you are allowed to reword questions and prompt students to look back/give more info, the data from the BAS is not a true measure of kids' independent reading behaviors. When we look at why BAS and MCAS scores do not line up, this is a big reason why. The BAS also doesn't accurately take into account reading stamina.	In the upper grades, I do not think we should be required to BAS students who are scoring E/Above Grade Level the same way we need to assess struggling readers. Literacy Specialists should be starting intervention groups in September based on data from end of previous year and MCAS scores. Round 2 BAS scores should be completed end of May/beginning of June.	

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	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
107	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Students' reading comprehension.	No	
108	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I think the BAS is an appropriate tool that helps assess my students.	Having a deadline is important because it sets a standard that I need to meet an educator. I wish that we could have more days allotted to assessing students. Or a full day of assessment as opposed to just two half days. It's stressful trying to fit that into the schedule.	
109	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	YES! Can guide classroom teachers to group students by instructional needs rather than just their current reading level. Break down specific areas of need - for example, if "Fluency" is identified, does this mean rate, meaningful phrasing, reading with expression...? The more specific area will determine instructional choices (readers theater, repeated reading, modeling, listening to books on tape etc.)	P.D. around more frequent ongoing assessment (running records/LASW protocol etc.) to inform and differentiate instruction.	
110	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I use the BAS as a benchmark for where students are reading at the start of the year, and allows me to create reading groups with students who have similar reading levels and behaviors.	When we BAS students in the spring, I don't think we are assessing them close enough to the end of the school year. I don't think teachers of the following year have an accurate idea of where their students left off reading the year before. I also feel that BAS is not an appropriate assessment for students in the RISE program, particularly since the comprehension section does not allow for visuals or other modifications which they use in the classroom in reading groups and throughout the day.	
111	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It is very helpful.	Maybe adding another testing cycle.	
112	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, BAS data are not helpful to my practice	Some fluency and Inferencing questions are helpful for an individual student. Mainly used for one guided reading group per year.	Beginning of year give all students a quick assessment in class. In the past I used a fill in the blank packet that gave a good sense of on grade, below, or above. Find something similar and implement it for a quick read of the classroom! BAS takes so long and for the upper grades, only some kids even have data.	
113	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	N/A	More support to get BAS done	
114	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	The BAS provides me with the opportunity to group students and find out their immediate and long term needs. I'm able to see whether a student needs more practice on skills within the story (decoding, summarization), beyond the story (predictions), and about the story (author's craft).	I think it would be more helpful to do the second set of BAS in April/May in order to provide the next years' teacher a more appropriate updated level. Also, this test does not reflect our RISE students abilities.	
115	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, Allows me to establish fluid literature groups throughout the year	Yes - it helps me pinpoint specific aspects of reading skills and reading response skills to target.	Allowing for prioritizing assessments in the upper grades -	

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	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
116	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It is nice to have a structured way to read with students one-to-one	I don't think it's a good use of classroom teachers' time to enter so much data into the BAS spreadsheet. I find it helpful to collect this information for myself, but it would save time if I was able to just report an instructional level for each student. I also think it would be helpful if we could spend more time on assessing struggling students and maybe only periodically test students who have historically always been at "pause and consider".	
117	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Listening to student reading is useful in gauging their fluency.	No	
118	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Confirm teacher professional judgment, BAS data are not helpful to my practice, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Not really. My kindergarteners have authentic experiences reading in my classroom. The BAS sometimes can be a very stressful experience for young children. Also, The data I get in February is not helpful. I would prefer to get data closer to parent conference/progress report times. May would be great.	Kindergarteners should do the BAS later in the year.	
119	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	BAS helps group students for guided reading and allow for flexible groupings within classes.	I suggest that we move the spring BAS testing to later in the school year.	
120	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Not really.	Some of the BAS texts and questions do not provide accurate feedback when considering student reading levels. Some stories are easier or harder than the average text at that level and some of the questions are frankly just bad questions. Students get them wrong despite being able to read and comprehend other texts at that level. If there is any way to review the assessments that would be great.	
121	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Yes. I use it to form intervention groups and to look at the specific needs of individual students.	I like the idea of only assessing students of concern (or new students) twice a year, and those who are consistently at or above grade level only once a year.	
122	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes - BAS helps me really get to know my students as readers.	There is inconsistency among the teachers across grade levels with the details written on the folders, on the sheets, etc. This makes it difficult to know where to begin with students if there is a lack of information from the spring.	
123	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	I use BAS for the main reasons listed above and have used it to guide LLI groups in the past	Not at this moment	
124	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes	My suggestion is finding an one instructional level as opposed to the two instructional and independent. If a student is independent at the highest level for their grade (pause and consider).	
125	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	The BAS helps me set up guided reading groups at the beginning of the year but information from previous classroom teachers submitted in June is sufficient to get groups started in the fall without having to do the BAS	I would recommend not assessing until January and setting up guided reading groups based on the previous teachers levels from June.	
126	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Because students read a common text, I'm able to compare students across the class based on how they respond to a common question or response.	I think it makes more sense to assess in January and June. The June score would start the next school year off and would give me enough time to get the year started, set up the classroom, and then start guided reading before testing again in January. The January score would show any progress made and inform the second part of the school year until the May/June score which would end the year to show yearly progress and follow the student to the next year.	

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	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
127	Grades K-2 Teacher	Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment, BAS data are not helpful to my practice, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I find the BAS to be the least helpful of the K assessments. I have more than enough information about my students with our Kindergarten literacy assessments, as well as the other informal assessments that I am constantly doing in the classroom. Given that we administer the assessment in February, when many children are not really reading quite yet, I find it to be stressful for the children and not really an accurate portrayal of reading levels for progress reports in June. It would be far more helpful to assess student reading levels in May.	K assessments should take place in May.	
128	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	no- I find that the records/notes I take after reading with students both individually and in their guided reading groups to be more helpful and informative over the course of the year. I view the BAS as a way for teachers to understand their students' reading levels at the beginning of the year and to assess progress mid-way through the year.	First, we need to address the amount of time this valuable assessment takes. Two half days is not enough time for teachers to read with all of their students or even 16 if other staff are helping. We need additional coverage time to actually be able to complete the BAS for our students. In addition, it takes a substantial amount of time to score each reading record, fill out a cover sheet, and enter the data on a spreadsheet. Today, we were given our 1 hour faculty meeting to enter the data (and fill out this survey). 1 hour is not enough time to do all the record keeping tasks mentioned above. Also, we need to think through the value of entering all the data on paper forms and the spreadsheet. I find certain categories to be of value (ex. accuracy, self-corrections and overall comprehension score). Breaking down the comprehension score is not helpful unless a child scores very low on this area. In that case, I would rather refer back to the actual reading record to see what the child might be struggling with. It is time-consuming to enter break down the comprehension score for a student who scores a high score. I would like to only need to enter the scores for about/beyond/within if the student scores below a certain benchmark comprehension score.	
129	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	helps me know where to begin with the continuum helps me plan IRA, guided reading, mini-lessons helps me know what focus on to improve students fluency, monitoring comprehension, adjusting, rate, etc.	work as a town to norm our testing	
130	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	-It helps me to meet with students 1-1 and learn about their reading behaviors. -Group students and provide literacy goals. -Understand what they are thinking about comprehension to a text -Hear fluency -Learning about how they solve unknown words -Connect with readers	-I think it would be helpful if there was an online form / google spread sheet for teachers to click goals: thinking within the text, beyond, and about. -It would be helpful if each question in the form said what are they working on/ or able to do for solving words, monitoring and correcting, searching for and using information, summarizing, and fluency. -This information can be printed or used online to share/ track students data over time. It would save time and teachers wouldn't have to fill out a chart and cover sheet. -It would be helpful if this form generated groups: guided reading levels as well as groups based instructional goals from reading behaviors. -We need more than two 1/2 days to assess 21 first graders. -Assessing at the beginning of the year happens during critical teaching time to establish good reading habits. It is hard to be out of the room multiple times a week to work with students 1-1 on reading. -We should be using foundations data from chapter assessments to gather and group information. If students score lower than 80% they need more instruction in a small group. -Lucy Calkins talks about specific strategies that are good for different reading levels. It would be very helpful if we had a quick reference sheet for teachers to use as a guide as well as visual reference cards.	

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	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
131	Grades K-2 Teacher	Document student progress, BAS data are not helpful to my practice	It takes way TO long to complete, analyze and post BAS assessments for all my students . All I need is a quick snap shot at where they are so that I can move them along.	LESS TIME SPENT ON ASSESSMENTS (collecting, analyzing and posting data!) more time WITH the kids building connection and helping them love learning.	
132	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It gives us a break-down of comprehension, such as differentiating within the text, about the text, and beyond the text. It is difficult to finish the MSV for everyone, but it is helpful knowledge to be paying attention to this as students read and as I enter teaching points on the form.	BAS information becomes "old data" very quickly in younger grades. I have no suggestion for improving this, except maybe a less intense assessment, more often?	
133	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, BAS data are not helpful to my practice, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, some times it catches the interesting behaviors and helpful information to consider about a student.	The BAS assessments can be subjective(especially the comprehension scores) so if there are designated assessors who just administrate the BAS assessments throughout the school year, it would make the assessment results more accurate and reliable.	
134	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps me concentrate my attention on areas that many students need, esp. with regard to guided reading, mini-lessons and IRA. Also, it gives me insight into how to structure and focus my classroom library and utilize our awesome school library collection with our guided reading - multiple copy resources.	I would appreciate the opportunity to work with literacy coaches in school to co-score in order to help "norm" the results.	
135	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	The BAS data helps me to identify what instructional level text to use during my small group instruction to work on comprehension and fluency skills. It also provides me with the data on which comprehension skill I should target at well as fluency skill to address.	I am new to the district, so not at this moment in time.	

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	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
136	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, the BAS does provide additional information about what students can and can't do even when they are "independent" at a level, that doesn't mean that they are able to grasp all the elements.	Oh my... no easy answers.... The problem is, as you know, that there is just not enough time to do the BAS and everything else. I find that the time is often well worth it and I am getting better at giving them- and that feels good- seeing my own progress... but... the books/stories are often not well written and so don't really provide accurate levels... reading with each student using a common text is great, but I am not sure these are the books to use. I think we could pick short passages that truly are well written and use them as levels. Also, I find that there is not enough time to really sit with each kid to explain what I learned about them and what they can work on. So... I am thinking we find a 'below, at, reach texts for fiction and non-fiction- that we all agree has elements we are looking for... we use it like a BAS with out loud and to yourself sections- also maybe, there is a better way to focus more on students who we have some concerns about- I am thinking there could be something shorter or not at all in the fall for students who are at pause and consider so we have more time to focus on kids who do not yet love to read. Also, the school system seems to have less and less help. They no longer have internship programs set up with 3-5... this means that being alone with 25 or so students and no help is tricky. It seems like if we, as a school system, truly care about literacy and good teaching then we have to provide more teachers in each classroom. I know that is a bigger than BAS question, but it is one of the reasons that BAS becomes such a burden rather than a help. One last thing is that it always feels like we send in all this data and it is never clear where it goes. We were never sent kids mcas scores- I had to wait for the math specialist to send it to us. Again, this is bigger than BAS, but it has to do with the purpose of data collecting. I am happy to discuss all of this further. Sincerely, Francesca	
137	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	No	No	
138	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	No	N/A	
139	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Fluency and accuracy!	This may sound superficial, but when entering grades, if every other row on the google sheet was shaded, it would help keep track of entering grades!	

	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
140	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, I use BAS data to inform my decision making about which students should be selected for Leveled Literacy Intervention. I also use the data to help classroom teachers plan guided reading groups that are instructionally appropriate for students, so that every child is receiving differentiated literacy instruction from their classroom teacher.	Absolutely. The BAS is an authentic assessment that closely mirrors what students are doing in real life. I'm able to assess reading fluency, accuracy, and comprehension in a 30 minute session. When I assess comprehension, I am able to determine specific behaviors and understandings that students need to be taught. The BAS is the foundation of the intervention work that I do. It was also foundational to the guided reading work that I did as a classroom teacher, and it allowed me to differentiate my Tier 1 instruction to truly meet the unique needs of each student in my classroom.	Eliminating the BAS would be incredibly harmful to the district's literacy program and to the reading instruction of Brookline students. No other assessment that I have used in my ten years as a classroom teacher and now as a literacy specialist, has given me the same level of meaningful data as the BAS has.	
141	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It affords me the one-on-one time to observe more closely a student's thinking about their reading.	Not at this time.	
142	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	No	No	
143	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, LLI selection, planning with classroom teachers around guided reading, monitoring student growth	Yes, it helps us to deeper understand a student's comprehension. It highlights their strengths and areas for growth within, beyond, and about the text. In addition, the miscue analysis helps us plan for instruction for each student as well as the whole class. It helps us see patterns across classrooms and grade levels... Furthermore, it helps me understand areas for growth in teaching and learning across schools and within my own school.	The BAS has been heavily researched, field tested and reviewed. I have been a literacy coach and literacy specialist for over 20 years (many of those years were in NYC, and Boston Public). In all of that time I have never seen or used any other assessment that comes close to providing us with the same information. Every other assessment gives you a slice and not the whole picture. Most do a poor job of assessing comprehension. BAS is used across the country to inform instruction. It is not exclusively a literacy collaborative tool. Perhaps what we need to look at, which has been brought up, is the timing of the BAS windows and not the BAS itself.	
144	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	No	I need more than 1 release day to assess all of my students. It would be helpful if we have more release time to complete the BAS (i.e. two release days).	
145	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	I think the BAS assessment is helpful for students who you know are reading below grade level. It allows me to identify IND and INS levels and observe the reading strategies they are using, as well as set goals for them. However, I do not believe it is as useful for students who are exceeding expectations or who are at P & C.	I think BASING students who are below grade level is still beneficial, and believe conferencing/talking to students and recording their thinking during reading lessons is more valuable/provides lots of information to me as their teacher.	
146	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	It helps with both	not at this time...I like the BAS	
147	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	Helps to form guided reading groups.	Choose different books for BAS.	
148	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	It can help identify which students have background knowledge and life experience that supports their understanding, and which students don't, which impacts their comprehension.	Provide teachers with 2-3 assessment options so that they can choose the one that is most helpful for their understanding of their students' reading strengths and challenges.	
149	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels	It tells me whether or not students can infer.	One consistent person should do all assessments because BAS grading is subjective when each teacher does it.	
150	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment	I use the BAS as a source of data for rough comparison 1.) within a cohort, 2.) across cohorts, and 3.) across time periods. I use BAS data at two points in time during the year (September and March). The essential data I use is the overall reading level, fluency measures, and comprehension measures.	The BAS is beneficial as a rough indicator of a student's current reading level. This benefit must be carefully weighed against the significant cost to the district in substitute expenses and lost learning time.	
151	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	Yes, especially when it comes to the comprehension part. I get a good sense of how students interpret question about the text and beyond	For kids who are not reading yet, there has to be some other assessments to figure out what they know or where they are in the literacy sequence of skills to be acquired.	

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	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
152	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	The BAS helps me to determine which reading strategies I need to teach to my students.	In addition to the BAS I think it would be helpful to include a phonics assessment.	
153	Grades K-2 Teacher	Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, have evidence to support why students need LLI	I think the spring BAS should be done in late spring so classroom teachers can benefit from the results and it should not be included on the progress report. It should be shared in the spring meeting in person.	Yes, please provide specific way to enter information on spread sheet so the teacher entering info can see all data on the screen at once!	
154	Grades K-2 Teacher	Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps to see what types of errors students are making.	no	
155	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I feel it gives a good picture of comprehension abilities orally.	I'd like more time to assess - there feels like a time pressure to complete it all.	
156	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, it gives me information about their fluency, ability to talk about texts and comfort with talking and reading texts. This is very helpful at the first grade level.	*More support earlier in the year to assess. Maybe literacy specialists could help during the first 2 weeks of school before they begin servicing kids? *Please highlight or shade every other row on the input form/excel spreadsheet. This would be SO helpful!	
157	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	I use BAS data to form guided reading groups and to guide lessons to target specific skills for students to practice.	It is incredibly helpful to have support from literacy specialists and ELE teachers to administer BAS assessments. It is very helpful to have a BAS sub during our assessment windows. Thank you!	
158	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	no	no	
159	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	I feel the above explanations provide the reasons I use BAS.	How we utilize BAS can be used the same way at the high school.	
160	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	No	I think more frequent and skill specific assessments would be helpful.	
161	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	BAS data helps me guide both my whole group mini lessons in reading and my small group guided reading lessons that are tailored to students individual needs.	BAS in the fall and Spring (maybe not winter)	
162	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I also use the BAS (and the continuum) to draft goals and benchmarks for students with reading goals on their IEP	I love it.	
163	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	Allows me to provide adequate reading material when I pull them out for instruction,	No	

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	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
164	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	No, it provides a limited picture into student skills. The fact that there are only two texts per level also makes the assessment frustrating for students in Special Education who may read books at a specific level for multiple years.	Consider how this information is used for students in the upper grades. What is the true value in BASing a student at the end of 8th grade, when the high school does not use the same system?	
165	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress	No, it often doesn't give me an accurate view of a students because I know a lot more by working with them in small groups.	More choices in assessment tools.	
166	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Helps me plan for guided reading groups. PLEASE DO NOT CHANGE THE ASSESSMENT. NO MORE NEW THINGS.	I think it would be helpful to have the cover sheets have possible options of specific areas/domains to work on (fluency with some bullet points, etc.) that we could check off. This could come from the continuum and we could use the continuum to add specifics but the documenting of next steps is SO time consuming. It takes me a full day with a sub plus an addition 3+ hours outside of that time to complete assessing students, let alone all of the paperwork. Maybe this is unique to first grade and the number of books we have to read? But needs to be more efficient!	
167	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	The books and questions are not great for the levels I do with students. The non-fiction and fiction texts greatly differ.	BAS takes too much time and doesn't give enough information. BAS should be given once a year to students at grade level or above and more for students who are struggling. Teachers also do not have enough time to do this thoroughly.	
168	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	No	Need more BAS days/time for the paperwork part	
169	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes. It provides me with a good sense of decoding and fluency skills with leveled texts. It also provides me with information about specific comprehension skills that students do, or do not have.	I would like to see some formal assessment of decoding skills. I am a 5th and 6th grade special d teacher. Maybe this is happening in younger grades.	
170	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, but it is super time consuming.	Yes, but I think the DRA was just as helpful and took less time. We used to do more assessments (San Diego quick assessment, along with other assessments on spelling and dictation) but they took less time and gave pretty accurate information. The district is paying so much money for BAS materials and training. I'm just not sure if we are getting the biggest bang for our buck.	
171	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	What area I should focus guided reading questions in such as within, beyond and about type questions.	Assess to small assessments to give throughout the year to see there progression. More subs for us to get the BAS done in time and time to input the data.	
172	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, Talk to families about their student's learning needs	This is a strangely worded question! I think you're asking if it gives us information beyond what we would otherwise get from talking to students and observing them? I think the BAS does, but it's incredibly labor intensive, given the amount of information we receive.	More time! If we're going to keep using BAS, administering at least 3 assessments per child, we need release time to do it. The books we use also feel terribly dated, so at minimum we also need texts on more relevant topics.	
173	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It can be useful to have a one-on-one reading conversation to quantify things I've noticed in student reading behavior.	BAS books are out of date (especially for higher levels), which skews scores and makes them less useful.	
174	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	an understanding of students' particular strengths and indicators of what reading work those strengths suggest they are ready for next an understanding of what kind of thinking students are able to do and not yet do within (literal), beyond (inferential), and about (critical) text	No	
175	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, BAS data are not helpful to my practice	No, our students in K are not assessed until February and then are not assessed again at the end of the year. By February we have an idea of each child's reading level and where they need to be taught from without the BAS data. Then when the students move to first grade, the students' most recent reading level is from February (almost 8 months prior to the start of their grade 1 learning), rendering it useless.	The comprehension piece and asking questions about beyond the text aren't typically helpful to figure out the childrens's actual reading level. I also don't feel like the books are leveled accurately and necessarily good examples of leveled books to determine reading levels.	

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176	Special Educator	Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	It shows me their guided reading level which is helpful but it is not helpful with regards to their reading and spelling level for phonics instruction.	Conducting a consistent assessment that goes along with instruction. DRA is helpful for guided reading but it seems that more concern is around phonics instruction and frequent informal assessments around Letter/Sound ID, reading/ spelling levels/ sight word assessment should be given.	
177	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	documents student progress in identified areas	some questions are more broad than others in each level, more variety of texts per level for assessment to be monitored more frequently	
178	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	N/A	Just want to note to keep in mind that BAS assessments may not be the best match for students who may have social, emotional, or behavioral needs or things they work on (Example: students who are unable to relate to others may not be able to answer beyond or above questions that they could not even apply in their own lives. Some of these students have ed plans that address these issues, but it reflects as low comprehension in scores.)	
179	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It informs grouping for book clubs. It also helps me recommend books for students that are at their levels.	More sub-days to perform assessments. Each book takes about 15-20 minutes, and each child goes through 3-5 books for a complete assessment. I'd love time in the schedule to meet with literacy specialists about certain kids.	
180	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	No	1. Use central data team to share back data directly to classroom teachers in a manageable way so that they can identify trends 2. Streamline paperwork - currently too long (also much repetition between paperwork and spreadsheet)	
181	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, it provides standard resources to track progress.	Some books and related questions are not written as well as others. More books at each level would be helpful for students who take longer to make progress.	
182	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	I find the BAS helpful in terms of providing a common understanding of reading behaviors and goals across levels and grades. It provides a slightly more objective means of planning, tracking progress, and guiding instruction.	Not to add to the number of assessments we do, but it would be helpful to have some sort of assessment around encoding (either using Foundations or another common spelling assessment). Having more time/help to do the BAS would be helpful. I came from another district where you only had to find one instructional and independent level, and I think that amount of testing is sufficient (do not need to go to two instructional levels) for planning instruction. I also think kids should be testing again at the end of the year. There are often big jumps between kid's winter levels and where they start off the next year, and I feel like it allows some kids to fall off our radar during that period.	
183	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It helps me to get to know the students' reading behaviors, especially at the beginning of the year.	A phonics assessment would also be helpful.	
184	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	BAS provides data on inconsistencies between ability to read and comprehend fiction and non-fiction which guides independent reading selections (creating targeted book boxes). Also, in K we use the pre-reading assessments for readers and non-readers which instructs phonics and intervention from letter ID, sound/symbol correspondence, phonemic awareness, etc.	Based on what I've seen as a CST member, we need to have phonemic and phonological awareness assessments through grade 2 or higher.	

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185	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Confirm teacher professional judgment	I think I could find better more efficient ways to assess reading levels if left to my own accord.	Yes. I suggest looking into MAP testing. All students do it, therefore no one feels ostracized. Furthermore, we wouldn't just be focusing on lower achievers in the upper grades; the MAP test provides data for all students. They take it on one day and this interactive test responds to their ability. The data that the test provides is multifaceted.	
186	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Yes	No	
187	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	I can see how confident my students are when they read and answer questions.	Some of the questions that are asked are vague and not that helpful in the "Beyond section"...	
188	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	Helps me see which students need additional work on phonics. See which students are able to use inferencing in order to understand vocabulary.	I think that once a year would probably be enough unless there was a question regarding a particular student's progress. The BAS is useful, but it also takes up important instructional time.	
189	Admin	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	I enjoyed reading with students wearing my admin hat, as it was a way to get to know students in an academic setting and a way to provide meaningful support to teachers.	Ideally we would have an "all hands on deck" approach and plow through assessing MUCH faster.	
190	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels	Yes	1. I think LLI selection meetings should determine when you get your BAS days. The grade level with the earliest LLI meeting, should be able to schedule first, and then so on. 2. Classroom teachers should be provided with extra time to do the paperwork - it is extremely laborious and time consuming. Or, literacy specialists should make themselves available to help with the paperwork. 3. There is HUGE inconsistencies with how the BAS folders are completed. There should be an exemplar of the inside and outside with clear expectations about how to fill out the folder. I spend a lot of time fixing folders that I receive.	
191	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	The BAS is helpful at the beginning of the year--it gives you a good starting point. I find it less helpful when we do the second round. The BAS cycles are too close together.	I find what the BAS considers meeting grade level benchmark does not match the level of what is needed to meet grade level expectations on MCAS. Often students are considered as being meeting grade level expectations on the BAS, but they struggle in class and when taking the MCAS. I think we are missing kids who struggle to provide written responses to reading (because the BAS is all verbal). I also think we rely too heavily on the BAS. It is only one score, one assessment. Anyone who has been trained in assessment knows you need to use at least two different assessment tools, as well as informal classroom observations, to form opinions and judgments about a student's performance level.	
192	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	no	district-wide writing assessment	
193	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes. At the very least, it gives me a starting point as I gauge the student's reading progress.	I would love to have more support from literacy and reading specialists; they could BAS some of the students that I am not given time in my day to BAS.	
194	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Helps me to form guided reading groups	Give the second BAS at the end of the year instead of the middle	

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195	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	Yes! See above!	Nope	
196	Grades K-2 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	It gives me insight to their thinking and strategies.	Not at this time.	
197	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	What do you mean by "additional information"? In addition to what?	More trained Literacy Coaches at all levels, K2, 3-5, 6-8	
198	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	No- the continuum helps with this but we don't use that enough. People don't treat instructional levels as fluid (and tend to look at overall level and NOT growth.)	When students are below level, we do NOT have appropriately matched interventions and I don't understand how interventions are Not being matched to kids skill deficits. Literacy specialists need to get more comfortable articulating instructional strategies they are using (beyond LLI) because I know that this is happening but they don't always know how to document or talk about what types of support or interventions they are providing.	
199	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction	NO	Assess only those students that you have concerns about. If a student is at Pause and Consider for two years in a row, what is the new information gained? Those students should not be assess for two years and then assessed only if teacher believes there are concerns.	
200	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	It is helpful in the fall as I try to get to know my readers.	Classroom teachers are NOT provided enough time to thoughtfully administer the BAS to their students. 6 hours for 16-22 students is NOT enough. In addition, creating sub plans before the BAS time is an added task and completing all the paperwork and spreadsheets after the BAS adds time. We are not given any other release time for these tasks. Math, ECS, and literacy specialists, who don't start services right away, could come into our classrooms to do whole class lessons for us. We could be given faculty meeting time to work on all the paperwork. We could be released from recess duty to make sub plans. There are many ways that classroom teachers could be supported if indeed the BAS data is valued. AS it is, I resent BAS and don't give it my full attention. As for its value, that's another story that I don't have time to go into today.	
201	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, Help students set reading goals.	I'm not sure what you mean by additional. It provides a thorough assessment of reading levels and behaviors across a range of text types and levels with different challenges. It's not a perfect assessment, but it gives me a good sense of whether kids will be able to handle the kinds of challenges they might meet in texts at particular levels. It doesn't address motivation or engagement, but I often have a quick chat with kids as we walk to my room for BAS so I can find out about their reading habits and preferences.	I like the pre- and post-assessments in the Calkins units, but I would not want to see us start to report those scores. I think they are very useful as formative assessments and for student self-evaluation, goal setting, and reflection. However, they also conflate reading and writing ability.	

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202	Grades K-2 Teacher	Confirm teacher professional judgment, BAS data are not helpful to my practice	Every once in a while I'll find that a child is a level higher/lower than I had anticipated, but the data that I have collected independently is much more helpful to me.	I would prefer to do the BAS at a later date in Kindergarten. So many students are not yet reading in February, and many find the assessment to be stressful. As their classroom teacher that works with them every day, I know which students are reading and which students are not. I use running records to informally assess reading levels, and think that BAS data would be much more helpful as a data point that gets used from year to year to make decisions if it were used as a summative assessment at the end of the year. I also think that expecting all Kindergartners to be at a C by the end of the school year is not developmentally appropriate for many children. Some of them just turned 5 at the end of August, knew no letters and sounds at the beginning of the year, and expecting them to be actually reading by the end of the year is inappropriate. The jump from a B to a C is HUGE, and having this expectation for all students shows a lack of understanding of and attention to developmentally appropriate practice.	
203	Special Educator	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress	It helps capture reading behaviors that are students strengths and reading behaviors that are students weaknesses.	I have two concerns with regards to the BAS. First, in 6th-8th many students have already read the texts in the kit. As a result we then have to find supplemental text from the LLI intervention kit in order to test accurately. Finding the reading specialist and getting copies printed is a time intensive process. Additionally, the LLI texts require more time to administer with regards to assessment than the BAS so the amount of time it takes a student to complete an assessment increases. Secondly, as a special education teacher in a learning center during the BAS testing window I found I had to devote a significant amount of time to assessing students which then got in the way of my ability to do interventions around their individual needs, IEP goals etc.	
204	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	BAS data helps to determine what resources students can access in science and social studies.	Adding a "writing about reading" component	
205	Grades K-2 Teacher	BAS data are not helpful to my practice	BAS gives me forced one-on-one time with each child, which is a nice benefit.	I think shared grade-level assessments are helpful to my practice, provided they are designed by teachers of that grade. The BAS is absolutely not practical nor helpful in Kindergarten. Most children are not ready to read in February and March and therefore are stressed by the thought of doing something with teachers that is clearly a test to them. In addition, it does not provide information that is new or helpful. I assess students informally every day and the BAS does not provide information that I would use to support children. On occasion, with higher readers, it could give me info about specific skills, but not enough information to warrant a test. I also don't think the information helps first grade teachers because Kindergarten children change so much from the time of BAS until the time they begin first grade.	

	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
206	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes, yes, yes. See my entire answer below as it includes my perspective on how the BAS provides additional info that helps assess student reading levels. To add here, the BAS provide the nuances that are difficult to otherwise detect in student reading behavior. For example, a second grader says "I am reading Harry Potter." Now maybe some second grader somewhere is reading that book, but the second grader I was dealing with could really only decode the words and had little true comprehension about the story. How do I know this? Because that student's BAS assessment showed a reading level upwards of Level M. Certainly this student was at a "pause and consider" higher level for a 2nd grader. However, the F&P Guided Reading level for Harry Potter is Level V. Knowing all of this, I was able to gently show this student how choose reading material - even find a series with few wizards and magic as part of the story - so they could practice, practice and grow, grow to eventually read not "one" Harry Potter book but to look forward to eventually reading all of the Harry Potter books :)	I would improve the delivery of the current BAS. That is, arrange the time frame so it does not fall right at the start of school. For example, the administration of the BAS could dip in over time and not start until the first six weeks of school have passed. Even teachers who find the BAS useful, find doing it during this initial time period, with not-so-great classroom subs, creates classroom management issues and really interrupts the building of classroom routines and community. I can't stress enough how I have observed that this start-of-school time line upsets teachers, coloring their attitude towards the usefulness of this data. Additionally, I think more needs to be done to help classroom teachers work with the Continuum so what they learn from the BAS results can be smoothly implemented into their whole class and small group instruction. I work at a school with a strong, active Literacy Leadership Team. I would advocate having or revitalizing the LLT groups at each school. We meet monthly during Collaboration Time because we all agreed to that. We could use more time but some feel if we met until 3:30 rather than 2:30, a stipend would be necessary. Unfortunately, BAS assessment has gone the way of being part of the loud talk about "too much testing". BAS is a very, very valid instrument to evaluate a student's reading fluency, comprehension, decoding and more. BAS is not the only tool teacher's have to inform them about student literacy - that point is also lost in the loud talk. BAS is often criticized as a "one-size-fits-all" approach but it is not at all. Look at the BAS sheet - especially the bottom area that mentions behaviors to notice, ideas to implement based on that individual student's BAS assessment. I can't count the number of times that I have consulted the BAS to help me better understand a student's approach to literacy. BAS assessment is one part of the entire Literacy Collaborative program. The program itself is rich, verified by research and by practice. Please do not end the BAS assessment but please do modify the way it is administered.	1
207	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	N/A	I think the BAS gives us good information to help inform instruction, however I think it's an overwhelming amount of work to carry out in a very short window of time. I think it would be helpful to give classroom teachers two days of sub coverage to assess students as it's unlikely to get through more than 5 or 6 complete assessments in one day of sub coverage. I also think it might be helpful to expand the window of time in which we can administer the BAS.	

	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
208	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment, Establish common data points that we share across multiple grade levels, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals, Help to identify students who have stopped making progress Tier 1, help to identify students for Intervention	I learn about student accuracy, fluency, rate, comprehension, ability to talk about a book, planning for guided reading in the classroom, time to connect with a student 1:1, depth of understanding about a student's ability across a continuum of reading.	The BAS takes a lot of thought/time to do "right" and many people grumble about it; this would be the one area that I think educators complain most about. However, this is an essential tool that we use. It establishes a common language and understanding of students as readers across a continuum. Without it, and the information it provides, Tier 1 teaching and learning will be negatively impacted with a lack of information about student capability. Despite the fact that it takes time to administer, students love the 1:1 teacher time, and the opportunity to sit and read with a student is highly valuable not only for the literacy information it provides but also for the potential to develop a personal connection and deeper understanding of a student and his/her experiences. One area for improving assessment would be to support 6-8 teachers in fully understanding the value of the BAS as a teaching tool and make the experience more formative instead of having it be an added burden to teacher load.	
209	Grades 3-5 Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	The BAS is helpful for making groups, but regarding what to teach I get more information about student thinking and behaviors when I teach in small guided reading group or in a book club.	Students that are reading above grade level the year before could be assessed only during the winter session. That way in the fall there is a smaller group of students to assess. This isn't another way, but two 1/2 days isn't enough time and it's very challenging to write sub-plans for the beginning of the year. If there was a way the district could provide more substantial coverage and more time for classroom teachers, the data could be collected in a more thoughtful way. Right now it's a race to get finished, so the data doesn't feel as valid. Lastly, these stories are not true literature, so it's hard to assess how students would respond to a more true level R text or T text.	
210	Grades 6-8 ELA Teacher	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels	Sometimes I am able to observe fluency issues.	We should be able to determine which students need to be tested rather than test an arbitrary number of 16. I also think the BAS books are outdated and dull, so students -- especially struggling readers cannot relate to the content. Not only do they need to be updated, they need to not have random challenging words such as: extravehicular, donned, leviathan, cacophony (though it is on some vocabulary lists). Also, the BAS data for 8th graders need to be stored or transferred to the high school. If the high school is not using this data, then what can we do with the pile up of folders? Also, teachers cannot possibly complete their testing during the allotted time when we have a substitute. Therefore, some of us are testing outside our classroom while students are left alone in class. If Brookline really wants us to test 16 students each semester--thoroughly, then we need an hour per student. 16 hours of testing means that we are testing over the course of several weeks---if we are able to test during class. However, many teachers scramble to get testing done during their free periods--and pull students from their workshop time. Again, this is not sustainable and it does not honor the contract. There is pressure to complete 16 students by the October 24th deadline, yet we are not given the time in our schedule. It is also disrespectful to send out a survey that is due at 4 p.m. on Tuesday. We just received it today. If Brookline cares about this data, then it must be done with respect for students and teachers. It would be helpful to ask us (not in a Google Form, but in a conversation) about the issues we are having with BAS. If Brookline respects teachers and students, then we will examine our practices closely ---and honestly discuss if BAS is a valuable use of our time. Finally, as we examine culturally sensitive issues, we need to look at the content of the BAS stories to determine if they are inherently discriminatory. Please let us be bold in our examination of this time consuming practice. Thank you.	

BAS Survey - October 2018

	My current role is:	3. Please indicate how you currently use your BAS data? (Check ALL that apply)	4. Does the BAS provide additional information that helps you assess student reading levels and reading behaviors? Please explain your response.	5. Do you have any suggestions for ways to improve assessing student literacy in the district?	
211	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Document student progress	My ELE students often read at least two years below grade level, and knowing their reading level helps me select appropriate materials to use in class. We give the ELE students the ACCESS tests each January, but the results are difficult to interpret since they do not include a grade-level score.	I would like to have a BAS score for each of my students, but it's hard to find the time for even the six students that I am required to test. Subs are not provided to ELE teachers, only to classroom teachers, for BAS testing. It might help if ELE teachers can also have a sub so that we can test more of our students.	
212	Special Educator	Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Provides common assessment language that we share across a variety of school based and district professionals	Yes. I'm not sure it needs to be done twice a year all students, but for my students with reading goals on their IEPs, the data I get is incredibly helpful.	If a child was reading above grade level on the previous BAS, don't reassess that child for another year or two.	
213	Specialist (EL Teacher, ECS Teacher, Librarian etc)	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels	No, it could give us more information in terms of planning instruction. We mostly use it to form groups in DATA meetings, but why not have Instructional planning meetings with the Literacy coaches after BAS data has been collected. Instructional Planning meetings should go on all year long to help classroom teachers.	Why assess everyone again in the early spring again. It is a huge time investment. Just assess kids the classroom teachers are concerned about. Classroom teachers KNOW their students. Couldn't Instructional Planning meetings have Action steps that have to be documented. Sharing of student written work in Gr. level teams with Literacy coaches could be used to move Instructional forward.	
214	Literacy Specialist/ Literacy Coach/ Literacy Interventionist	Identify student's independent and instructional reading levels, Observe and quantify student reading behaviors, Document student progress, Make informed decisions that connect assessment to instruction, Confirm teacher professional judgment	Yes, the BAS provides a lot of valuable information now that I understand the theoretical perspectives behind the assessment. It can be challenging to use the data in an informed way (beyond finding a reading level) if you do not fully understand the theory of reading and writing that Fountas and Pinnell believe in. Understanding their work helps teachers understand what M, S, and V all mean and can help to develop meaningful instruction.	-Teachers should use running records in between BAS cycles to continue to inform instruction, and cut back on the time it takes to administer the assessment (running records provide a starting place). -We should have other interventions besides LLI. Additional assessments, beyond the BAS, should be used with students who struggle and those assessments should inform the interventions that are being put into place.	

BROOKLINE
DRISCOLL SCHOOL EXPANSION

School Building Committee
February 28, 2019



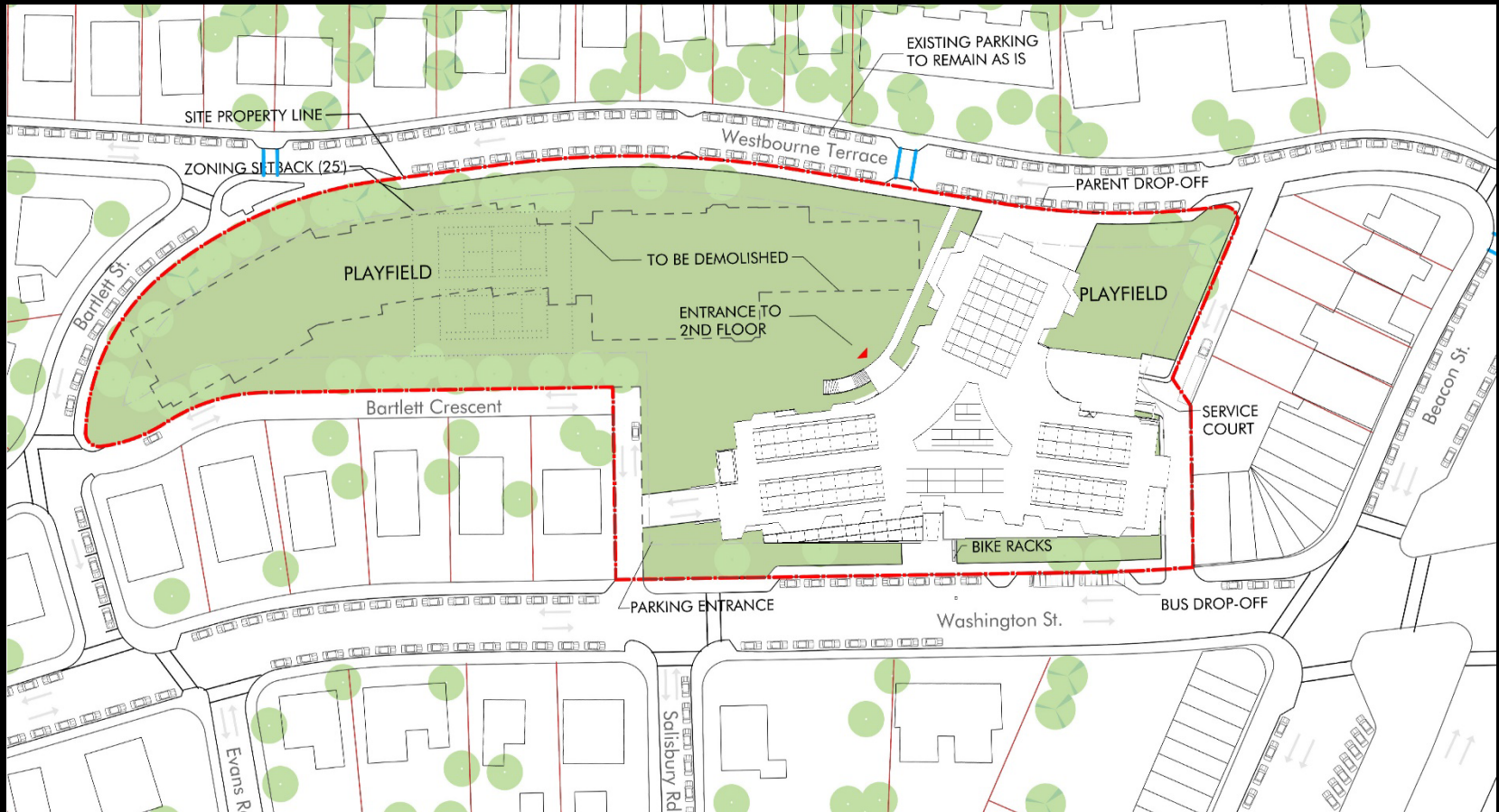
Agenda

1. Design Updates
2. Budget

Agenda

1. Design Updates

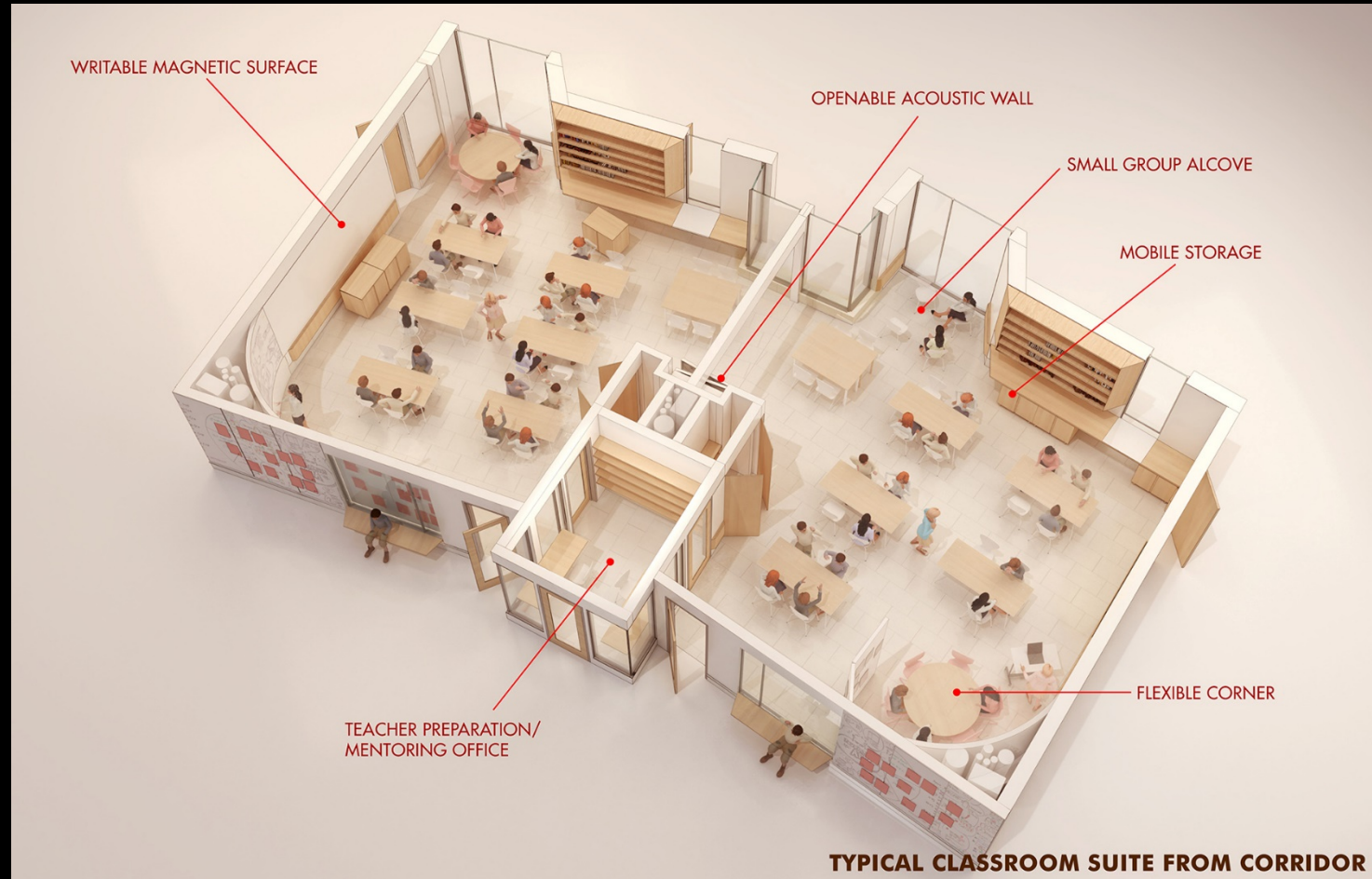
Site Plan



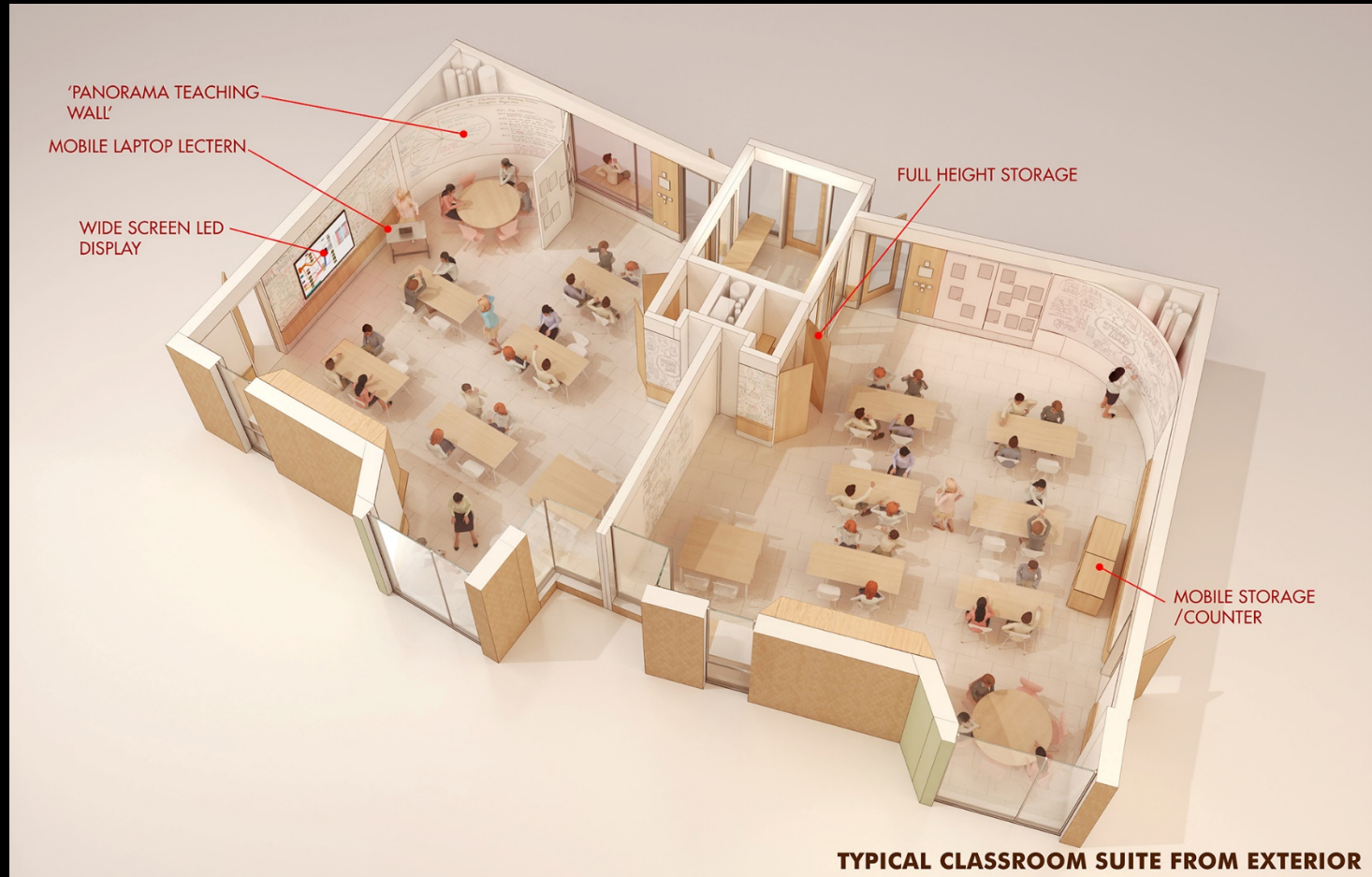
Open Space Metrics

	LOT	BUILDING		OPEN SPACE			
Concept Alternative	Total Lot Area	Building GSF	Building Footprint	Usable Play Area (with tennis)	Vehicle / Pedestrian	Unutilized Area	Total Open Area
Existing	173,000 SF	97,000 SF	39,500 SF	72,500 SF	32,000 SF	29,000 SF	133,500 SF
H Modified Star	173,000 SF	155,500 SF	42,000 SF	97,000 SF	21,500 SF	12,500 SF	131,000 SF
Lincoln	187,308 SF	87,500 SF	44,369 SF	61,851 SF	13,633 SF	67,455 SF	142,939 SF
Runkle	132,858 SF	104,800 SF	52,609 SF	40,446 SF	0 SF	39,802 SF	80,248 SF
Coolidge Corner	292,723 SF	200,000+ SF	88,880 SF	143,211 SF	6,982 SF	53,650 SF	203,843 SF

Anatomy of a Classroom



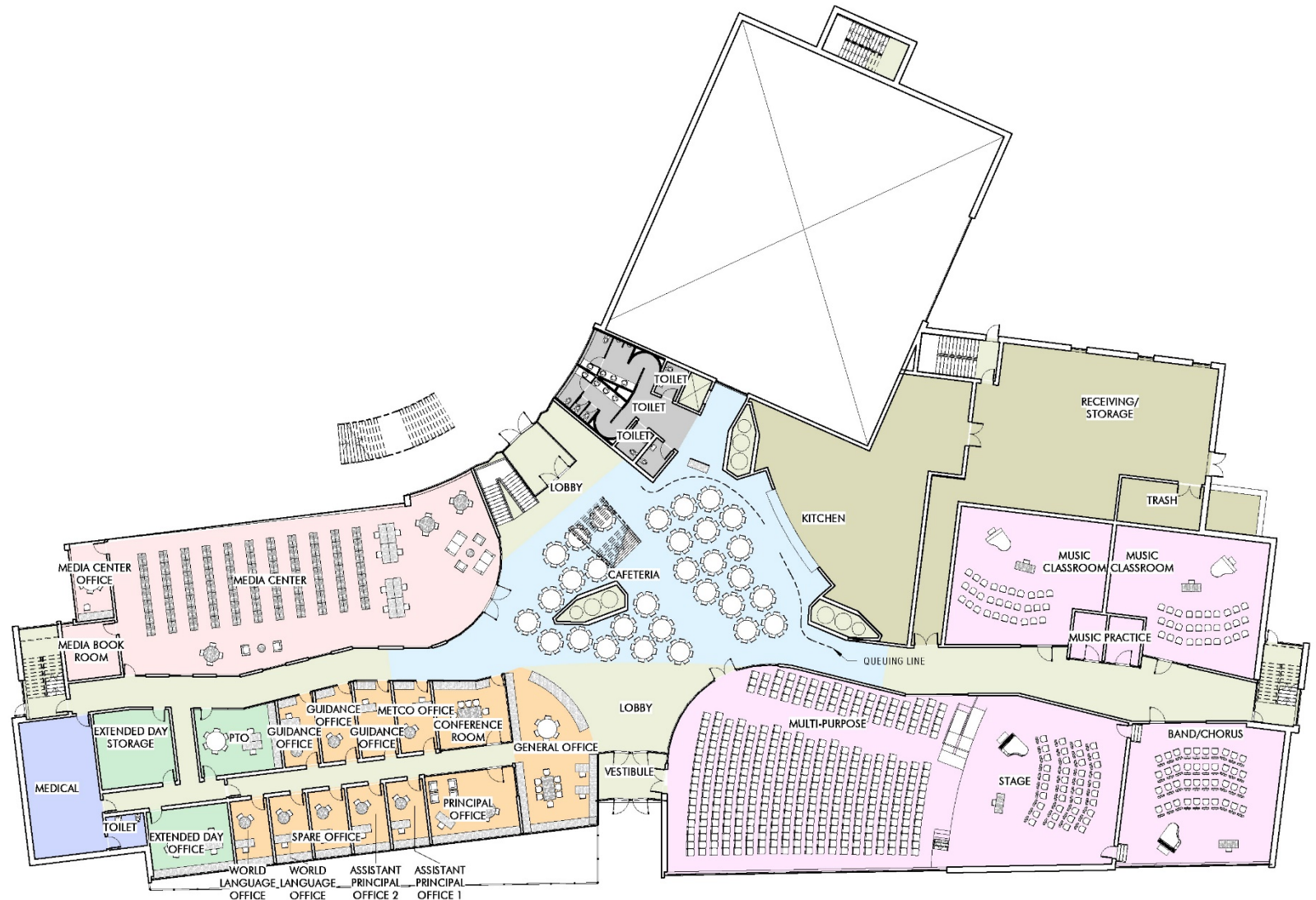
Anatomy of a Classroom



Basement Floor Plan



First Floor Plan



Second Floor Plan



Third Floor Plan



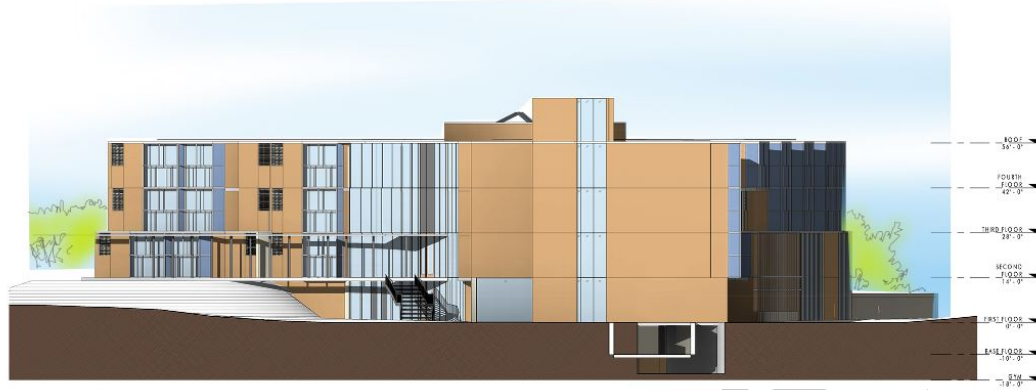
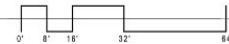
Fourth Floor Plan



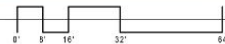
Elevations



SOUTH ELEVATION



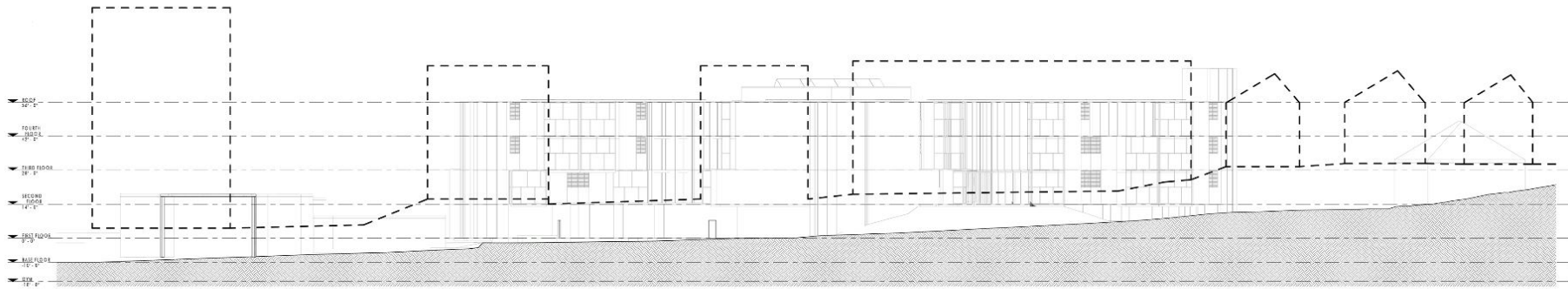
WEST ELEVATION



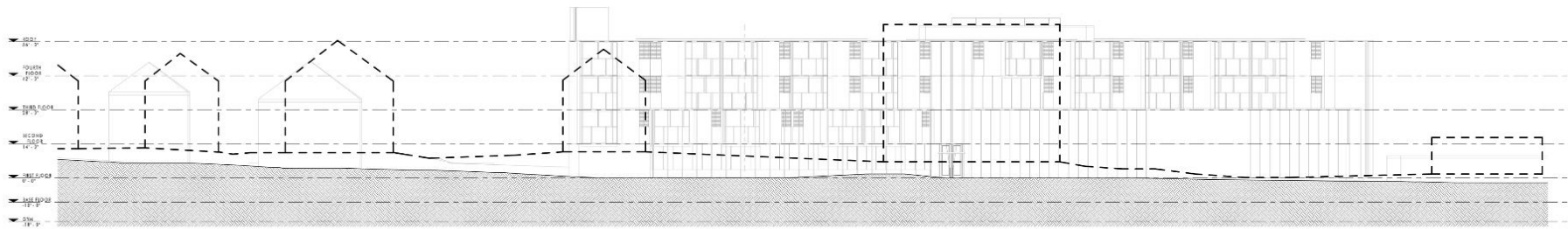
Elevations



Street Massing Diagram



WESTBOURNE TERRACE ELEVATION



WASHINGTON STREET ELEVATION

Agenda

1. Design Updates
2. Budget

Construction Costs Drivers

Construction estimate includes several cost drivers not found in typical MSBA projects including:

- Boston Metro Area cost index – Construction costs approximately 20% above less developed areas in Massachusetts
- Structured Parking
- Fossil fuel free systems
- Brookline K-8 standard Multipurpose Room – adds additional sf, double height

Construction Costs

Total Construction Cost

Estimated Bid or Guaranteed Maximum Price (GMP)

Includes:

Trade Costs:

- Hazmat Abatement
- Demolition
- Earthwork
- Utilities
- Landscaping
- Road and Sidewalk
- The Building

Markups:

- Design Contingency
(% reduces over time during design)
- General Conditions
- Bonds and Insurance
- Escalation (% reduces over time during design)
- CMR

Total Project Costs - Driscoll

Total Project Costs include:

- Construction Costs: \$87.2M
- Architectural / Engineering Fees \$8.7M
- Owner's Project Manager Fee: 3M
- CMR Pre-Construction Fee \$300k
- Legal Fees: \$100k
- Commissioning: \$125k
- Testing and Inspections: \$120k
- Utility Fees: 100k
- Furniture, Fixtures, and Equipment: \$1.6M
- Technology: \$1.1M
- Moving Expenses: \$90k
- Hard Cost Contingency: \$4.1M
- Soft Cost Contingency: 2.2M



Projected Total Costs - Driscoll

	<u>Construction Cost</u>	<u>Total Project Cost</u>
<u>Building and Site:</u>	\$77.4M	<u>\$96.6M</u>
<u>Play Area:</u>	\$2.0M	<u>\$2.5M</u>
<u>Structured Parking:</u>	\$2.8M	<u>\$3.4M</u>
<u>Fossil Free Allowance:</u>	\$5.0M	<u>\$6.3M</u>
Total	\$87.2M	\$108.8M

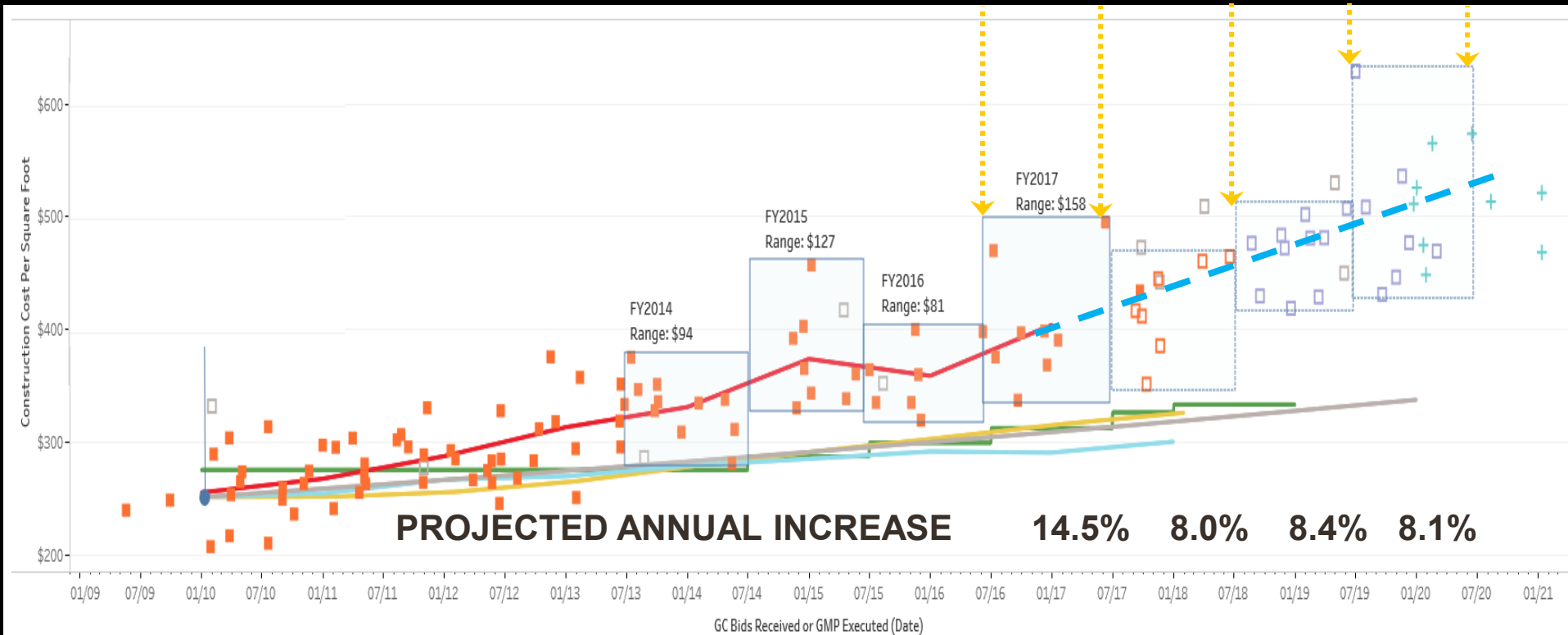
Cost Comparison to Feasibility Study - Driscoll

	Construction Cost	Total Project Cost
<u>Feasibility Study:</u>	\$84.3M - \$89M	\$104.5M - \$110.3M
<u>Schematic Design:</u>	\$87.2M	\$108.8M

ESCALATION - RECENT MSBA SCHOOL PROJECTS

 = Projected average school cost increase based on MSBA pipeline

FY2017 FY2018 FY2019 FY2020



The information and data contained in this chart is based on the MSBA's review of construction cost estimates, contracts and other documentation provided by cities, towns, and regional school districts. This information and data is intended for informational purposes only. The data may have changed based on actual construction bids or contract amendments, for example, and the MSBA shall have no responsibility or duty to update any of the information. Please contact the Districts for the most current information. The MSBA hereby disclaims any and all liability and responsibility that may arise in connection with the information contained in this chart. (Updated August 2018)

RECENT MIDDLE SCHOOL PROJECTS

(Sorted by Total Project Cost, adjusted for escalation)

Project Name	Students	Cost Escalated to Driscoll (\$M)
Lynn Middle Schools	1,660	\$213
Saugus Middle/High School	1,360	\$186
Beverly Middle School	1,395	\$136
Holyoke Lawrence Middle School	1,100	\$132
Abington Middle/High School	1,115	\$129
Natick Kennedy Middle School	1,000	\$116
Dennis-Yarmouth Mattacheese Middle School	940	\$113
Westport Middle/High School	860	\$112
New Driscoll	800	\$109
Boston Dearborn STEM Academy	600	\$94
Quincy Sterling Middle School	430	\$70

RECENT MIDDLE SCHOOL PROJECTS

(Sorted by Cost per Square Feet, adjusted for escalation)

Project Name	Students	Cost/SF
Boston Dearborn STEM Academy	600	\$730
Quincy Sterling Middle School	430	\$727
New Driscoll Including Parking and Fossil Free	800	\$698
Saugus Middle/High School	1,360	\$693
Lynn Middle Schools	1,660	\$674
Natick Kennedy Middle School	1,000	\$638
New Driscoll - Base Building and Landscape	800	\$636
Holyoke Lawrence Middle School	1,100	\$617
Dennis-Yarmouth Mattacheese Middle School	940	\$614
Westport Middle/High School	860	\$597
Beverly Middle School	1,395	\$586

BROOKLINE

BALDWIN SCHOOL

School Committee
February 28, 2019



Jonathan Levi Architects

BALDWIN SCHOOL, BROOKLINE

Agenda

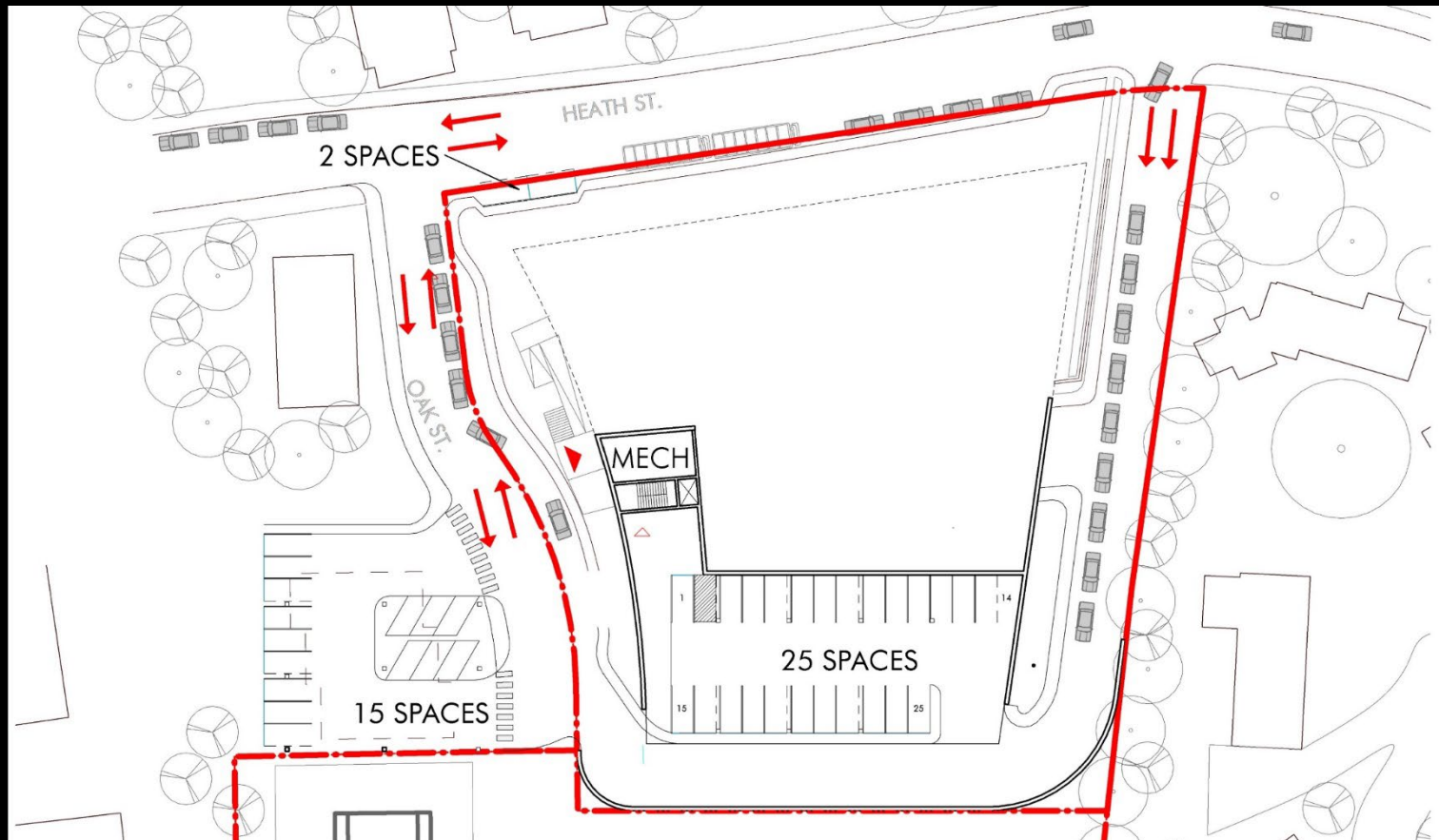
1. Design
2. Budget

Agenda

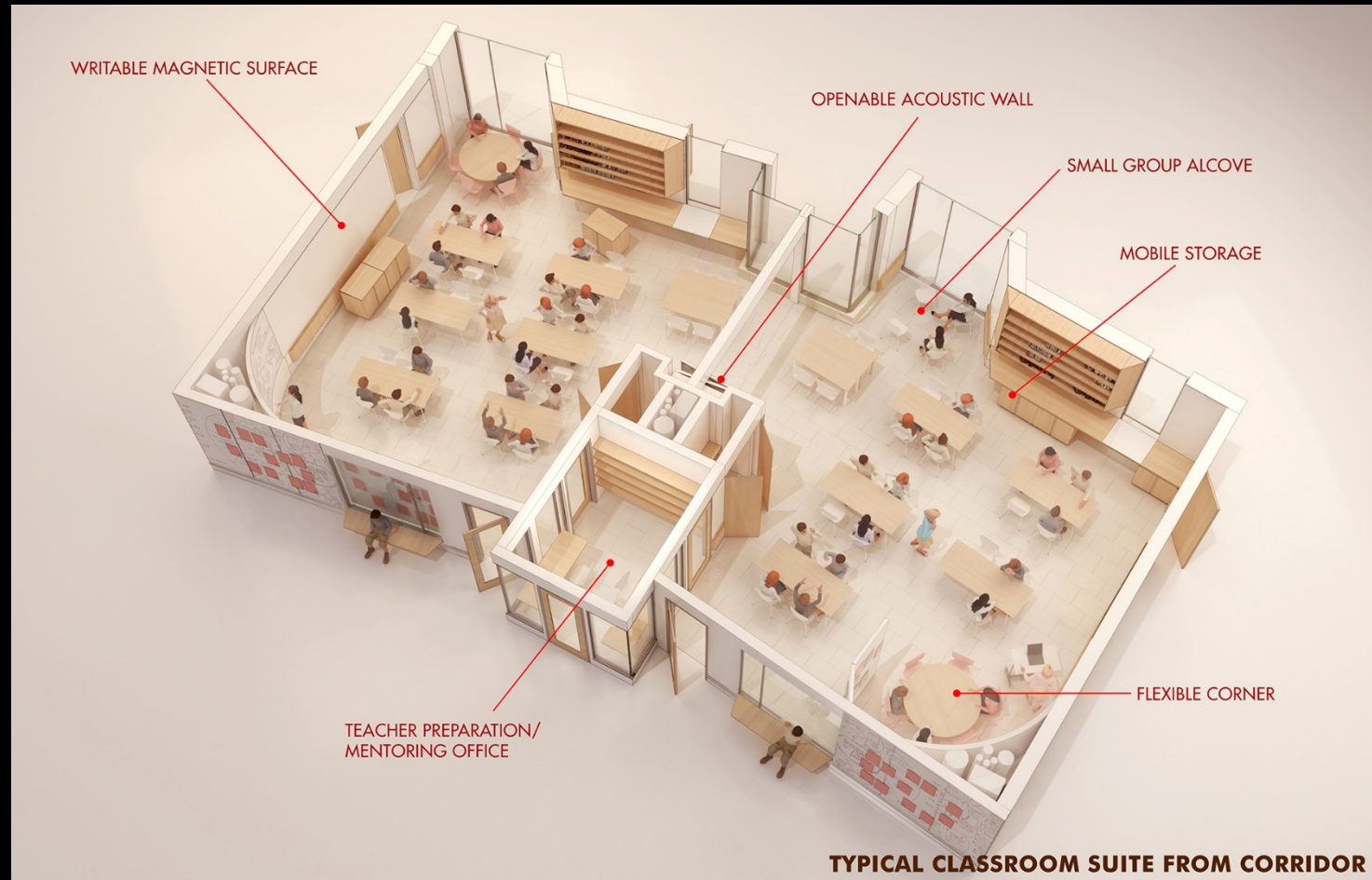
1. Design



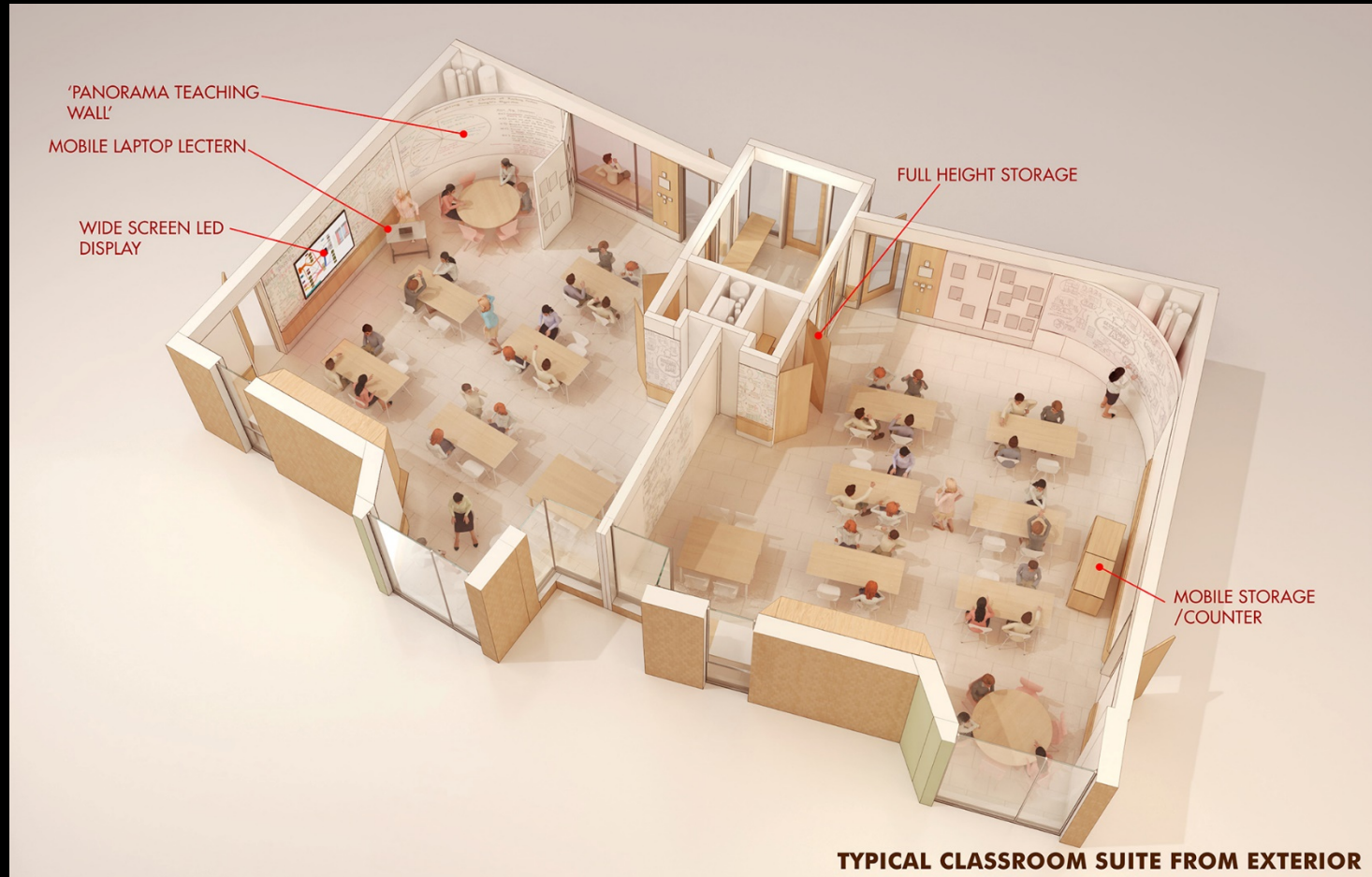
Site Plan



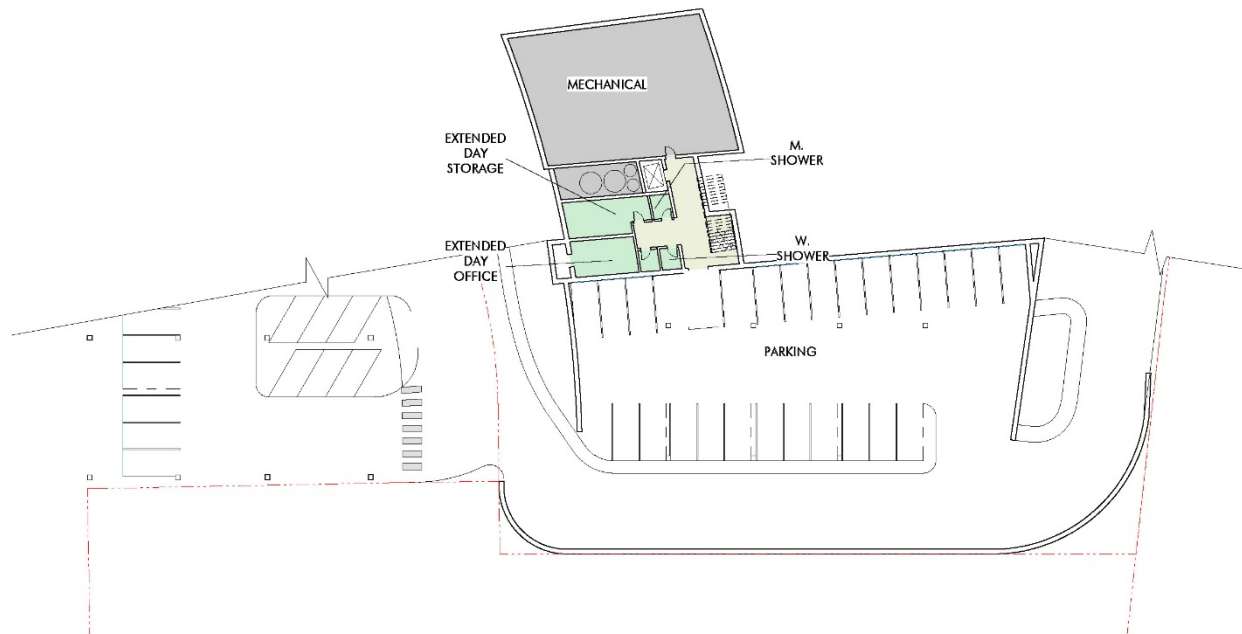
Anatomy of a Classroom



Anatomy of a Classroom



Basement Floor Plan

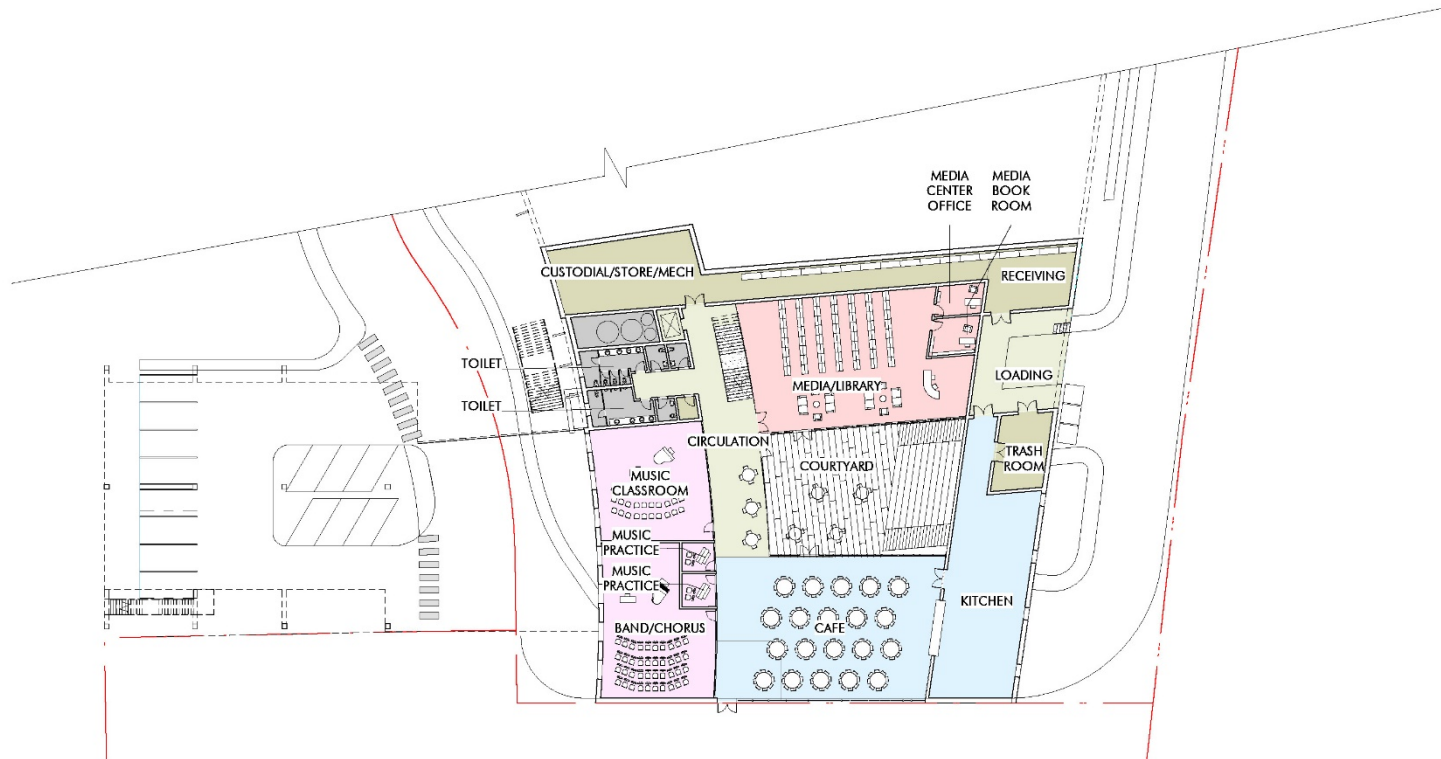


BASEMENT

32

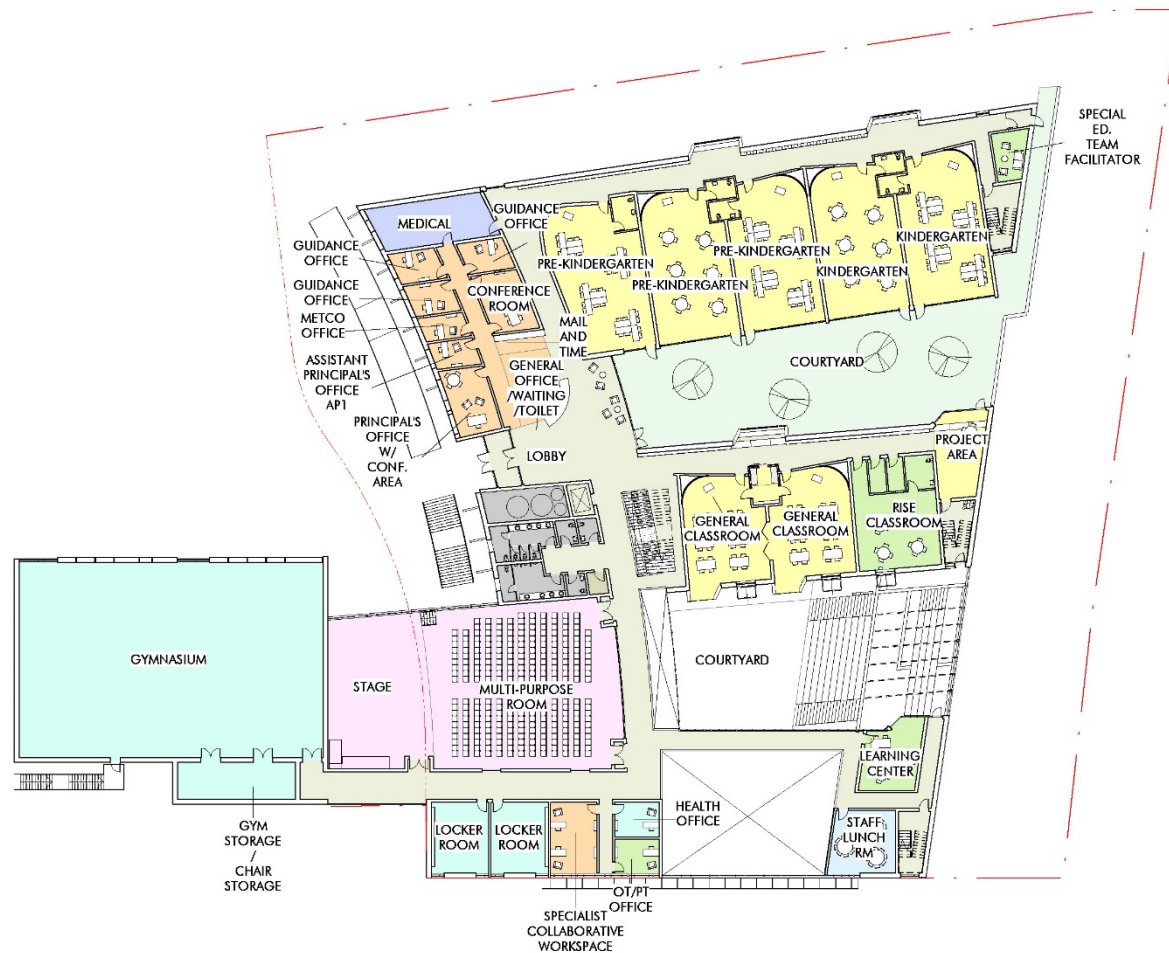


Basement Floor Plan



FIRST FLOOR

Basement Floor Plan



SECOND FLOOR



Basement Floor Plan



THIRD FLOOR



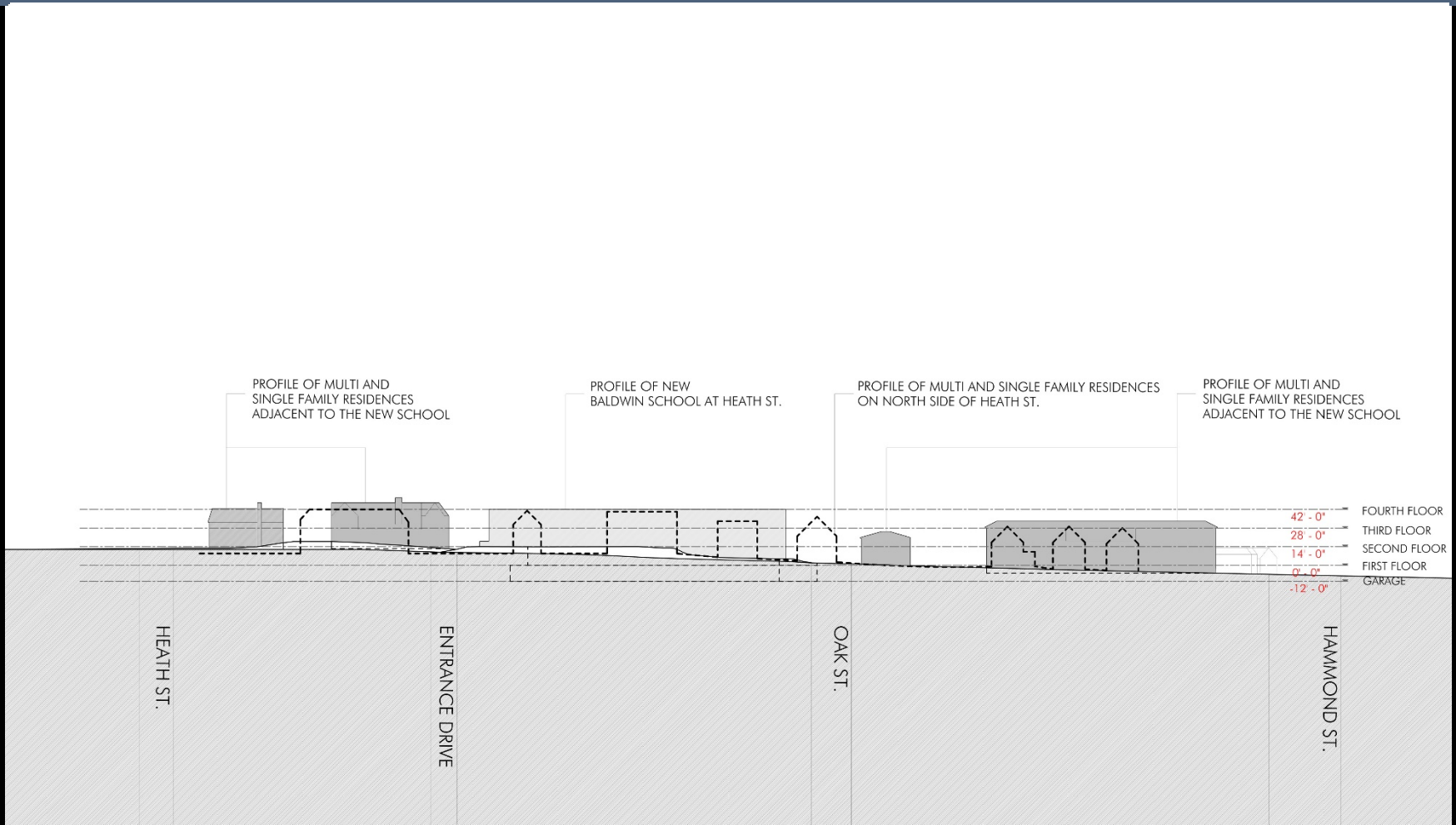
Basement Floor Plan



FOURTH FLOOR



Street Massing Diagram



 Jonathan Levi Architects

8' 32' 64' 128'

HEATH STREET ELEVATION
MASSING DIAGRAM
BALDWIN SCHOOL, BROOKLINE

 Jonathan Levi Architects

BALDWIN SCHOOL, BROOKLINE

Agenda

1. Design Updates
2. Budget

Construction Costs Drivers

Construction estimate includes several cost drivers not found in typical MSBA projects including:

1. Boston Metro Area cost index – Construction costs approximately 20% above less developed areas in Massachusetts
2. RISE program – requires additional sf per student and increased staff to student ratio
3. Structured Parking
4. Fossil fuel free systems
5. Small School Premium
6. Brookline soil conditions – typically ledge
7. Brookline K-8 standard Multipurpose Room – adds additional sf, double height
8. Neighborhood improvements – sidewalks, crossing signals, etc.

Construction Costs

Total Construction Cost

Estimated Bid or Guaranteed Maximum Price (GMP)

Includes:

Trade Costs:

- Hazmat Abatement
- Demolition
- Earthwork
- Utilities
- Landscaping
- Road and Sidewalk
- The Building

Markups:

- Design Contingency (reduces over time during design)
- General Conditions
- Bonds and Insurance
- Escalation (reduces over time during design)
- CMR

Total Project Costs - Baldwin

Total Project Costs include:

- Construction Costs: \$66.9M
- Architectural / Engineering Fees \$6.9M
- Owner's Project Manager Fee: 2.3M
- CMR Pre-Construction Fee \$300K
- Legal Fees: \$100K
- Commissioning: \$87K
- Testing and Inspections: \$120k
- Utility Fees: 100K
- Furniture, Fixtures, and Equipment: \$900K
- Technology: \$630K
- Moving Expenses: \$50k
- Hard Cost Contingency: \$3.3M
- Soft Cost Contingency: 1.3M



Projected Total Costs - Baldwin

	<u>Construction Cost</u>	<u>Total Project Cost</u>
<u>Building and Site:</u>	\$58.2M	<u>\$72.2M</u>
<u>Play Area:</u>	\$2.0M	<u>\$2.5M</u>
<u>Structured Parking:</u>	\$2.8M	<u>\$3.4M</u>
Pedestrian and Bike Safety		
• Sidewalk Upgrades,		
• Crosswalks, Signage, Signals		
• Route 9 Pedestrian		
<u>Crossing Safety Upgrades</u>	\$1.4M	<u>\$1.7M</u>
<u>Fossil Free Allowance:</u>	\$2.5M	<u>\$3.1M</u>
Total	\$66.9M	\$82.9M

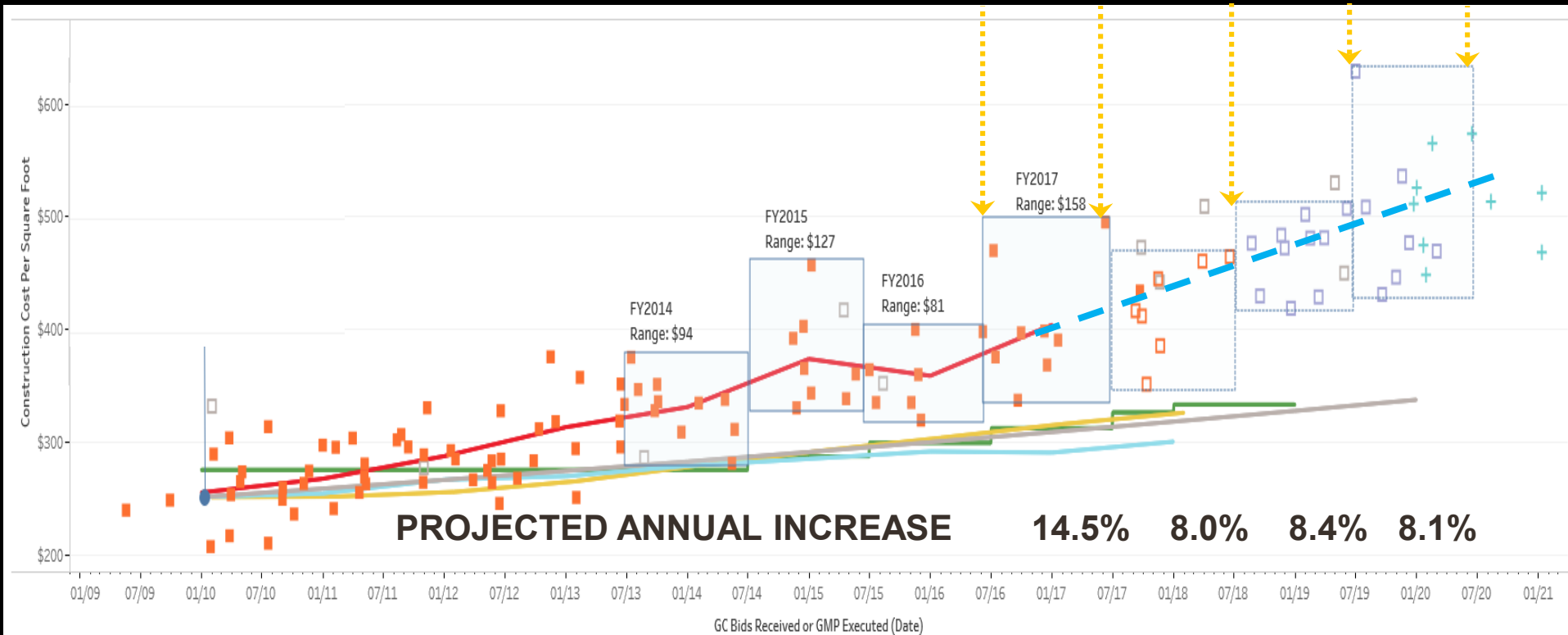
Cost Comparison to Feasibility Study - Baldwin

	Construction Cost	Total Project Cost
<u>Feasibility Study:</u>	\$62.6M - \$67M	\$77.6M - \$83M
<u>Schematic Design:</u>	\$66.9M	\$82.9M

ESCALATION - RECENT MSBA SCHOOL PROJECTS

 = Projected average school cost increase based on MSBA pipeline

FY2017 FY2018 FY2019 FY2020



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(Sorted by Total Project Cost, adjusted for escalation)

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Westport Middle/High School	860	\$112
Boston Dearborn STEM Academy	600	\$94
Baldwin	450	\$83
Quincy Sterling Middle School	430	\$70

RECENT MIDDLE SCHOOL PROJECTS

(Sorted by Cost per Square Feet, adjusted for escalation)

Project Name	Students	Cost/SF
Baldwin Including Parking and Fossil Free	450	\$763
Boston Dearborn STEM Academy	600	\$730
Quincy Sterling Middle School	430	\$727
Baldwin Base Building, Landscape, and Pedestrian Improvements	450	\$703
Saugus Middle/High School	1,360	\$693
Lynn Middle Schools	1,660	\$674
Natick Kennedy Middle School	1,000	\$638
Holyoke Lawrence Middle School	1,100	\$617
Dennis-Yarmouth Mattacheese Middle School	940	\$614
Westport Middle/High School	860	\$597
Beverly Middle School	1,395	\$586



Brookline Schools Additional Seat Options Comparisons

(Sorted by Cost per Added Seat)

Lowest Cost Options	Cost	Added Seats	Cost/Seat
Baker 5	\$184M	160	\$1.15M
Baker 3/3	\$163M	340	\$.47M
Heath	\$75M	180	\$.42M
Pierce 5/678	\$173M	430	\$.40M
Pierce 5 Opt. 1	\$142M	430	\$.33M
Pine Manor	\$121M	540	\$.22M
Putterham	\$106M	540	\$.20M
Baldwin (Plan D)	\$103M	540	\$.19M
Baldwin North (Actual SD w Fossil Free)	\$83M	450	\$.18M

Notes: 1) Previous options based on 6/6/18 HMFH Study,
 2) Blended number of seats/classroom,
 3) Escalation, fossil free and swing space costs are not included for previous options.

Food Service RFP Schedule

Date/Time	Task
February 28, 2019	Advertise & Release Request for Proposal
March 12, 2019, 8:30-11 a.m.	Site Visitation
March 19, 2019	Deadline for Written Questions on RFP
March 21, 2019	Amendment/ Response to Written Questions
March 28, @ 2:00 p.m.	Deadline for Proposals
On or before April 30, 2019	Contract Negotiation
On or before April 30, 2019	Award of Contract by School Committee

EMPLOYMENT AGREEMENT
BY AND BETWEEN
THE BROOKLINE SCHOOL COMMITTEE
AND
ANDREW BOTT

This Employment Agreement (hereinafter referred to as "this Agreement") is made between the Brookline School Committee (hereinafter referred to as "the Committee") and Andrew Bott (hereinafter referred to as "the Superintendent" or "Mr. Bott"). This Agreement will be effective as of July 1, 2016 and shall supersede all prior employment agreements between Mr. Bott and the Public Schools of Brookline ("PSB"). For mutual consideration expressed herein, the parties agree as follows:

1. EMPLOYMENT. The Committee hereby agrees to continue to employ Mr. Bott as Superintendent of Schools for the Public Schools of Brookline and Mr. Bott accepts such continued employment on the terms and conditions contained in this Agreement.
2. TERM. Mr. Bott shall be employed as the Superintendent of the Public Schools of Brookline for five (5) years from July 1, 2019 through June 30, 2024 unless terminated earlier in accordance with the provisions of this Agreement. No later than October 1, 2023 the Committee shall give written notice of its intent to renew the Superintendent's employment after June 30, 2024. Should the Committee and the Superintendent mutually desire to continue the Superintendent's employment after June 30, 2024, they will make a good faith effort to complete negotiations for a successor employment agreement on or before January 30, 2024. If they are unable to agree upon a new employment agreement or an extension of this Agreement, then this Agreement shall expire and the Superintendent's employment will end on June 30, 2024 unless terminated earlier in accordance with the provisions of this Agreement.
3. COMPENSATION.

3.1 The Superintendent will be paid in accordance with the following schedule:

Contract Year	Salary
July 1, 2019 – June 30, 2020	\$203,752.00
July 1, 2020 – June 30, 2021	\$207,827.00
July 1, 2021 – June 30, 2022	\$211,984.00
July 1, 2022 – June 30, 2023	\$216,223.00
July 1, 2023 – June 30, 2024	\$220,548.00

3.2 The Superintendent's Salary shall be earned ratably throughout the contract year and shall be prorated for work of less than the full contract year. The Superintendent's salary shall be subject to withholdings for state and federal taxes and other withholdings required by law or authorized by the Superintendent. The Superintendent's Salary shall

be paid in equal installments in accordance with the procedures governing payment of other professional staff in the Public Schools of Brookline. The Superintendent's per diem rate shall be calculated by dividing the contract year salary by 261.

4. DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES. The Superintendent shall be the superintendent and chief executive officer for the Public Schools of Brookline ("PSB") and shall perform all the duties of and possess all the authority now or hereafter imposed upon or granted to a superintendent of schools under provisions of the statutes of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts and by rule or regulation of the Commissioner of Education, and applicable policies of the Committee. As way of example, and not limitation, the Superintendent shall be responsible for hiring, firing, disciplining, assigning, transferring, supervising, evaluating and directing his subordinates and employees in the PSB, developing and recommending strategies for improving instructional quality and student achievement, sustaining and improving the involvement of parents and community members and institutions in the school system, establishing and implementing sound financial management procedures and otherwise organizing the school system in a manner that best serves the educational needs of the students in the PSB in accordance with Massachusetts General Laws and regulations, applicable federal laws and regulations, and applicable Committee policies. The Committee may, from time to time, prescribe additional duties and responsibilities for the Superintendent provided, however, that all additional duties and responsibilities prescribed by the Committee are consistent with those normally associated with the position of a superintendent of schools in the Commonwealth of Massachusetts. The Superintendent shall attend all meetings of the Committee, unless excused by the Committee, and may participate in all Committee deliberations except when matters relating to his own employment are under consideration. He shall assist the Chairperson of the Committee in setting agendas for Committee meetings and in preparing for Committee meetings. He shall advise the Committee on policies, procedures, and plans and shall take the initiative in presenting and recommending policies, procedures, and planning issues to the Committee. The Superintendent shall devote his full time, skill, labor and attention to the discharge of his duties during the term of this Agreement. The Superintendent shall participate in community activities in order to generate support for the PSB, and to solicit feedback from the community on the performance of the PSB. The Superintendent will seek input from the Committee regarding his community activities.
5. PERFORMANCE EVALUATION. The Committee shall evaluate the Superintendent each contract year in accordance with the applicable requirements in 603 CMR 35.00 - 35.11 inclusive. Such evaluation shall be done in open session in accordance with M.G.L. chapter 30A.
6. WORK YEAR and BENEFITS.
 - 6.1 Work Year. The Superintendent shall work a full contract year (52.2 weeks) schedule subject to authorized leaves such as vacation leave, provided herein.
 - 6.2 Vacation Leave.
 - A. Accrual.

The Superintendent shall accrue twenty-five (25) vacation days per contract year at

the rate of 2.0833 days of vacation per month worked during the term of this Agreement. The Superintendent may take his vacation days at any time during the term of this Agreement, with the permission of the Committee Chair/designee, but normally vacation days will be taken whenever possible during school vacation periods.

- B. Carry Over. The Superintendent may carry over up to and including ten (10) accrued unused vacation days into the subsequent Contract Year. The total carryover of accrued unused vacation days into subsequent Contract Years cannot exceed ten (10) vacation days in the aggregate. At no time may the Superintendent have more than a total of thirty-five (35) accrued, unused vacation days which includes all vacation days previously carried over from prior Contract Years that have not been used (not exceeding ten) plus the total of his accrued unused vacation from the current Contract Year.
- C. Vacation Buy Back Upon Separation. At the time of separation from service, the Superintendent shall receive compensation for all unused, accrued vacation days at the Superintendent's per diem rate. The Superintendent expressly waives any claim under G.L. c. 149, §148 for any amount of accrued, unused vacation days to the extent that payment for such days would exceed the limitation in Section 6.2B of this Agreement.
- D. Annual Vacation Buy Back. The Superintendent may sell back up to and including ten (10) accrued unused vacation days per Contract Year at the Superintendent's per diem rate in such Contract Year. The Superintendent will provide the Chairperson of the Committee with notice of his intent to sell back vacation days and the number of days he intends to sell back on or before February 1st of the Contract Year in which the sell back will occur.

- 6.3 Sick Leave. The Superintendent shall be entitled to 15 days of sick leave with pay in accordance with the provisions in this Section 5.3. The Superintendent will accrue one and one fourth (1¼) sick leave days per month worked during the term of this Agreement up to a maximum of fifty (50) days. The Superintendent may use his accrued sick leave to cover the Superintendent's absences for personal illness or injury. There is no buyout of accrued unused sick leave upon separation from employment.
- 6.4 Administrative Leave Days. The Committee shall grant up to four (4) administrative leave days with pay per Contract Year, non-cumulative; such administrative leave days shall be taken only for important personal business which cannot be addressed outside of the Superintendent's work day or work year and shall not be used as vacation leave or for recreation.
- 6.5 Bereavement Leave. The Superintendent shall be entitled to a bereavement leave of up to five (5) calendar days upon the death of an immediate family member, defined as the Superintendent's spouse, child, grandchild, parent, grandparent, and mother/father-in-law.

6.6 Holidays. The Superintendent shall be entitled to paid holidays in accordance with the procedures governing holidays for professional staff of the PSB.

6.7 Insurance. The Superintendent may elect to obtain insurance, including but not limited to group health insurance, generally available to employees of the PSB and their dependents on the same terms and conditions as such insurance is generally available to other non-unionized employees of the PSB. If the Superintendent declines to obtain such health insurance, the Superintendent shall provide proof of health insurance coverage through another source and shall complete any required documentation including the Massachusetts Health Insurance Responsibility Disclosure (“HIRD”) form.

6.8 Cell Phone/Computer. Upon the request of the Superintendent, the District shall provide a laptop computer, a cell phone and other equipment, as deemed necessary for the Superintendent to work off-site as well as at the District office. The Superintendent shall return the same to the District upon his separation from employment.

6.9 Vehicle Allowance. Commencing July 2019, in lieu of providing the Superintendent with a vehicle owned by and registered to the Town of Brookline, the Committee will provide the Superintendent with a vehicle allowance of three hundred dollars (\$300.00) per month.

6.10 Disability Insurance. The District shall provide the Superintendent with the option of purchasing disability insurance on the same basis as such insurance is available to Assistant Superintendents and Deputy Superintendents in the District. The Superintendent understands and agrees that the District may change such insurance carriers, products, eligibility, benefits, and premium contribution rates from time to time. The District shall reimburse the Superintendent for the cost of the annual premium for such insurance, up to a maximum of \$1,200.00 for each Contract Year.

7. REIMBURSEMENT FOR EXPENSES AND PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATIONS.

Reimbursement for Attendance at Professional Meetings. The Superintendent shall submit receipts for reasonable and necessary expenses incurred in attending professional meetings, conferences, and seminars up to a maximum of two thousand dollars (\$2,000.00) per Contract Year, to be agreed in advance with the Committee. No reimbursements shall be made in excess of the \$2,000.00 limit without prior written request from the Superintendent and prior written authorization from the Committee after a vote of the Committee at an Open Meeting.

8. LICENSE. The Superintendent hereby represents to the Committee that he is currently licensed or has satisfied the requirements to obtain a license to serve as Superintendent of Schools pursuant to the laws of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts and the Rules and Regulations of the Commissioner of Elementary and Secondary Education and the Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education (“DESE”). As a condition of employment and continued employment, the Superintendent shall maintain,

throughout the term of this Agreement, a valid and appropriate license qualifying him to serve as a superintendent of schools in a school district in the Commonwealth of Massachusetts, as required by Massachusetts General Laws, as such may be amended from time to time. The Superintendent agrees to notify the Committee within 24 hours of his license being revoked, rescinded, suspended, or lapsed.

9. PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES. The Superintendent shall devote his full time, attention, and energy to the business of the Brookline Public Schools. However, the Committee encourages the continuing professional growth of the Superintendent through his participation, as he might decide in light of his responsibilities as Superintendent, in:

- A. the operations, programs, conferences, and other activities conducted or sponsored by local, state, and national school administrator and/or school committee associations;
- B. local, state and national conferences, seminars, and courses offered by private institutions, commissions, or committees related to education; and
- C. informational meetings with persons whose particular skills or backgrounds would serve to improve the capacity of the Superintendent to perform his professional responsibilities for the PSB.

However, except for reimbursement for expenses consistent with Section 7 of this Agreement, no other funds will be made available for any of the professional activities listed in this Section 9.

10. INDEMNIFICATION.

10.1 Terms. In accordance with and to the extent provided by applicable Massachusetts General Laws, the Committee agrees to provide indemnification to the Superintendent against all uninsured financial losses arising out of any proceeding, claim, demand, suit or judgment by the reason of alleged negligence or other conduct resulting in bodily or other injury to any person or damage to the property of any person committed while the Superintendent is acting within the scope of his employment or under direction of the Committee. The parties understand and agree that this indemnification provision shall not apply to actions by the Committee to suspend and/or terminate the Superintendent. Notwithstanding the foregoing, Superintendent and the Committee agree that in no event shall any member of the Committee ever have any personal liability under this Agreement.

10.2 Receipt of Process. The Superintendent shall, as soon as possible within three (3) business days of the time he actually receives any summons, complaint, process, notice, demand or pleading, deliver a copy of the same to the Committee.

10.3 Survival of Indemnification Right. This Section 10 shall survive the termination of this

Agreement regarding acts of the Superintendent which are covered by Section 10.1, above.

11. TERMINATION OF EMPLOYMENT AGREEMENT.

11.1 Termination of Agreement by the Committee with Good Cause. During the term of this Agreement, the Committee may suspend the Superintendent from his position as superintendent and/or may terminate his employment and this Agreement for good cause. "Good cause" herein shall be defined as any ground put forth by the Committee that is not arbitrary, irrational, unreasonable or irrelevant to the task of building and maintaining an efficient school system. Prior to any termination for good cause, the Committee shall provide the Superintendent with written notice of the reason, reasons, charge or charges against him, and the grounds on which such reason(s) or charge(s) is based. Provided that the Superintendent has made a request for a hearing in writing to the Chairperson of the Committee within seven (7) calendar days of receipt of such written notice, the Committee shall provide the Superintendent with a hearing upon said reason(s) or charge(s). Such hearing shall be conducted in accordance with the provisions of the Open Meeting Law, G.L. c. 30A, §§18-25. The Superintendent shall be entitled to have his legal counsel present to advise him. The Superintendent shall be responsible for paying all fees and costs associated with such legal counsel. The decision of the Committee, after such hearing, if any, shall be final and binding, subject to such judicial review as may be provided under applicable law. The Superintendent may request to use his accrued vacation days prior to his separation from employment and/or the Committee may schedule the Superintendent for vacation days prior to his final day of employment. In the event of termination pursuant to this paragraph, the Committee shall not be required to pay, and the Superintendent shall not be entitled to receive, salary payments and benefits payable after the effective date of termination.

11.2 [This Section 11.2 intentionally left blank.]

11.3 Termination For Disability. Subject to the provisions of the Americans with Disabilities Act, if the Superintendent is absent from work on account of a disability for more than one hundred twenty (120) calendar days, the Committee shall have the option of terminating his employment and this Agreement for incapacity. If the Committee exercises its option to terminate the Superintendent's employment and this Agreement, the Superintendent shall not be entitled to receive salary payments and benefits payable after the effective date of such termination.

11.4 Early Termination By the Superintendent. The Superintendent may terminate his employment by submitting his written resignation to the Committee with as much advance notice as possible but no less than one hundred and twenty (120) calendar days advance notice. In the event of termination pursuant to this paragraph, the Committee shall not be required to pay, and the Superintendent shall not be entitled to receive, salary payments and benefits payable after the effective date of the Superintendent's resignation. The Superintendent may request to use his accrued vacation days prior to his separation from employment and/or the Committee may schedule the

Superintendent for vacation days prior to his final day of employment.

- 11.5 Accrued Unused Vacation Days. Upon separation from employment for any reason, the Committee shall pay the Superintendent for all accrued unused vacation days in accordance with the provisions in Section 6.2D of this Agreement.
12. NOTICES. All notices required or desired to be given under this Agreement will be deemed to be served if in writing and delivered by in-hand delivery to the Superintendent or sent by certified mail to the Superintendent's residence in the case of the Superintendent, or sent by certified mail to its central office in the case of the Committee with a copy sent by certified mail to the residence of the Chairperson of the Committee.
13. ENTIRE AGREEMENT. This Agreement contains the whole agreement between the Committee and the Superintendent. There have been no inducements, promises, terms, conditions, or obligations made or entered into by either party other than those set forth herein. No modification of or addition to this Agreement shall be effective unless and until set forth in writing and signed by the parties.
14. SEVERABILITY. If any term(s) or provision(s) of this Agreement are held to be invalid or unenforceable for any reason by a court of competent jurisdiction, the validity and enforceability of the remaining terms and provisions shall not be affected, and such invalid and/or unenforceable term(s) and/or provision(s) shall be modified to the extent necessary to make it or them enforceable.
15. GOVERNING LAW. This Agreement shall be interpreted, enforced, governed and construed under and in accordance with the laws of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts.
16. COUNTERPARTS. This Agreement shall be executed in two counterparts, each of which shall be deemed to be an original and both of which taken together will be deemed one and the same instrument.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF the parties have caused this Agreement to be subscribed in duplicate on this ____ day of _____, 2019.

On Behalf of the Brookline School Committee:

David Pollak
Chairperson, Brookline School Committee

Andrew Bott